Kalavinka Buddhist Classics

天台山沙門智顗述

修習止觀坐禪法要

The Essentials Of Buddhist Meditation

The Essentials for Practicing Calming-and-Insight & Dhyāna Meditation

The Classic *Śamathā-Vipaśyanā* Meditation Manual
By the Great Tiantai Meditation Master & Exegete

Śramaṇa Zhiyi (Chih-i)
(538–597 CE)

Translated by Bhikshu Dharmamitra

Kalavinka Press

The Essentials
of
Buddhist Meditation

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The Essentials
of
Buddhist Meditation

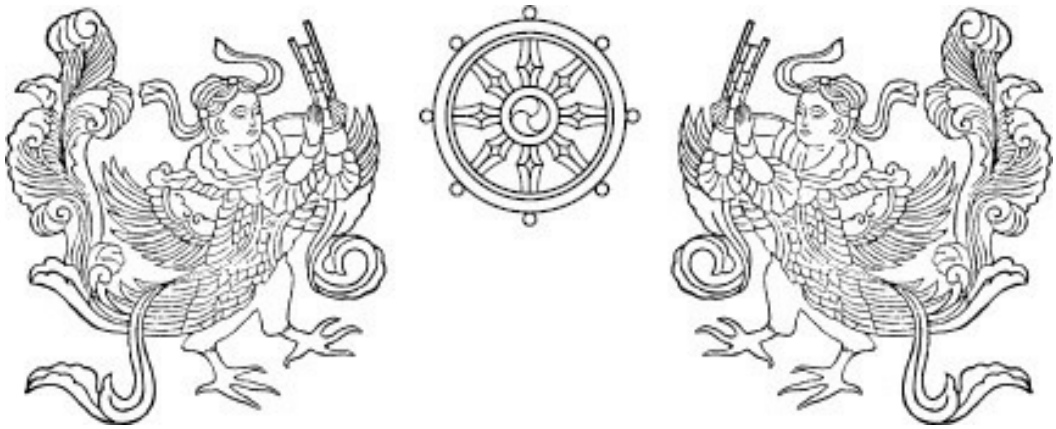
A Classic *Śamatha-Vipaśyanā* Meditation Manual:

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Dedicated to the memory of the selfless and marvelous life of the Venerable Dhyāna Master Hsuan Hua, the Weiyang Ch'an Patriarch and the very personification of the Bodhisattva Path.

Dhyāna Master Hsuan Hua

宣 化 禪 師

1918–1995

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Citation and Romanization Protocols

Kalavinka Press *Taisho* citation style adds text numbers after volume numbers and before page numbers to assist rapid CBETA digital searches.

Romanization, where used, is Pinyin with the exception of names and terms already well-recognized in Wade-Giles.

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Introduction

The Nature and Present Import of This Text

Due to its clarity and comprehensiveness in describing the crucially important factors involved in understanding and practicing Buddhist meditation, this present work, *The Essentials for Practicing Calming-and-Insight and Dhyāna Meditation*, is one of the most important introductory meditation manuals ever authored in the two millennia-long course of Sino-Buddhist history.

These very same qualities of clarity and comprehensiveness make this text by Master Zhiyi (Chih-i) a genuinely useful and reliable meditation-instruction resource for English-speaking students of the Buddha's Dharma. Although relatively short, *The Essentials* includes in condensed form the entire scope of teachings necessary for practicing what is right and avoiding what is wrong as one pursues the practice of Buddhist meditation. As such, it offers both the beginning student and the long-term Dharma practitioner immediate access to the essentials required for learning, enhancing, or rectifying Buddhist meditation practice.

This is equally true for traditions of practice not as readily identifiable with "calming-and-insight" training, as for example Ch'an meditation. Indeed, it is hard to envision how a practitioner of Ch'an meditation could make very meaningful progress in that radical and sudden approach to meditation without having first developed a solid understanding and practice of most of what is taught in Master Zhiyi's *Essentials of Buddhist Meditation*.

The Author and His Works on Meditation

The author of this text is the famous meditation master and exegete, Śramaṇa Zhiyi (538–597 CE), one of the most brilliant and widelyrespected figures in the history of Chinese Buddhism, a monastic eminence well-known for textual exegesis on numerous works, for brilliance in refining and broadening the Tiantai teaching school's hermeneutic presentation, and for authoring Chinese Buddhism's four most important meditation texts explaining right practice of the calming-and-insight meditation discipline standard in Indian Buddhism. Specifically, those works are:

1. *The Great Calming-and-Insight* (摩訶止觀 / T46.1911.001–140)
2. *An Explanation of the Dharma Gateway of Dhyāna Pāramitā* (釋禪波羅蜜次第法門 / T46.1916.475–548)
3. *The Essentials for Practicing Calming-and-Insight and Dhyāna Meditation* (修習止觀坐禪法要 / T46.1915.462–475)
4. *The Six Gates to the Sublime* (六妙法門 / T46.1917.549–555)

Of the above four texts, this translation is the third. (I have also translated the fourth and am publishing it under separate cover.)

The Circumstances Occasioning the Writing of this Text

The immediate personal cause for the writing of this text was Master Zhiyi's desire to produce a simple but comprehensive meditation text to help his brother break through life-threatening karmic obstacles.

The larger cause for writing this text was the wish to introduce a short and easily understood foundational meditation manual clarifying right meditation practice for wider use among Buddhist practitioners. This was done at a time still early in the history of Buddhism in China when right meditation practice was not always well understood by students of Dharma and when instruction in meditation was not universally available. Although deep understanding of meditation practice was probably quite common among the learned monastic elites, short, clear, and comprehensive texts addressing the needs of the larger Buddhist community were rare.

Primary Doctrinal Focus of this Text

The terms I render in the title and throughout the text as "calming-and-insight" are the standard Buddhist technical terms describing the primary aspects of traditional Indian Buddhist meditation (Sanskrit: *śamatha-vipaśyanā*; Pali: *samatha-vipassanā*). Modern Tibetan-tradition translations commonly render these primary meditation practice elements with such terms as "calm abiding and special insight" (*zhi gnas*, *lhag mthong*). Southern-tradition translations commonly refer to the former as "calming meditation" or "*samatha* meditation" (often linking it to

breath-focused meditation or *ānāpāna*), while identifying the latter as "insight," "insight meditation," or "vipassana meditation."

Given this common ground as a point of reference, we may realize that this short work provides training in the bases for correct understanding and practice of the most standard form of meditation common to all Buddhist traditions. This work is in no way a text devoted to uniquely Sino-Buddhist forms of meditation. The roots of all teachings presented in *Essentials* are standard in classic Indian Buddhism. Although it would be easy enough to demonstrate how calming-and-contemplation meditation is fundamentally no different from Bodhidharma's Ch'an meditation (Sanskrit: *dhyāna*; Korean: *son*; Japanese: *zen*), this work not only does not teach "Ch'an" *per se*, it does not even mention it.

The Structure of the Text

I have included the preface written by the Song dynasty monk, Yuanzhao, half a millennium after Master Zhiyi passed on because it so well describes the text's content and significance.

The *Essentials* text proper begins with a brief prefatory discussion by Master Zhiyi himself in which he emphasizes the importance of balanced calming-and-insight practice which does not favor the stillness of "calming" over the development of wisdom realizations through analytic "insight" and does not favor "insight" over "calming." He compares the two primary elements of meditation practice to the two wheels of a cart or the two wings of a bird, two cases wherein "imbalance" is clearly untenable.

Master Zhiyi then segues into the text proper by listing the ten chapter titles. The chapters are arranged in a practical sequence proceeding from preliminaries to actual practice to important related topics. I now provide a brief content synopsis for each chapter:

Chapter One: "Fulfillment of Prerequisite Conditions." The concerns here are the prerequisite needs of: moral virtue and purification of bad karma; adequacy of clothing, food, and domicile; withdrawal from involvements; and proximity to spiritual guidance from a genuinely reliable source.

Chapter Two: "Renunciation of Desires." The topic here is facilitating focused meditation practice by withdrawal from the distractions inherent in attachment to sense-object data comprised by visual forms, sounds, smells, tastes, and touchables.

Chapter Three: "Elimination of the Hindrances." The five hindrances discussed are: desire in the mind for the aforementioned sense objects; ill-will; "lethargy-and-sleepiness"; "excitedness-and-regretfulness"; and afflicted doubt in self, guru, or Dharma.

Chapter Four: "Making Adjustments." The primary topics here are: a) the necessary adjustments to food and sleep when not actually seated in meditation; and b) the appropriate adjustments in body, breath, and mind when entering meditation, abiding in meditation, and emerging from meditation.

Chapter Five: "Implementation of Skillful Means." This is a very brief discussion of five essential factors as they apply to the practice of meditation, namely: zeal, vigor, mindfulness, wise discernment, and single-mindedness.

Chapter Six: "The Actual Cultivation." This very detailed chapter goes directly into the practice of calming-and-insight, giving particular focus to: countering mental coarseness and scatteredness; countering "sinking" and "floating" mind states; applying either calming or insight as best suited to exigent circumstances; countering "subtle" mind states conducing to attachment; and using calming-and-insight to achieve balance between meditative absorption and wisdom. Instruction is provided regarding the use of calming-and-contemplation at the gates of each of the sense gates of eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and intellectual mind and also while sitting, standing, walking, lying down, talking, and doing things.

Chapter Seven: "Manifestation of Roots of Goodness." This chapter primarily covers mind states arising in meditation as effects from specific types of prior spiritual cultivation, in particular: cultivation of the internal energetics of meditation; contemplation of impurity; cultivation of kindness; contemplation of causality, cultivation of mindfulness of the Buddha. It then deals with the issue of distinguishing between signs of false meditative absorptions and signs of genuine meditative absorptions. The chapter concludes with an exhortation to pursue the establishment of yet more good karmic causes productive of auspicious future karmic effects.

Chapter Eight: "Recognition of the Work of Demons." This chapter deals with a topic little discussed in Western Buddhist circles, that of "demons," phenomena dismissed by many as ancient superstition. Here, the various categories of problematic ghosts, spirits, and demon-generated afflictions are catalogued along with the means of driving them away through calming, through insight, through rectification of mind, through mantras, through repentances, through precept recitation, through uncompromising ongoing karmic correctness, and through assistance of the guru.

Chapter Nine: "Treatment of Disorders." This chapter deals with traditional means of countering physical and mental disturbances arising through karmic obstacles or unskillful meditation practice.

Chapter Ten: "Realization of the Fruits." The concerns here are in distinguishing between provisional and ultimate contemplations while also describing the nature of the high-level, later-stage meditation practice of those well advanced on the path to buddhahood. The discussion concludes with a clear statement of essential prerequisites for success in meditation practice.

Special Aspects of This Text

In reflecting on the matter, I have noticed that this particular work by Master Zhiyi possesses a number of important special aspects making it unique among Buddhist meditation texts so far available in English translation, among which are the following:

First, unlike most works dealing with calming-and-insight, even though its teachings are for the most part independent of any particular tradition, the doctrinal framing of this text is distinctly mahāyānistic. By this, I mean to say that the tenor of its discussions more-or-less assume that all practice is carried out in the context of the altruistic path devoted to universal spiritual liberation.

Concrete manifestations of this "mahāyānistic orientation" are found in a few of the teachings found in *The Essentials*. For instance: a) In the chapter on the prerequisites as it relates to purification of negative karma through repentances; b) In the chapter on dealing with demons, specifically in the recommendation of mantras as means to counter negative influences; and c) In the chapter on realization of the fruits of practice, specifically as regards distinguishing what is and is not an "ultimate" contemplation.

Second, this text also seems to be unique among meditation texts found in English translation in the unusual comprehensiveness of the topics it covers. That is to say, it does not simply describe the details of how to meditate. Rather it deals with everything of genuine importance related to the practice of meditation. Examples of these crucial related issues include specific instructions on:

1. Fulfilling crucial prerequisite conditions which are essential to entering deep meditation states.
2. Eliminating the five hindrances blocking all meaningful progress in cultivating meditation.
3. Making essential adjustments to food, sleep, body, breath, and mind.
4. Dealing with unbalanced development of calming (*śamatha*) versus insight (*vipaśyanā*) so as to ensure acquisition of not just meditative absorption, but also genuine wisdom.
5. Countering "floating" mind states and "sinking" mind states blocking entry into meditative absorption.
6. Distinguishing between false and deceptive meditation states leading away from the Path and genuinely beneficial meditation states serving progress on the Path.
7. Countering various types of meditation sickness and negative spiritual influences commonly encountered in the cultivation of meditative absorption.

Third, *The Essentials* may also be unique in describing "insight" (*vipaśyanā*) at the highest level of realization of emptiness of all encountered phenomena at each of the six sense gates and in all circumstances, whether walking, sitting, standing, lying down, doing things, or talking, while describing "calming" (*śamatha*) at the highest level of realization wherein cognition of reality silences discursive thought and enforces deep wakeful serenity.

As a side note, reflection on the above-mentioned definitions of "calming" and "insight" makes the rationale behind classic Chinese "Ch'an" practice much easier to grasp for those heretofore inured to more classic dogmas of what is and is not calming-and-insight meditation. In short, reflecting on this, one realizes that Ch'an practice is a radically direct methodology for achieving the very same aims of calming-and-contemplation and is no different from calming-and-insight practice. When correctly understood and practiced, Bodhidharma's Ch'an meditation precipitates and enforces both complete "calming" and complete "insight."

Having first studied the present text, the identity of Ch'an practice with the other more widely recognized traditions of Indian Buddhist meditation becomes yet more obvious when one proceeds next to study Master Zhiyi's other short meditation text, *The Six Gates to the Sublime* which is also devoted to explaining a classic approach of early Indian Buddhist meditation practice.

Stylistic Factors Affecting this Translation

Although I don't doubt there is room to improve the smoothness of this translation even while retaining precise accuracy, there nonetheless are some stylistic limitations and circumlocutional prolixity imposed by my default

insistence on strictly literal translation. Also, the translation style may seem archaic or formal. This is for the most part because the Chinese text itself is written in a somewhat archaic and formal style.

Although many outline headings originate with Master Baojing's outline of the text, most of the numerous and detailed outline headings found in the English translation originate with the translator. (These are enclosed in brackets.) I inserted these additional headings because I feel that complex texts are made much more accessible to the English reader through introduction of more detailed outlining. I do not pretend my structural analysis of the text is infallible. There is probably room for improvement in the outline as presented in "Directory to Chapter Subsections" and as interwoven with the translated text.

In Summation

I first produced a preliminary draft of this translation in 1992 and, owing to the importance of the work, I have allowed various copyrighted provisional drafts to be posted on the Kalavinka internet websites since then. Because the present version of the translation is immensely improved in accuracy over previous versions, it should in all cases be preferred as the definitive edition. It gives me great pleasure to be able to introduce such a potentially beneficial meditation text into the world of Western Buddhism, not least because confusion about right meditation practice is still so very widespread.

I would like to express particular gratitude to those who have reviewed the Chinese and English of the text, pointing out problems in earlier drafts of this work.

Due to the terseness of the language and the abstruseness of the concepts and practices treated, it is likely that there will be room for further refinement of aspects of this translation. I hope that specialists or practitioners encountering errors or infelicities will favor me with recommendations for improvement, forwarding such suggestions via the Kalavinka websites.

I especially hope that Buddhist practitioners may find this text useful in development of meditation practice and in advancement on the Path.

Bhikshu Dharmamitra
Seattle, New Year's Day, 2008

The Essentials
of
Buddhist Meditation

Tiantai Master Zhiyi's Classic Meditation Manual:

The Essentials for Practicing
Calming-and-Insight & Dhyāna Meditation

English Translation by Bhikshu Dharmamitra

The Yuanzhao Preface

By the Song Dynasty Monk, Yuanzhao (釋元照: 1048–1116 CE)

There are four calming-and-insight texts in the Tiantai tradition: The first, known as the "perfect and sudden," was presented in the form of lectures by the Great Master at Yuquan ("Jade Spring") Monastery in Jingzhou Prefecture. Zhang'an (章安) transcribed it in ten fascicles.

The second, known as the "gradual and sequential," was lectured at Waguan ("Tiled House") Monastery. Disciple Fashen (法慎) transcribed it. Originally comprising thirty fascicles, Zhang'an edited it into ten fascicles. It is what is known today as the *Dhyāna Pāramitā*.

The third, known as the "unfixed," is the one which the Chen Dynasty Chief State Secretary (尚書令), Maoxi (毛喜), requested the Great Master to issue. It consists of a single fascicle known today as the *Six Gates to the Sublime*.

The fourth, known as the *Smaller Calming-and-Insight*, is this very text. The Great Master brought it forth for his elder brother, Chenzhen. Truly, this is a condensation of the large edition and a presentation of the very crux of the means for entering the Path.

As for what is described as "calming-and-insight," or as "meditative absorption and wisdom," or as "quiescence and illumination," or as "luminous clarity and stillness"—these are all instances of different designations describing the very same concepts.

Now, as for what reaches to the very bottom of the myriad dharmas' source and permits one to directly verify the cultivation and realization of the Buddhas, none compare to calming-and-insight. And as for what the Great Master of the Tiantai tradition personally received at Mount Gṛdhrakūṭa—he received calming-andinsight. As for the marvelous awakening of the great arousing, it is the awakening to calming-and-insight. As for what is cultivated in samādhi, it is calming-and-insight. As for what is described when eloquence is allowed to flourish, it is calming-and-insight.

Therefore, one may say that, when it comes to explicating those Dharma gateways of one's own mind which are practiced, although the texts of the Tiantai teaching tradition are elaborate and numerous, one should realize that the essentials to which they return do not go beyond calming-and-insight.

Were one to stray from calming-and-insight, one's abilities would be inadequate to clearly understand the Path as described in the Tiantai tradition and would be inadequate to even discuss the meaning of the Tiantai tradition's teachings. Therefore, one who would enter the Path simply cannot fail to study [calming-andinsight]. One who would study it cannot fail to cultivate it. How then could one, like the shallow learners of a decadent age, merely chase after reputation and profit, course in rigid attachments to mere designations, or indulge muddled relishing of only the dimmest sorts of meditative realizations?

Although the texts devoted to it remain extant, still, the path of calming-and-insight is but little heard of in the World these days. On realizing this, is it even possible to not experience an aching heart and pain-filled mind?

I write this preface now on the occasion of commissioning the carving of new woodblocks for the printing of this text. May this event cause all who hear it explained or lay eyes on it to plant the seeds of causal affinity with the Great Vehicle. How much the more so might this be the case where there are those who cultivate according to it or gain realizations based on it? Were this to occur, could the benefits issuing from it even be measurable?

Since I had to proofread this work [prior to releasing it for printing], I took that as an occasion to write this preface.

Preface by the Shakyan monk, Yuanzhao.

Composed in Yuhang Prefecture, in the second year of the Shaosheng reign period (1096 CE), on the first day of autumn's second lunar month.

Tiantai Master Zhiyi's Preface

I. Introductory Section

A. Citing a Quatrain to Indicate the Grand Design

To refrain from doing any manner of evil,
To respectfully perform all varieties of good,
To carry out the purification of one's own mind—
It is this which constitutes the teaching of all Buddhas.[1]

B. Introduction Proper: Conditions Occasioning Creation of This Text

1. Brief Indication of the Essential Nature of Calming and Insight

As for the dharma of nirvāṇa, there are many paths of entry into it. However, if we discuss those which are crucially essential, they do not go beyond the two dharmas of calming and insight.

2. Commendation of the Marvelous Functions of Calming and Insight

How is this so? Calming (*śamatha*) constitutes the initial method through which one is able to suppress the fetters (*saṃyojana*).[2] Insight (*vipaśyanā*) is the primary essential through which one is able to cut off the delusions. Calming then is the wholesome provision with which one kindly nurtures the mind and consciousness. Insight then is the marvelous technique which stimulates the development of spiritual understanding. Calming is the supreme cause for the manifestation of dhyāna absorption. Insight is the origin of wisdom.

3. Clarification of the Supreme Benefits of Calming and Insight

a. Clarification Proper

If a person perfects the two dharmas of meditative absorption and wisdom, then this amounts to the complete fulfillment of the dharma of benefiting both oneself and others.

b. Scriptural Citation

Hence the *Dharma Blossom Sutra* states, "The Buddha himself abides in the Great Vehicle. Such dharmas as he has realized are adorned by the power of meditative absorption and wisdom. He employs these in delivering beings to liberation."[2]

4. Undesirable Aspects of Inequality in Calming and Insight

a. Explanation Proper

One should realize that these two dharmas are like the two wheels of a cart or like the two wings of a bird. If the cultivation of them becomes one-sided, one immediately falls into error-ridden inverted views.

b. Scriptural Citation

Hence a sutra states, "If a person is one-sided in the cultivation of dhyāna absorption and merit and thus neglects the study of wisdom, this results in delusion. If one indulges in the one-sided study of wisdom and thus neglects the cultivation of dhyāna absorption and its meritorious qualities, this results in derangement."[4]

Although there are some minor differences in the faults associated with delusion and derangement, still, the erroneous views developing from the two conditions are generally no different. If one fails to maintain even balance in this, then one's practice deviates from what would be perfect. How then could one achieve a swift ascent to the most ultimate result?

5. The Necessity of Evenly Balanced Calming and Insight

a. Scriptural Citation Illustrating Importance

Hence a sutra declares, "Because the Śrāvaka disciples are more developed in their powers of meditative absorption, they are unable to perceive the buddha nature. The bodhisattvas abiding on the ten grounds (*bhūmi*) are more developed in the power of wisdom. Although they do perceive the buddha nature, still, that perception has not developed into complete clarity. The powers of meditative absorption and wisdom are equally developed in the Buddhas, the Tathāgatas. Consequently, they possess absolute understanding and perception of the buddha nature."[5]

Extrapolating from this, how could calming-and-insight not constitute the essential entryway into the great result of nirvāṇa, the supreme path for the cultivation of the practitioner, the common point of confluence for perfect fulfillment of the manifold virtues, and the very substance of the unsurpassed and ultimate result?

b. Clarifying the Rationale in This Explanation of Calming-and-insight

If one understands accordingly, then one will understand that this Dharma entryway of calming-and-insight is truly not a shallow one. When one wishes to draw in and lead along those who have only just begun to study—when one

wishes to instruct the untutored and muddle-headed that they might advance onto the Path—it is easy to discourse on the subject, but difficult for them to implement the practice. How then could one justify launching into extensive discussions of the abstruse and marvelous?

II. The Doctrine Proper

A. Ten Calming-and-Insight Concepts with Encouragement and Cautioning

1. Encouragement

We shall now offer a general explanation of ten concepts in order to reveal to the novice practitioner the steps traversed in ascending along the orthodox Path as well as the stages involved in progressing toward entry into nirvāṇa. The investigator should adopt appropriate humility with regard to the difficulty of succeeding in cultivation and thus should not demean this text's shallowness and ready accessibility.

2. Offering Cautionary Advice

If one's mind correctly gauges the import of these words, then, in the blink of an eye, one's qualities of wisdom and severance will become so great as to defy measurement and one's spiritual understanding will become unfathomably deep.

If, however, one disingenuously seizes on passages out of context or, due to personal sentiments, distorts the instructions of the text, then the months and years will be needlessly drawn out while actual realization will have no basis for development. One's circumstance then would be like that of the pauper who spends his time calculating the wealth of other men. What possible benefit could this have for oneself?

3. Listing Sections and Revealing Their Aims

a. Listing Section Titles

First:	Fulfillment of Prerequisite Conditions
Second:	Renunciation of Desires
Third:	Elimination of the Hindrances
Fourth:	Making Adjustments
Fifth:	Implementation of Skillful Means
Sixth:	The Actual Cultivation
Seventh:	Manifestation of [Roots of] Goodness
Eighth:	Recognition of the Work of Demons
Ninth:	Treatment of Disorders
Tenth:	Realization of the Fruits

b. Clarifying the Aim of the Sections

Now, we shall briefly treat these ten concepts in order to instruct the practitioner of calming-and-insight. These are crucial essentials for the beginner's training in sitting meditation. If one is well able to grasp their intent and thus proceed to cultivate them, one will be able to settle the mind, avoid difficulties, manifest meditative absorption, develop understanding, and achieve realization of the non-outflow fruits of the Ārya.

Chapter One

Fulfillment of the Prerequisite Conditions

B. The Actual Exposition of the Ten Sections

1. Section One: Fulfillment of the Five Conditions

a. Observing Precepts Purely

1) Generally Clarifying Essentials of Precept Observance

Now, one who has resolved to begin practice and who desires to cultivate calming-and-insight must first fulfill five conditions related to outward circumstances. The first is the requirement that one maintain purity in practice of the moral precepts. This is as stated in a sutra: "It is in dependence upon and because of these moral precepts that one succeeds in developing the dhyāna absorptions as well as the wisdom which puts an end to suffering. Therefore the bhikshu should be pure in upholding the precepts."[1]

2) Specific Explanation of Features of Three Precept-Observance Levels

a) Superior Level of Precept Observance

In this regard, there are three classes of practitioners according to differences in the upholding of precepts.

The first is as follows: Prior to becoming a disciple of the Buddha [this practitioner] did not commit any of the five relentless (*ānantarya*) transgressions.[2] Later he encountered a good master who taught him to accept the Three Refuges and the five precepts, whereby he became a disciple of the Buddha. If he succeeded in leaving the home life, he first took on the ten precepts of the *śrāmaṇera* and then later received the complete precepts, thereby becoming a bhikshu or, [in the case of a woman], a bhikshuni. From the time of first taking precepts, he has been pure in guarding and upholding them and thus has been entirely free of transgressions.

In the upholding of the precepts, this person is of the superior grade. One should understand that in cultivating calming-andinsight, such a person will certainly achieve realization in those dharmas of the Buddha. Such a person may be likened to a robe which is perfectly clean and which thus will easily absorb the appropriate dye.

b) Middling Level of Precept Observance

In the case of the second, after having received the precepts, although there have been no transgressions of the major precepts, still there has been much damage done to the minor prohibitions. If for the sake of cultivating meditative absorption, such a person is able forthwith to carry out repentance in a manner prescribed by Dharma, he too may qualify as one whose upholding of the precepts is pure and he, too shall be able to develop meditative absorption and wisdom. Such an individual may be compared to a robe which, although once soiled, has nonetheless been entirely cleaned such that dye will take in this case as well.

c) Inferior Level of Precept Observance

i) Repentance According to Methods of the Great Vehicle

(1) Clarification of Repentance Options in Great and Small Vehicles

In the case of the third, having received the precepts, one was unable to guard and uphold the precepts with a firm mind and thus there has been much transgression of both minor and major prohibitions. According to the approach of the Small Vehicle, there is no method whereby one may repent and be purified of transgressions against the four major monastic prohibitions. If, however, one resorts to the approach of the teachings of the Great Vehicle, there is still a means whereby these [karmic transgressions] may be extinguished.

(2) Citation of Evidence That One Who Repents Becomes a Healthy Person

Accordingly, a sutra notes: "Within the Buddha's Dharma, there are two types of healthy people: those who have committed no evil deeds whatsoever and those who, having committed them, have been able to repent of them."[3]

(3) Repentance According to Great Vehicle Methods

(a) Implementation Relying on Ten Repentance-Assisting Dharmas

Now, as for one seeking to repent, he must fulfill ten dharmas which assist the success of repentance:

First, develop a clear understanding and belief in cause-and-effect;

Second, give rise to profound fearfulness [of retribution];

Third, bring forth a deep sense of shame and dread of blame;[4]

Fourth, seek out a method to extinguish offenses. This refers to the methods of practice explained in the Great Vehicle sutras. One should cultivate them in accord with the Dharma;

Fifth, reveal and confess prior offenses;
Sixth, cut off the thought of continuing [the offenses];
Seventh, resolve to protect the Dharma;
Eighth, make the great vow to liberate beings;
Ninth, be ever mindful of all Buddhas of the ten directions;
Tenth, contemplate the nature of offenses as being unproduced.

(i) Revealing Duration of Repentance Dharma

If one is able to completely carry out these ten dharmas, one should then proceed to adorn the site for cultivating the path, bathe one's body, clothe oneself in clean robes, burn incense and scatter flowers. Then, in front of the Triple Jewel, one should carry on the practice of repentance in accord with the Dharma, doing so for one week or three weeks, or perhaps for one month or three months, or perhaps even continuing on for years during which one repents single-mindedly of the grave offenses involved in transgressing the prohibitions. One should stop only when one has succeeded in extinguishing them.

(ii) Revealing Signs Indicating Extinguishing of Offenses

How is one to recognize the signs that grave offenses have been extinguished?

It may be that, as the practitioner carries out sincere repentance in this fashion, he experiences his body and mind becoming light and pleasant, and also experiences a fine and auspicious dream.

It may be that he sees all manner of magical, auspicious, and rare signs. It may be that he becomes aware of his wholesome thoughts opening forth and developing. Or, while seated in meditation, he may become aware of his body as like a cloud or a shadow, and then, from this point on, he may gradually achieve realization of the mental states characteristic of the dhyānas.

It may be that he experiences the powerful and sudden arising of awakened thought whereby he is well able to recognize the marks of dharmas and is able to understand the meaning and connotation of whichever sutra he encounters, realizing from this Dharma bliss and a mind no longer beset by worry or regretfulness. All manner of causes and conditions such as these should be recognized as signs indicating that the path-obstructing offenses resulting from breaking the precepts have been extinguished.

(iii) Clarification: Post-repentance Precept Observance Constitutes Purity

If, from this point on, one firmly upholds the restrictive prohibitions, this too qualifies as purity in *śīla* (moral virtue). Such a practitioner may be able to cultivate dhyāna absorption. He may be likened to a torn and deeply soiled robe which one has been able to patch and wash clean enough that it becomes capable of being dyed.

(b) Repentance According to the Great Vehicle's Signlessness Principle

(i) Explanation Proper.

If a person has transgressed against one of the major prohibitions, it is to be feared that this may obstruct acquisition of dhyāna absorption. Even though he may not be able to rely upon cultivating practice methods set forth in the Sutras, still, he may simply bring forth an intense sense of shame and dread of blame, go before the Triple Jewel, confess his former offenses, and cut off any thought of continuing them. He may then take up the practice of continuously engaging in seated meditation with his body erect, contemplating the nature of offenses as empty, and remaining mindful of the Buddhas of the ten directions.

Whenever he emerges from dhyāna, he must, with sincere mind, burn incense, bow in reverence, repent, and then recite the precepts and recite the Great Vehicle sutras as well. The grave offenses which obstruct the path should naturally and gradually become extinguished. On account of this, his *śīla* becomes pure and thus dhyāna absorption may develop.

(ii) Citation of Evidence

Accordingly, the *Sutra on the Marvelous and Superior Meditative Absorption* states, "If, after a person has transgressed against a major precept, his mind becomes beset by fearfulness and he thus wishes to extinguish it, there is no other means aside from dhyāna absorption which can be successful in extinguishing it.

"In a deserted and quiet place, this person should focus his mind and engage in the practice of continuously sitting in meditation while also proceeding to recite the Great Vehicle sutras. All of the grave offenses will be entirely extinguished and each of the dhyāna absorptions will naturally manifest."[5]

b. Ensuring Adequacy of Clothing and Food

1) Clothing

a) Superior-Roots Clothing

As for the second, the requirement that clothing and food be adequate, there are three approaches with regard to clothing: The first is as exemplified by the Great Master of the Snowy Mountains[6] who happened to obtain a single

cloak adequate to cover up his body and took that to be adequate because he never encountered people and additionally had perfected the ability to endure the elements.

b) Middling-Roots Sustenance

The second category is that exemplified by Mahākāśyapa who, because he always cultivated the *dhūta* practices,[7] wore only a single three-part rag robe and accumulated no other clothing.

c) Inferior-Roots Clothing

The third category relates to countries where the weather is often cold and to individuals whose endurance abilities are not yet perfected. In these cases the Tathāgata also permitted the accumulation of a hundred and one other things aside from the three-part robe. However it was necessary to purify them verbally,[8] to refrain from being excessive, and to be satisfied with the appropriate amount. Were one to allow oneself to overindulge by being acquisitive and desirous of accumulating things, then the mind would become disrupted and they would become an obstacle to the Path.

2) Sustenance

a) Superior-Roots Sustenance

Next, as for the categories relating to food, there are four, the first of which is that exemplified by the superior man and great master who, having entirely severed relations with the world, dwells deep in the mountains, eating the native herbs and fruits according to the season, thus supplying the requirements of the body.

b) Middling-Roots Sustenance

As for the second, he always cultivates the *dhūta* practice of accepting only food which has been obtained on the alms round. Through the practice of accepting only alms food, one is able to curb four types of wrong livelihood. One relies exclusively upon right livelihood to maintain life because he is thereby able to bring forth the path of the Āryas.

As for the types of wrong livelihood, they are: first, obtaining sustenance through inferiorly-directed endeavors; second, obtaining sustenance through upwardly-directed endeavors; third, obtaining sustenance through endeavors directed at the midpoints; and fourth, obtaining sustenance through endeavors focused on the directions. The characteristics of inappropriate livelihood are as explained by Śāriputra to Śucimukhī.[9]

c) Inferior-Roots Sustenance

The third involves residing in an *araṇya* (hermitage) where a *dānapati* brings offerings of food. The fourth is where one lives among the Sangha and eats pure food. Where one has the advantage of sustenance arrangements such as these, then this is what is meant by achieving adequacy in food and clothing. Why is this? If one does not have circumstances such as these, the mind will not be at peace and thus this will act as an obstacle to the Path.

c. [Obtaining Easeful and Quiet Dwelling]

The third [among the five prerequisite conditions] requires that one find an easeful and quiet dwelling place. One who is in a state of ease is not working at doing manifold tasks and so this is what we mean when we stipulate "easeful." A "quiet" place is one in which there is no commotion whatsoever. There are three types of places where one may be able to cultivate dhyāna absorption.

1) [Remote Dwelling]

The first is deep in the mountains in a place cut off from people.

2) [*Araṇya* Dwelling]

The second is an *araṇya* dedicated to *dhūta* practices no closer than a mile or so (lit. "three or four *li*") from a village.[10] In such a case, the noise of cattle will be cut off and there will be no commotion.

3) [*Saṅghārāma* Dwelling]

The third is within the confines of a pure *saṅghārāma* (monastic dwelling) far from the residences of laypeople. All of these circumstances may serve as "easeful and quiet dwelling places."

d. [Putting Responsibilities to Rest]

The fourth [of the five prerequisite conditions] is that one put all responsibilities to rest. This involves four specific ideas:

1) [Cessation of Livelihood]

First, one must put to rest responsibilities relating to making a living and must not engage in endeavors associated with ordinary conditioned existence.

2) [Cessation of Relationships]

Second, one must put to rest all interpersonal responsibilities. One must not seek out ordinary people, friends, relatives, or acquaintances. One must cut off all endeavors involving interactions with other people.

3) [Cessation of Activities]

Third, one must put to rest all responsibilities relating to arts or crafts and must not pursue any activities involving skilled worldly trades, art, medicine, occult mantra-related activities, physiognomy, writing, accounting, making calculations, and other such matters.

4) [Cessation of Study]

Fourth, one must put to rest all responsibilities relating to learning. One must put aside reading, reciting, listening, studying, and so forth. This is what is meant by putting all responsibilities to rest. Why is this necessary? If one is involved in many responsibilities, then matters related to cultivating the Path will deteriorate. The mind will become disturbed and difficult to focus.

e. [Drawing Near to Good Spiritual Friends]

The fifth [of the five prerequisite conditions] requires that one draw near to good spiritual friends. Good spiritual friends are of three types:

1) [Externally-Protective Good Spiritual Friends]

The first is the "externally-protective" good spiritual friend who provides necessary provisions, makes offerings, and is well able to take care of the practitioner's needs, doing so in a fashion which precludes any mutual disturbance.

2) [Identical-Practice Good Spiritual Friends]

The second is the "identical-practice" good spiritual friend together with whom one cultivates a single path. Each provides the other with encouragement and inspiration while refraining from mutual bother or disturbance.

3) [Instructive Good Spiritual Friends]

The third is the "instructive" good spiritual friend who instructs and delights the practitioner with teachings about the internal and external skillful means associated with the Dharma entryway of dhyāna absorption. This is the conclusion of the summary clarification of the five kinds of necessary prerequisites.

Chapter Two

Renunciation of Desires

2. Section Two: Renunciation of Desires

a. [The Importance and Scope of Renunciation of Desire]

As for what is meant by "renunciation of desires," this refers to the five objects of sensual desire (*kāmacchanda*). When one wishes to cultivate calming-and-insight while sitting in dhyāna meditation, it is absolutely essential to renounce them. The "five desires" are the forms, sounds, smells, tastes and touchables encountered in the world. They are ever able to deceive and delude all ordinary people, causing them to develop fond attachment. If one is able to become deeply aware of the negative consequences of desires, one will not become involved with them. This is what is meant by renouncing desire.

1) [Desire for Forms]

First, the renunciation of the desire for forms refers to such forms as the stately and decorous shapes and features of men and women, including alluring eyes, long eyebrows, red lips, and white teeth, as well as things regarded in the world as precious. It also includes colors such as blue, yellow, red, white, vermilion, purple, chartreuse, and green. All sorts of such marvelous forms are able to influence the foolish observer to develop fondness for them and consequently embark on all manner of unwholesome karmic deeds.

One example is King Bimbisāra who, on account of sexual desire, stole into a hostile kingdom and entered the quarters of Āmrapālī, the courtesan. Another is King Udayana who, corrupted by lust, hacked off the hands and feet of five hundred rishis. [Desire for forms] is possessed of all manner of negative consequences like this.

2) [Desire for Sounds]

Second, the renunciation of the desire for sounds, refers to musical sounds such as issue from harps, zithers, or flutes, and such as are created by strings, bamboo, metal, or stone, and refers also to such sounds as the voices of men and women singing, chanting, hymning, or reciting. They may influence the foolish common person who hears them to straightaway develop defiling attachment and to generate all manner of unwholesome karmic deeds.

One example of this phenomenon is the case of the five hundred rishis dwelling in the Snow Mountains who heard the singing of a *kinnara*-spirit maiden, immediately lost dhyāna absorption, and thus became mentally intoxicated and deranged.[1] On account of all sorts of reasons such as these, one should realize the negative consequences of desire for sounds.

3) [Desire for Fragrances]

Third, the renunciation of the desire for fragrances, refers to the physical scents of men and women, the fragrances of human society's food, drink and perfumes, as well as all manner of incenses and aromas. An ordinary fool does not understand the true character of fragrances and so, on smelling them, becomes fondly attached, and thus opens the door to the fetters.[2]

An example of this is the case of the bhikshu at the side of the lotus pond who smelled the fragrance of the blossoms and whose thoughts were then moved to fondness and pleasure. The pond spirit then rebuked him soundly by scolding, "Why did you steal my fragrances?"[3]

One may, on account of attachment to fragrances, stir up otherwise quiescent fetters. For all sorts of reasons like these, one should realize the negative consequences of the desire for fragrances.

4) [Desire for Flavors]

Fourth, the renunciation of the desire for flavors, refers to bitterness, sourness, sweetness, pungency, saltiness, mildness, and other such fine flavors characteristic of fine beverages and cuisine. They may be able to incite the foolish common person to develop a kind of corrupting attachment and then to consequently engage in unwholesome karma.

An example of this is the case of the *śrāmaṇera* who developed a corrupting obsession with the flavor of curds and who thus, at the conclusion of his life, was reborn in a container of curds where he took on the body of a curd worm.[4] On account of all manner of reasons such as these, one should realize the negative consequences of the desire for flavors.

5) [Desire for Touchables]

Fifth, the renunciation of the desire for touchables, refers to the softness and delicate slickness of the bodies of men

and women, to the sensations of their physical warmth when it is cold, their physical coolness when it is hot, as well as to all other pleasant tactile contacts. The foolish person, lacking in wisdom, is submerged by them and thus generates karma blocking progress along the Path.

An example of this was the one-horned rishi who, on account of indulging the desire for physical contact, lost the superknowledges and ended up with a courtesan riding him about, mounted atop his shoulders.[5] For all manner of reasons such as these, one should realize the negative consequences of the desire for touchables.

b. [Scriptural Citations]

The dharma of renouncing desire as treated above is drawn from the discussion in the *Mahāyāna Treatise*.[6]

It additionally states, "Alas! These beings! They are constantly harassed by the five desires and yet they continue to pursue them incessantly.

"As for these five types of desire, gaining their objects results in their becoming even more intense.

"They are like fire which, when stoked with more firewood, burns ever brighter.

"The five desires yield no happiness. [When one pursues them], one is comparable to a dog gnawing away at a dried-up bone.

"The five desires proliferate contention, just as birds skirmish over carrion.

"The five desires scorch a person, just as one is burned when carrying a torch into the wind.

"The five desires bring harm to a person, just as when one treads upon a poisonous snake.

"Like bounty gained in a dream, the five desires have nothing real about them.

"[The pleasure arising from] the five desires does not endure long. It is borrowed only for a moment and is like a spark struck from a stone.

"The wise also consider them to be like enemies or thieves. The worldly person is foolish and deluded, is covetously attached to the five desires, won't relinquish them even in the face of death, and later undergoes immeasurable suffering and aggravation as a result.

"This dharma of the five desires is something people have in common with animals."[7]

All beings typically act under the direction of the five desires and thus become slaves to the desires. On account of this, having become covered over by desires, they are prone to fall into the three lower realms.

[One should reflect]: "If, even as I cultivate dhyāna meditation, I revert to being obstructed and covered over by them, then I am a great thief. I must urgently distance myself from them."

As stated in verses from the *Dhyāna Sutra*:

That birth and death are not cut off
Is on account of desire and fondness for its flavor.
As when nursing a grudge all the way to the grave,
One endures in vain all manner of bitter suffering.

The smell of the body is like that of a corpse.
Impurities stream forth from its nine apertures.
Just as worms in an outhouse delight in the feces,
So too does the foolish man delight in the body.

The one who is wise should contemplate the body,
And not lust after the tainted pleasures of the world.
To be without burdens and to have nothing desired—
This is what qualifies as true nirvāṇa.

It's just as described by the Buddhas themselves:
Practicing with one mind and singular intention,
While counting the breath in dhyāna absorption—
It is this which is the practice of the *dhūtas* (ascetic practices).[8]

Chapter Three

Elimination of the Hindrances

3. Section Three: Elimination of the Hindrances

As for "elimination of the hindrances," it refers to the five hindrances (*nīvaraṇa*, *āvaraṇa*).[1]

a. [The Hindrance of Desire]

The first involves the eliminating of the hindrance of sensual desire (*kāmachanda*). Earlier, we discussed the outward arising of desire with respect to the five sense objects. Now we are concerned with the inward arising of desire in the intellectual mind faculty. This refers to instances where the practitioner is seated upright, cultivating dhyāna meditation, and his mind generates continuously, one after another, desire-based ideations which cover over the wholesome mind,preventing it from developing. When one realizes that this is occurring, one should eliminate [such ideation].

Why should he do so? If, as in the case of Śubhakara,[2] the internal arising of the lustful mind is able even to burn the body, how could it be that all wholesome dharmas would not be burned up as well when the mind generates the fire of desire? Persons possessed by desire are extremely far away from the Path.[3] How is this so? Desire is the dwelling place of all manner of affliction-based disturbances. If the mind becomes attached and beset by desire, there is no way for one to grow near to the Path. This is as explained in "Verse on Eliminating the Hindrances":

The person knowing shame and blame who's entered the Path
Takes up his bowl and provides merit for beings.
How could one give free reign to desire for sense objects
And become immersed in the five senses?

Having already renounced the pleasures of the five desires,
One has cast them off and does not look back.
Why would one still desire to gain them,
Like a fool who laps up his own vomit?

All desires are suffering at the time they are sought.
When gained, one is usually fearful [of losing them].
On losing them, one experiences burning aggravation.
At every point there's nowhere where pleasure abides.

Given that desires are so attended by troubles,
How might one be able to relinquish them?
If one but gains the bliss of deep dhyāna absorption,
One will then no longer be subject to their deception.

b. [The Hindrance of Ill Will]

The second is the elimination of the hindrance of ill will (*vyāpāda*). Ill will is the basis for losing the Buddha Dharma, a cause and condition for falling into the wretched destinies,[4] the nemesis of Dharma bliss, the great thief which preys on the wholesome mind, and the repository of all manner of abusive speech.

Accordingly, when the practitioner is sitting in dhyāna meditation, he might think to himself, "This fellow is now tormenting me. What's more, he torments my relatives and praises my adversaries." Continuing, he might think, "It's been like this in the past as well, and it will continue to be so in the future. This amounts to a ninefold torment."

Consequently, he might become full of ill will and, based upon that ill will, he might begin to cherish animosity. On account of generating animosity, he might then think to torment the other individual. In this fashion, ill will serves to cover over the mind and, for this reason, [this "hindrance" is also] referred to as a "covering." One should proceed urgently to eliminate it and should not allow it to proliferate. This is as illustrated by Śakra Devānām Indra's query which he posed to the Buddha in verse:

What thing is it which, killed, brings peace and brings bliss?

What thing is it which, slain, brings freedom from worry?
What thing is it which is the root of venomousness,
And which devours and destroys all forms of goodness?

The Buddha responded, speaking in verse:

If one kills anger (*krodha*), one becomes peaceful and happy.
If one slays anger, one becomes free of one's worries.
It is anger which is the root of venomousness.
It is anger which destroys all forms of goodness.[5]

Having realized this, one should cultivate kindness and patience as the means to dispel anger so that the mind may become pure.

c. [The Hindrance of Lethargy-and-Sleepiness]

Third, eliminating the hindrance of lethargy-and-sleepiness (*styānamiddha*).[6] "Lethargy" (*styāna*) refers to a dullness and dimness of the subjective mental processes, whereas "sleepiness" (*middha*) refers to the state in which the five sense faculties are so covered over by dimness that the control of the limbs is relinquished and one curls up and sleeps soundly. It is for this reason that [this "hindrance" is also] referred to as the "covering" of sleep.

It is capable of destroying the mind intent on Dharma which generates genuine bliss in this and later lives and is also capable of destroying the bliss derived in later lives from rebirth in the heavens and the realization of nirvāṇa. An unwholesome dharma such as this is the very worst. How is this so? Unlike the mental states associated with the other hindrances which may be expelled simply by becoming aware of their presence, sleep is like being dead in that an aware state of consciousness is no longer present. Because one is not abiding in a state of awareness, this remains a difficult thing to eliminate.

This is as described in a verse employed by buddhas and bodhisattvas to reprimand somnolent disciples:

Get up! Don't lie there hugging that stinking corpse.
It's but various impurities falsely designated as a "person."
It's as if you've gotten a serious disease or been shot by an arrow.
With such an accumulation of suffering and pain, how could you sleep?

[The entire world is burned up by the fire of death.
When you should be seeking to escape, how could you sleep?][7]
You're like a man in shackles being led to his execution.
With disastrous harm so imminent, how could you sleep?

The thieves of the fetters haven't been destroyed and their harm has not yet been eliminated.
It's as if one were sharing a room with a venomous serpent.
It's also as if one were entering a battle's gauntlet of swords.
What would you do then? How could you sleep?

Sleep amounts to a vast darkness where one can't see anything.
Every day it deceives and steals away a person's clarity.
Because sleep covers over the mind, one can't see anything.
As it has such great drawbacks, how could you sleep?

For all manner of reasons such as these, one remonstrates against the hindrance of sleepiness. One becomes alarmed by and awakened to impermanence, pares down one's need for sleep and prevents oneself from being covered over by its dullness. If the mind becomes severely afflicted with dullness and sleep, one should resort to a dhyāna wake-up device or staff to get rid of them.[8]

d. [The Hindrance of Excitedness-and-Regretfulness]

The fourth, eliminating the hindrance of excitedness-and-regretfulness (*auddhatya-kaukṛtya*).[9]

1) [Excitedness]

As for excitedness itself (*auddhatya*), there are three types:

a) [Physical Excitedness]

The first is physical excitedness which is characterized by the body's habitual enjoyment of wandering about engaging in all manner of foolishness while having no ability to feel even momentarily peaceful when sitting down.

b) [Verbal Excitedness]

The second type is verbal excitedness which is characterized by the habitual enjoyment of singing, chanting, disputation over rights and wrongs, useless and frivolous discourse, the discussion of worldly matters, and so forth.

c) [Mental Excitedness]

The third type is mental excitedness. Here, one's mental inclination is towards neglectfulness and towards indulging the mind in its manipulation of circumstances. This may involve musing over literature, the arts, worldly talents and artisanship, as well as all manner of unwholesome ideation and discursive thought. These are characteristic features of mental excitedness.

The function of excitedness as a dharma is to destroy the mind of the monastic. Even if a person strives to focus his thoughts, he might still be unable to develop meditative absorption, how much the less so if he falls prey to excitedness and scatteredness. Someone under the influence of excitedness and scatteredness is like a drunken elephant unrestrained by the trainer's hook and like a camel without a nose ring. None of these are subject to control or discipline. This is as described in a verse:

You've already shaved your head and donned the dyed robe.
Taking up the clay bowl, you go out on the alms round.
How then can you delight in and be attached to dharmas of frivolity and excitedness?
Being neglectful and giving rein to your inclinations, you lose the benefits of Dharma.[10]

Since one loses the benefits of Dharma, one loses worldly bliss as well. Having realized one's errors, one should strive with urgency to eliminate [the excitedness hindrance].

2) [Regretfulness]

As for regretfulness (*kaukṛtya*), it is regretfulness itself which brings about the creation of a hindrance in this context. If one merely experiences instances of excitedness in which there is no operative regretfulness, this situation is not one wherein a [true] hindrance has been created. How is this the case? It is because at such times of experiencing excitedness [pure and simple], one may not yet have become involved in objective conditions. However, later, when one is desirous of entering meditative absorption, one may then experience regretfulness over what one may actually have done. Then worry-based afflictions cover over the mind. It is on account of this that there is the creation of a "covering" [hindrance].

a) [Two Types of Regretfulness]

Regretfulness itself is of two types. The first is regretfulness which arises as a consequence of excitedness as explained above. The second is exemplified by the person who has committed a major and severe offense and who thus constantly experiences feelings of fearfulness. The arrow of regretfulness has entered his mind and has become stuck so firmly that it can not be pulled out. This is as described in a verse:

Through having done what one shouldn't have done,
Or through having failed to do what one should have done,
One is burned by the fire of the regretfulness affliction,
And, in a later life, falls into the wretched destinies.

If a person is able to feel regret for an offense,
Then, having regretted it, he should not continue to feel troubled.
In this way, the mind can be peaceful and happy.
One should not constantly seize upon it through recollection.

If one possesses either of the two kinds of regretfulness,
Whether it be over having failed to do what one should have done,
Or over having done what one should not have done,
This is the mark of a stupid person.

It is not the case that, on account of being regretful,
One will somehow be able to do what one failed to do.
All of the ill deeds which one has already committed
Can't be caused thereby to become undone.[11]

e. [The Hindrance of Doubt]

Fifth, eliminating the hindrance of doubt. Because doubt covers over the mind, one is unable to develop faith in any dharma. Because one has no mind of faith, one encounters the Buddha's Dharma in vain and gains nothing from it. This is analogous to a man's entering into a mountain of jewels. If he has no hands, he is unable to acquire anything

at all.

This being the case, the faults of doubt are extremely numerous. Still, they need not necessarily obstruct the acquisition of meditative absorption. Now, as for those sorts of doubt which may directly obstruct meditative absorption, they are of three types:

1) [Doubt in Oneself]

The first is where one doubts oneself and thus thinks to himself, "All of my faculties are all dim and dull. The defilement from my previous offenses is deep and severe. Could it be that I'm not the man for this?" If one indulges in creating these doubts, then the dharma of meditative absorption will never be able to manifest. If one desires to cultivate meditative absorption, one must not slight oneself, for it is difficult to fathom the extent of one's roots of goodness planted in former lifetimes.

2) [Doubt in One's Guru]

The second type of doubt is that wherein one doubts one's own guru, thinking, "If his deportment and appearance are such as this, he must not have any realization of the Path. How then could he be able to teach me?" If one develops such doubting arrogance, then it constitutes an obstruction to meditative absorption.

A method for one wishing to be rid of this [hindrance] is mentioned in the *Mahāyāna Treatise*: "This is comparable to when gold is encased in a smelly leather pouch."[12] Because one wishes to possess the gold, one can't just pitch out the smelly pouch. The practitioner's situation may be just like this. Although the guru may not be immaculate, still, one should look upon him as one would look upon the Buddha.

3) [Doubt in the Dharma]

The third type of doubt is that wherein one doubts the Dharma. Worldly people are usually attached to their own ideas and thus are not able to immediately believe the Dharma which they have received, thus accepting it and cultivating it with a respectful mind. If the mind becomes hesitant, then, even though one has immediate exposure to the Dharma, it makes no imprint on the mind. Why is this the case? It is because doubt hinders it. The concept is as described in a verse:

It's just as when a person stands at a fork in the road
And is so deluded by doubt that he goes nowhere at all.
In relation to [fathoming] the true character of dharmas,
Doubt functions in precisely the very same way.

Because one has doubts, one doesn't diligently seek
[Realization of] the true character of dharmas.
View-filled doubts arise from delusion.
Among all of the ills, they are the very worst.

As for good versus unwholesome dharmas,
[The dharmas of] birth-and-death and nirvāṇa,
And dharmas which are definitely genuine and truly valid,
One must not indulge any doubts about them.

If you cherish the delusion of doubt,
The King of Death's hell messengers will tie you up.
Just as when a lion pounces on a deer,
You'll be unable then to achieve liberation.

Although whilst living in the world, one may have one's doubts,
One should still happily accord with wholesome dharmas,
Just as when one contemplates a fork in the road,
One should follow that path which is most beneficial.[13]

In the Dharma of the Buddha, it is through faith that one gains entry. If one has no faith, then, although in the presence of the Buddha's Dharma, he will finally gain nothing whatsoever from it. Based on all sorts of reasons such as these, one realizes the faults inhering in doubtfulness. Thus one should urgently strive to eliminate it.

f. [Question: Why Only Get Rid of Five?]

Question: Unwholesome dharmas are vast in number and the sense objects are countless. Why is it that one must only get rid of five dharmas?

1) [Reply: All Are Subsumed]

Reply: These five hindrances basically take four dharmas as their foundation, namely the three poisons as well as instances of "equaldistribution" [in relation to those three poisons.] These in turn subsume all eighty-four thousand points of entry into toilsome involvement with sense objects. First, the hindrance of desire is just synonymous with the poison of desire. Second, the hindrance of ill will is just synonymous with the poison of anger. Third, the two categories of dharmas consisting of lethargy-and-sleepiness and doubtfulness are just synonymous with the poison of delusion. The fourth is excitedness-and-regretfulness. It belongs to the "equaldistribution" category.

Together, these constitute the four categories of afflictions. In each of them, there are twenty-one thousand. In all four of them, there are collectively a total of eighty-four thousand. Hence, when one gets rid of these five hindrances, one thereby eliminates all unwholesome dharmas. Based on all manner of reasons such as these, the practitioner strives to eliminate the five hindrances.

g. [Benefits of Eliminating the Hindrances]

The practitioner is like a person who has gained freedom from a debt or one who has been cured of a serious disease, like a starving man arriving in a prosperous country, or like one who has been rescued safe and unharmed from a band of villains. When he eliminates these five hindrances, his mind becomes calm and secure and he feels clear, cool, and blissful.

Just as with the sun and moon which may be obscured and prevented from shining brightly by the five phenomena of smoke, dust, clouds, fog and the hand of the *asura* known as Rāhu, so it is as well with the human mind and the five "covering" hindrances.[14]

Chapter Four

Making Adjustments

4. Section Four: Making Adjustments

a. Preliminary Considerations

Now, when the practitioner first takes up the study of sitting in dhyāna meditation, as one who wishes to cultivate the Dharma of the Buddhas of the ten directions and the three periods of time, he should first make the great vows to bring all beings to liberation. In vowing to pursue the unsurpassed way of the Buddhas, he makes his mind as solid as *vajra* and resolves to be industrious and courageous to the point that he will not even spare his own life and will never retreat from his quest to perfect all buddha dharmas.

Next, seated in meditation and employing right mindfulness, he deliberates on the true character of dharmas. These include those dharmas commonly referred to as: wholesome, unwholesome and karmically neutral; the inward and outward sense faculties and sense objects; the error-ridden consciousnesses; and all of the dharmas associated with outflow-impurities and afflictions. They also include the conditioned dharmas throughout the three realms and the dharmas of cause-and-effect associated with cyclic births and deaths. [He observes that] they all exist solely on the basis of mind.

Accordingly, the *Sutra on the Ten Grounds* states, "Throughout the three realms, there is nothing else at all. It is all created solely from the mind."[1] If one realizes that mind is devoid of [any inherentlyexistent] nature, then [one realizes as well that] all dharmas are not genuinely real. If the mind becomes free of defiling attachment, then all of the karmic activity in the sphere of birth-and-death comes to a halt. After one has carried out this contemplation, he should then take up the cultivation according to the proper sequence.

What is meant by "making adjustments?" Now, to draw upon familiar subjects as analogies for this dharma, it is just as when a common potter wishes to create various sorts of vessels. He must first skillfully make adjustments in the clay such that it is neither too stiff nor too soft. Afterwards he may move to the potter's wheel.

It is also like playing the lute. One should first make adjustments to the strings, properly setting their tension. Then one may proceed to play, producing all sorts of marvelous melodies.

When the practitioner cultivates the mind, it is just the same. One must make skillful adjustments in five different matters and must make those adjustments appropriately. Then samādhi will develop easily. If there is some factor which has not been properly adjusted, then there will be all sorts of obstructive difficulties and it will be hard for roots of goodness to develop.

b. [Adjustments in Food]

First, making adjustments with respect to food. Now, as for food's function as a dharma, basically it is consumed out of a desire to supply the body so that one may advance along the Path. If one eats to the point of becoming too full, then the breathing will be strained, the body will feel stuffed, the energetic channels will not flow freely, the mental faculties will be blocked up, and, when sitting, one's thoughts will not be tranquil.

If one eats too little, the body will waste away, the mind will be too tightly strung, and mental deliberation will be unstable. Neither of these two situations is the way to the realization of meditative absorption.

If one consumes contaminated food, then it will cause a person's mind consciousness to become dull and confused. If one consumes foods which are not appropriate, then it will stimulate all sorts of dormant residual disorders to arise and will cause the four great elements to be thrown far out of balance.

This is the beginning phase of one's cultivation of meditative absorption. Thus one must be extremely careful in the way one proceeds. In this connection, we have [two] scriptural citations:

If the body is content, the Path may flourish.

If one maintains awareness of proper measure in food and drink,
If one is always happy abiding in a remote abode, and
If, with the mind stilled, one finds happiness in diligent effort—
This accords with the teachings of all buddhas.[2]

c. [Adjustments in Sleep]

The second involves adjustments in sleep. Now sleep is a matter of being covered over by a state of ignorance and

delusion. One must not give free rein to it. If one sleeps too much, one not only wastes the opportunity to cultivate the Dharma of the Āryas, but one also destroys any meditative skill. Thus one may cause the mind to be cloaked in darkness and the roots of goodness to become entirely submerged.

One should awaken to the import of impermanence, regulate and subdue sleep, cause one's spiritual energy to be clear, and one's mindful thought to be bright and pure. In this way, one will establish one's mind in the mental state of the Āryas and cause samādhi to manifest before one.

Accordingly, a sutra states, "Nor should there be any wasted time in either the first or last phases of the night. … One must not, on account of sleep, cause a lifetime to pass by emptily with nothing whatsoever achieved. One should remain mindful that the fire of impermanence burns up the entire world. Thus one should seek early on to bring about one's own deliverance. One must not indulge [a tendency to enjoy] sleep."[3]

d. [Adjustments in Body, Breath, and Mind]

The third, adjustments in the body, the fourth, adjustments in the breath, and the fifth, adjustments in the mind—these three ought to be considered together. They cannot be discussed separately. However, there are differences in technique at the beginning, middle, and end. This being the case, there are differences in their features when entering into, abiding in, and coming out of a session.

1) [Adjustments When Entering Meditation]

a) [Adjustments in the Body When Entering Meditation]

i) [Important Physical Considerations When Not Meditating]

Now, as for the physical adjustments undertaken when one first desires to enter dhyāna, there are issues of appropriateness in the physical adjustments undertaken by the cultivator wishing to enter samādhi. For instance, when one is abiding outside of meditative absorption, whether walking, standing, commencing an activity, or stopping one, whether moving or still—it is essential to be meticulously attentive in all such situations.

If one's actions are coarse and impetuous, then one's breath will become correspondingly coarse. Because the breath is coarse, then the thoughts will become scattered and difficult to register clearly. Additionally, when one returns to sitting, he will be agitated and muddled and the mind will not be tranquil or contented. Even though one's body may not be abiding in a state of meditative absorption, still, it is essential to employ one's mind to implement skillful means in a counteractive manner [preventing any such disturbance of tranquility].

ii) [Physical Adjustments When Beginning the Meditation Session]

(1) [Sitting Down]

Later, when one enters into dhyāna, it is essential to be skillful in stabilizing the body properly. When one first arrives at the sitting cushion, one must first establish oneself in the sitting location in such a manner that all is peaceful and secure so that nothing will interfere with remaining for a long time.

(2) [Arranging the Feet]

Next, one should arrange the feet correctly. If one is sitting in the half-lotus posture, one places the left foot so that it is on top of the right leg and then pulls it in so that it is close to the body proper. In doing so, one causes the toes of the left foot to become aligned with the right thigh while the toes of the right foot become aligned with the left thigh. If one wishes to sit in full lotus, one next corrects the arrangement of the right foot so that it rests atop the left leg.

(3) [Arranging Clothing]

Next, one loosens the belt on one's robe, making sure that it is straight all around and cannot fall open while one is sitting.

(4) [Arranging the Hands]

Next, one should arrange the hands. One lays the open left hand on top of the right hand so that they fit together and rest atop the left foot [in the case of half lotus]. One then draws them in toward the body so that they are centered and stable.

(5) [Consolidating the Posture]

Next, one should properly arrange the body, first making sure that the body is erect, and then seeing also that the limbs are set symmetrically, moving them back and forth as many as seven or eight times, as if massaging them into place. One must not allow the hands or feet to slip out of correct posture. Having done this, one then sits up perfectly straight, ensuring that the spine is neither slumping nor thrust forward.

(6) [Lining Up Head, Neck; Sitting Straight Up]

Next, one should straighten up the head and neck so that the nose and the navel are lined up and so that the head is not tilted to the side, held at an angle, drooped downward, or raised upward. One faces forward and remains straight.

(7) [Preparing the Breath]

(a) [Expelling the Turbid]

Next, one should expel the turbid breath. The method for expelling the breath requires that one open the mouth and release the breath while not allowing this process to be either coarse or urgent. One should make it soft and smooth as one releases the breath and sends it forth. One should imagine that, throughout the body, any blockages within the numerous energetic pathways are moved on out as one exhales.

(b) [Inhaling the Pure]

Then, one closes the mouth and inhales pure breath through the nose. One should do this up to three times. If the physical respiration is already correctly adjusted, then only once is adequate.

(8) [Lips, Tongue, Eyes, Spine]

Next, one should close the mouth such that the lips and teeth are held together while the tongue is held up against the hard palate. Then one should close the eyes only enough that they block off the light from outside. One should straighten up the body and sit upright like a stele. One cannot allow the body, the head or the four limbs to move about even slightly.

iii) [Summary]

This is the technique for making physical adjustments as one first proceeds to enter dhyāna absorption. To speak of what is most essential, being neither too loose nor too tight is the mark of correct physical adjustment.

b) [Adjustments in Breath When Entering Meditation]

Fourth, the technique for making adjustments in the breath when first entering dhyāna meditation. The breath may possess any of four characteristics: first, windy breathing; second, uneven breathing; third, normal breathing; and fourth, subtle respiration. The first three are indications of inadequate adjustment, whereas the last one is characteristic of correct adjustment.

i) [Types of Breathing]

(1) [Windy Breathing]

What is meant by "windy" breathing? When one is sitting and one senses the presence of a sound as the breath comes into and goes forth from the nose this is "windy" breathing.

(2) [Uneven Breathing]

What is meant by "uneven" breathing? When one is sitting and, even though the breath makes no sound, there is still a catching and halting such that it does not move on through, this is "uneven" breathing.

(3) [Ordinary Breathing]

What is meant by "ordinary" breathing? When one is sitting, even though the breath makes no sound and there is no catching and stopping, still, it is not subtle. This is "ordinary" breathing.

(4) [Subtle Breathing]

What is meant by "subtle" respiration? There is no sound, no catching, and no coarseness. The exhalation and inhalation of the breath are smooth and of extended duration such that they are as if still there, and yet as if they have disappeared. This circumstance supports the spirit's abiding in peacefulness and stability. One feels pleased and content. These are the marks of subtle respiration.

ii) [Effects of Each Breath Type]

If one maintains windy breathing, then one becomes scattered. If one maintains uneven breathing, then one becomes stuck. If one maintains ordinary breathing, then one becomes weary. If one maintains subtle respiration, then one enters meditative absorption.

If, when one is sitting, there occur any of the three characteristics of windy breathing, uneven breathing, or ordinary breathing, these are indications of inadequate adjustment. In a case where one applies mental effort under these circumstances, they also bring about mental disturbance and make it difficult for the mind to enter meditative absorption.

iii) [Adjustment Techniques]

If one wishes to correct them, then one should rely on three techniques: First, stabilize the mind by anchoring it below, [at the navel]; second, relax and release the body; and third, visualize the breath penetrating through to all of the pores, going forth and coming in without any obstructions whatsoever. If one makes one's mind subtle, one causes the breath to become very fine. If the breath becomes regulated, then the manifold disorders do not arise. One's mind easily enters meditative absorption.

iv) [Summary]

This constitutes the practitioner's technique for regulating the breath when first entering meditative absorption. To speak of the essentials, it is neither coarse nor "slippery."[4] This is the mark of regulated breathing.

c) [Adjustments in the Mind When Entering Meditation]

Fifth, the adjustment of the mind when first entering meditative absorption involves three concepts: first, entering;

second, abiding; and third, emerging. The first, entering, involves two ideas.

i) [Disordered Thinking]

The first is the regulation and control of disordered thinking so that one's thoughts are not allowed to run off.

ii) [Sinking, Floating, Urgency, Laxity]

As for the second, one must cause conditions involving "sinking," "floating," "laxity," and "urgency" to regain correct adjustment.

(1) [Sinking]

What constitutes the mark of "sinking"? If when one is sitting, one's mental state is murky and dim, if one doesn't remember anything, or if one's head tends to droop downward, these all constitute marks of "sinking." At such a time, one should anchor one's mindfulness at the tip of the nose and thus compel one's mind to abide in the midst of objective conditions so that there will be no breaking up and scattering of the mental focus. This technique is able to counter "sinking."

(2) [Floating]

What are the indicators of "floating"? If while one is sitting, the mind prefers to drift off and move about, if the body, too, is ill at ease, or if one brings to mind various outward objective conditions, these are all marks of "floating." It is appropriate at such a time to stabilize the mind by directing it downwards and anchoring it at the navel, thus controlling chaotic thinking. The mind then immediately abides in stability. This being the case, it is then easy to establish the mind in stillness.

To speak of the essentials, it is being neither sinking nor floating which is the mark of the regulated mind.

(3) [Urgency]

The meditating mind may also possess marks of laxity or urgency. As for the marks of the meditating mind afflicted with the "urgency" malady, they arise from a situation where one has focused the mind and has brought mindfulness to bear. Because of this, one has entered a state of meditative absorption. Based on this circumstance, [the focus of one's attention] has moved upward and brought about intense pain in the chest. One should relax and release his mental focus downward. The subtle energetic breath will then all flow on down. If one were to do this, then the disturbance would naturally be cured.

(4) [Laxity]

As for the marks of mind afflicted with the "laxity" malady, one realizes that one's mental determination has become scattered and dilatory and that one's body has tended to become slack and slumped. It may even be that there has been a flow of saliva from the mouth. At times, one may be dull and unclear. At such a time, one should draw up the body and make one's mindfulness more urgent. One should compel the mind to abide in the midst of objective conditions while compelling the body to maintain correct posture. One uses this technique to counter [laxity in] the mind.

In the event that the characteristics of being either rough or slippery manifest, if one infers from this, [the appropriate corrective actions] will become obvious. These constitute the techniques for regulating the mind when one first enters meditative absorption.

2) [Summary of Entry-Related Issues]

Now, entering meditative absorption is fundamentally a process wherein one proceeds from the coarse to enter the subtle. This is on account of the fact that the body is relatively coarse, the breath abides within it, and it is the mind which is the most subtle and still. Thus one's adjustments move from the coarse to that which is subtle, thereby causing the mind to become stable and still. These then are the initial skillful means involved in entering meditative absorption. This is what constitutes the regulation of the three[5] matters as one first enters meditative absorption.

3) [Adjustments When Abiding in Meditation]

Second: As for the regulation of the three matters that takes place as one abides in the sitting posture, the practitioner should apply his mind in the focusing of mindfulness whether the given session of sitting meditation is long or short and whether it extends for one, two, or three of the twelve two-hour periods in a day. One must clearly recognize the characteristics which indicate whether or not the three phenomena of body, breath, and mind are in a state of correct adjustment.

a) [The Body]

As one continues with a given session of sitting, if, even though one has already finished making adjustments to the body, it nonetheless occurs that the body becomes either lax or tense, either tilted or crooked, or either drooped or arched upward, so that the body is not upright and straight—as soon as one becomes aware of it, one must then correct it. One must ensure that, as one abides in peacefulness and stability, one remains free of any laxity or urgency, and that one remains in a posture which is level, straight, and upright.

b) [The Breath]

Then again, during a single session of sitting, although the body may be correctly adjusted, the breath may still not be in harmony. The marks of its not being regulated are as discussed above. Perhaps there is "windy" breathing. Perhaps there is "uneven" breathing. Or perhaps, in addition, the breathing has become so urgent that there is a sense within the body of distention and fullness. In such cases, one should employ the previously discussed methods and thus counter them accordingly. In every case, one should cause the breath-channel phenomena to manifest in a smooth and continuous manner, while seeming to be as if present and yet not present.

c) [The Mind]

Again, it may be that in the course of a single session of sitting, although the body and the breath are correctly regulated, still, the mind may have failed to achieve meditative absorption on account of being either "floating," "sinking," "lax," or "urgent." At such a time, when one becomes aware of it, one should employ the previously mentioned regulating techniques to cause it to abide appropriately in between [such extremes].

4) [Summary of Abiding-Related Issues]

These three matters most definitely do not have any fixed sequence of implementation. One accords with whatever aspect is out of adjustment in proceeding to establish appropriate adjustment of it. One thus brings it about that, throughout the course of a single session of sitting, the three factors of body, respiration, and mind abide in a state of appropriate adjustment. They remain free of any mutual interference and thus become fused in a way whereby there is no longer any dual aspect to them.

When this has become the case, one is then able to get rid of any residual disorders rooted in previous existences, one is able to guard against and prevent the arising of obstacles, and one becomes able to establish ascendancy in the path of meditative absorption.

5) [Adjustments When Emerging from Meditation]

a) [Emergence Procedures]

Third: As for the regulation of the three factors at the time of emerging from meditation, if it is the case that the practitioner's specific session of sitting in dhyāna is about to come to an end, when he wishes to come out of meditative absorption, he should first release his mind onto a different objective condition. Then, he should open his mouth and release the breath while also visualizing it dispersing itself from the many energetic channels in concert with the mental attention.

Afterwards, one should move the body ever so slightly and then move the shoulders and then the hands, the head, and the neck. Next, one moves the two feet and allows them to become entirely limber again. Next, one uses the hands to massage over all of his pores and then massages his hands till they become warm. He then uses them to cover his two eyes and then, afterwards, opens them. Once one has waited for the physical heat to dissipate somewhat, one can then come and go as he pleases.

b) [Dangers of Neglecting Emergence Procedures]

If one fails to do this, since one may have succeeded in causing the mind to dwell in a particular way during the sit, if one then acts in a sudden and hurried fashion as one comes out of meditation, then the subtle phenomena may not have yet been allowed to disperse. If they thus continue to abide, trapped within the body, they may cause a person to have headaches and to experience a stiffness of all of the joints similar to rheumatism. In subsequent sitting sessions, one may then become afflicted, agitated, and ill at ease. Therefore, when the mind wishes to emerge from meditative absorption, one must always pay careful attention to these points.

This constitutes the technique for regulating the body, respiration, and mind as one emerges from meditative absorption.

6) [Citations Relating to Entry, Abiding, Emerging]

Because one moves forth from the subtle into that which is coarse, this involves a skillful entering, abiding, and emerging as described in a verse:

> In moving forward and in stopping, there is a proper sequence.
> The coarse and the subtle do not work against each other.
> It is just as with the skillful training of a horse.
> One wishes to come to a halt and then desires to move along.[6]

In the *Lotus Sutra*, it says: "For the sake of the Buddha Path, the bodhisattvas in this great assembly have already diligently practiced vigor for an incalculable number of tens of millions of *koṭīs* of kalpas. They have become skillful in entering, abiding in, and emerging from an incalculable number of trillions of *koṭīs* of samādhis. They have gained great superknowledges, have long cultivated the brahman conduct, and have become well able to practice in appropriate sequence all of the good dharmas."[7]

Chapter Five

Utilizing Skillful Means

5. Section Five: Implementation of Skillful Means

Now, as for cultivating calming-and-insight, it is necessary to employ various skillful means as entryways into the Dharma. There are five of these dharmas, as follows.

a. [Zeal]

The first is zeal (*chanda*). One possesses the zeal to separate from all of the world's erroneous thinking and inverted views. This is because one nurtures the zeal to achieve success in all of the Dharma-access methods associated with dhyāna and wisdom.

This idea may also be referred to by such terms as "being determined to," "aspiring to," "having a fondness for," and "taking pleasure in." This is because such a person is determined towards, aspires to, is fond of, and takes pleasure in all of the profound Dharma-access methods. These are the bases of "zeal." This is as indicated by the Buddha when he said, "Zeal is at the root of all good dharmas."[1]

b. [Vigor]

The second is vigor (*vīrya*). One is solid in his observance of the moral prohibitions and in getting rid of the five hindrances. In this, one remains focused and precise, and does not neglect the practice even in the early or later watches of the night. This is analogous to when one employs a friction drill to start a fire. So long as it has not become hot, one must refrain from resting. This is what is meant by vigor as it applies to the good dharmas of the Path.

c. [Mindfulness]

The third is mindfulness (*smṛti*). One remains continuously mindful that the world is deceptive and deserves to be deemed base whereas dhyāna absorption is honorable and worthy to be regarded as noble. If one gains dhyāna absorption, one immediately becomes able to perfectly generate the wisdom free of outflow-impurities, all of the superknowledges, the aspects of the Path, and the powers. One becomes able to achieve the equal and right enlightenment and to engage extensively in the spiritual liberation of beings. This is worthy of being regarded as noble. These considerations define what is meant here by "mindfulness."

d. [Discernment]

The fourth is discernment (*saṃprajñāna*). One makes a critical comparison between worldly happiness and the happiness associated with dhyāna absorption and wisdom, judging the achievements against the losses and the worthless against the valuable. How so? As for the happiness of the world, the happiness is but little, whereas its suffering is extensive. It is false, deceptive, and unreal. This amounts to a loss and to involvement in what is worthless.

As for the happiness which accompanies dhyāna absorption and wisdom, it is free of outflow-impurities, unconditioned, serene, and carefree. One eternally transcends cyclic births and deaths and remains forever free from suffering. This amounts to an achievement and to the realization of what is valuable. Analyses such as these form the basis of discernment.

e. [Single-mindedness]

The fifth is the practice of single-mindedness (*citta-eka-agra*). Through making clear distinctions, one perceives with clarity that it is fitting to regard the world as vexing and loathsome. One recognizes well that the meritorious qualities of meditative absorption and wisdom are worthy to be deemed honorable and noble. At such a time, one should make a single-minded decision to cultivate calming-and insight, making one's mind like *vajra* so that the heavenly demons and the non-Buddhists will be unable to interfere with or destroy [one's practice]. One's determination should be such that, even if one's efforts come up empty and nothing whatsoever is gained, one will still persevere to the end and not turn back or change one's resolve. This is what is meant by single-mindedness.

This [utilization of five skillful-means dharmas] is analogous to [essential factors involved in] a person's travels. It is first necessary to know the signs of the open or obstructed road. Afterwards, one decides to proceed single-mindedly along the road and then advances accordingly. Hence we speak here of discernment and single-mindedness. One of the sutras states, "Were it not for wisdom, one would not course in dhyāna. Were it not for dhyāna, one would not exercise wisdom."[2] This is the essential idea here.

Chapter Six

The Actual Cultivation

6. Section Six: The Actual Cultivation

As for the cultivation of calming-and-insight, there are two modes. The first is cultivation while sitting. The second is cultivation while moving through objective conditions and as one relates to the objective sphere.

a. [Calming-and-Insight During Sitting Meditation]

As for the first mode, the cultivation as one cultivates calming-andinsight while sitting, although it is true that this can be accomplished in any of the four deportments,[1] still, for the study of the path, sitting is the superior posture. Therefore one first explains calming-and-insight in relation to sitting. Generally speaking, one sets forth five different concepts in this connection:

[1) Cultivating calming-and-insight as means of countering the coarseness and disorderedness of the beginner's mind;

2) Cultivating calming-and-insight as means of countering the faults of mental "sinking," or "floating";

3) Cultivating calming-and-insight in a manner which accords with whatever is appropriate;

4) Cultivating calming-and-insight to counteract subtle states of mind occurring in meditative absorption;

5) Cultivating calming-and-insight as means of achieving equal balance in meditative absorption and wisdom.[2]

1) [Calming-and-Insight Countering Mental Coarseness & Disorderedness]

The first concept is cultivating calming-and-insight as means of countering the coarseness and disorderedness of the beginner's mind. This refers to the case where, because the practitioner's thoughts are coarse and disordered when he first attempts to sit in dhyāna, he should then cultivate calming to get rid of them and break their hold. If one is unable to break their hold through calming, then one ought in such a case to cultivate insight. Hence one speaks of cultivating calming-and-insight in order to counter and break the coarseness and disorderedness of the beginner's mind.

a) [Calming During Sitting Meditation]

Now, the explanation of the cultivation of calming-and-insight involves two concepts. The first, the cultivation of calming, involves the use of three methods:

i) [Calming by Anchoring Attention on an Object in the Objective Sphere]

The first of these is calming wherein one anchors one's attention on a particular condition while monitoring the objective sphere. This refers to anchoring the mind at such locations as the tip of the nose or the navel in order to prevent the mind from becoming scattered. Accordingly, a sutra states, "One anchors the mind and refrains from falling into neglectfulness. This is just like locking up a monkey."[3]

ii) [Calming Through Controlling the Mind]

The second is calming through controlling the mind. This refers to exerting control no matter what comes up in the mind in order to prevent it from running off and becoming scattered. A sutra says, "As for these five sense faculties, the mind acts as their ruler. Therefore, you should all skillfully control your minds."[4]

Because both of these approaches are characterized by [obvious] phenomena, it is not necessary to analyze them here.

iii) [Calming Through Realization of Truth]

The third is calming through realization of truth. This means that, no matter what the mind dwells upon, if one understands that all dharmas are produced from causes and conditions and are devoid of an inherently-existent nature, then the mind will not seize upon them. If the mind does not seize upon them, then the false-thinking mind will come to a rest. Hence this qualifies as calming. This is as described in a sutra where it states:

> As for each and every one of all the dharmas,
> Consisting of causes and conditions, they are empty, devoid of any [inherently-existent] entity.
> One puts the mind to rest and penetrates to the original source.
> It is on this account that one is known as a "śramaṇa."[5]

When the practitioner first sits in dhyāna meditation, [he observes that], no matter what the mind thinks of, no dharma abides for even an instant. If one's false thoughts do not cease even though one has implemented the above-described technique of calming through realization of truth, one should then reflect upon the mind which gives rise

[to these thoughts], and realize that, as for the past, that has already been destroyed, as for the present, it does not abide, and as for the future, it has not yet come. When one searches throughout these three periods of time, it cannot be found at all. If it constitutes a dharma which cannot be found, then there is no [inherently existent] mind. If there is no such [inherently existent] mind, then all dharmas are themselves devoid of any [inherent] existence.

Although the practitioner contemplates and finds that the mind does not abide and is in every case devoid of any [inherent] existence, still, it is not the case that there is no *kṣaṇa-after-kṣaṇa*[6] (millisecond-level) process wherein one carries forth with the generation of an aware and knowing mindfulness.

One additionally contemplates this mind's thought, observing that it is on account of the inward presence of the six sense faculties, the outward presence of the six sense objects, and the mutual opposition between the faculties and the objects that one thereby generates consciousness. When the sense faculties and the sense objects have not yet been placed in mutual opposition, there is fundamentally no production of [any corresponding sense] consciousness. Just as one contemplates the process of production in this manner, so too does one contemplate the process of cessation in precisely the same way.

The names "production" and "cessation" are only falsely established. When the mind characterized by production and cessation ceases, then quiescent cessation manifests right before one. There is then nothing whatsoever therein which can be found to exist. This is the so-called empty and still noumenal principle of nirvāṇa. One's mind then naturally comes to a halt, [achieving a state of "calming."]

The *Awakening of Faith Treatise* states, "If the mind has run off and become scattered, one should immediately draw it back in and establish it in right mindfulness. As for this 'right mindfulness,' one should be aware that it is only mind. There is no outward realm. This very mind itself is devoid of any inherently existent characteristic. Even from one instant to the next, its existence cannot be found."[7]

It is said that there are beginners in the cultivation of this study who, not yet having developed an easy ability to still the mind, attempt to suppress it to force it to remain still. [Those adopting such an approach] often become prone to mental derangement.

This is just like studying archery. If one were to devote a long time to the practice, one would succeed in hitting the bulls-eye.

b) [Insight During Sitting Meditation]

The second, the cultivation of insight, is of two types.

i) [Counteractive Insight]

The first is counteractive insight. It is exemplified by the contemplation of impurity aimed at counteracting desire, the contemplation involving the mind of loving-kindness aimed at counteracting hatred, the contemplation involving analysis of the sense realms aimed at counteracting attachment to a self, and the breath-counting contemplation aimed at counteracting excessive discursive thinking. These will not be discussed in detail here.

ii) [Right {Insight} Contemplation]

The second, right [insight] contemplation, involves the contemplation of all dharmas as devoid of [inherently existent] aspects and also as produced from causes and conditions. The absence of an [inherently-existent] nature owing to [being reducible to mere] causes and conditions is itself their true character.[8] If one first comprehends that absolutely everything within the contemplated sphere is entirely empty [of any inherent existence], then the mind capable of engaging in contemplation naturally does not arise.

The earlier and later parts of the text devote considerable attention to discussing this concept. The reader is requested to study this in detail himself. The concept is illustrated by a sutra verse which states:

All dharmas are insubstantial.
They constantly abide in one's thoughts.
One who has understood and perceived emptiness
Is in every case free of thinking.[9]

2) [Calming-and-Insight Countering Mental "Sinking" or "Floating"]

The second concept involves cultivating calming-and-insight as means of countering the faults of mental "sinking," or "floating."

When the practitioner is sitting in dhyāna meditation, if his mind is obstructed by dimness and fails to attend to anything as he stares blankly, or if he becomes prone at times to much sleepiness, he should then cultivate insight to bring forth illumination.

If, in the midst of sitting, one's mind moves about in a floating manner such that it is light, agitated, and ill at ease, one should then cultivate calming in order to bring it to a halt.

This is a summary explanation of the features of cultivating calming-and-insight as means of countering the faults of mental "sinking," or "floating." It is only necessary that in utilizing them, one understands well how to match the medicine and the disorder. One must refrain in every case from committing the error of applying the antidotes in a contrary or unorthodox manner.

3) [Calming-and-Insight in Accordance with Whatever is Appropriate]

The third concept involves cultivating calming-and-insight in a manner according with whatever is appropriate.

When the practitioner is sitting in dhyāna meditation, if, even though he does cultivate contemplative illumination for the sake of counteracting mental sinking, his mind still does not become bright and pure and there is no Dharma-related benefit from it, he should then try cultivating calming in order to arrest it. If, when he is utilizing calming, he then becomes aware of his body and mind having become peaceful and still, he should know then that it is appropriate to utilize calming. He should then employ calming to pacify the mind.

When one is sitting in dhyāna meditation, if, even though he cultivates calming to counteract mental floating and moving about, the mind still does not come to a stop and he derives no Dharmarelated benefit from it, he should then try cultivating [insight] contemplation. If, in the midst of [insight] contemplation, he then becomes aware that the mind and spirit have become bright, pure, still, and stable, he ought to know then that it is appropriate to engage in [insight] contemplation. He should then employ [insight] contemplation to pacify the mind.

This is a summary explanation of the features of cultivating calming-and-insight in a manner which accords with whatever is appropriate. It is only necessary that one skillfully adapt to what is appropriate and cultivate that. If one does this, then the mind and spirit will become peaceful and stable, the calamity of the afflictions will be put to rest, and one will realize success in cultivating entryways to Dharma.

4) [Calming-and-Insight Countering Subtle Mind States]

The fourth concept involves cultivating calming-and-insight to counteract subtle states of mind occurring in meditative absorption. This refers to the situation where the practitioner has first utilized calming-and-insight to counteract and break the hold of coarse and disordered states and, because the disordered thought has already ceased, he then succeeds in entering meditative absorption.

On account of the subtle mind state arising in meditative absorption, one becomes aware of the body as empty and still and then experiences bliss. It may be that a mind prone to indulgence is then brought forth which is able to use that subtle mental state as a basis for seizing on deviant ideas.

If one remains unaware of the false and deceptive nature of the mind which has come to a rest in meditative absorption, one will certainly become desirously attached to this experience. If one becomes desirously attached, one will cling to this as being genuine. If, however, one is aware that this is false, deceptive, and not genuine, then the two afflictions of affection and views will not arise. This then would constitute the cultivation of calming.

If, even though one continues to cultivate calming, the mind still remains attached and the karma of the fetters linked to affection and views does not cease, one should then cultivate [insight] contemplation, directing that contemplation to the subtle mind involved in meditative absorption.

If one does not then perceive [any inherent existence of] those subtle mind states arising in meditative absorption, then one will not retain any attachment to the [wrong] views associated with this meditative absorption. If one does not establish attachment to those [wrong] views associated with this meditative absorption, then the karma associated with the afflictions of affection and views will all be entirely shattered and destroyed. This then would constitute the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

This is a summary explanation of the features of cultivating calming-and-insight to counteract the subtle mental states occurring in meditative absorption. The distinguishing features associated with the methods of calming-and-insight are identical to those set forth previously. The only difference in this case is that they are employed here to demolish especially subtle errors inherent in [particular] views associated with meditative absorption.

5) [Calming-and-Insight to Achieve Balance in Absorption and Wisdom]

The fifth concept is the cultivation of calming-and-insight as means of achieving equal balance in meditative absorption and wisdom.

While sitting in dhyāna, either on account of cultivating calming or perhaps on account of cultivating [insight] contemplation, the practitioner may then enter dhyāna absorption. Having done so, although he may have succeeded in entering meditative absorption, still, he may not possess any [insight] contemplation-based wisdom. This constitutes an absorption characterized by stupidity, one wherein one remains unable to cut off the fetters. Or it might also happen that the operative [insight] contemplation-based wisdom is only faint and scant. In such a case, one is unable to generate true wisdom, sever the fetters, or develop the entryways to Dharma.

At such a time, one should cultivate the analysis of [insight] contemplation. If one does so, then meditative absorption and wisdom become equally balanced, one becomes able to sever the fetters, and one achieves realization in the entryways to Dharma.

When the practitioner is sitting in dhyāna, on account of cultivating [insight] contemplation, his mind may suddenly open up and become awakened such that his wisdom becomes sharp and clear. However, it may be that the mind of meditative absorption is still only faint and scant. In such a case, the mind may become subject to moving and scattering. Then, just like a lamp flame in the wind, it cannot completely illuminate things. In such a case, one remains unable to succeed in abandoning cyclic births and deaths.

At such a time, one should return to the cultivation of calming. On account of cultivating calming, one then gains the mind of meditative absorption. Then, like the lamp flame which burns in a closed room, it becomes immediately able to dispel the darkness and illuminate things clearly.

This is a summary explanation of the cultivation of the two dharmas of calming and insight in order to establish equal balance of meditative absorption and wisdom.

6) [Benefits of Skillful Utilization of the Five Concepts]

If the practitioner is able in this manner to skillfully utilize these five ideas in cultivating calming-and-insight in sitting meditation, and if he does not fail to accord with what is appropriate in selecting them and dispensing with them, then one should realize that this person skillfully cultivates the Dharma of the Buddha. Because one is able to skillfully cultivate them, he most certainly will not pass through this one lifetime in vain.

b. [Objective Sphere Related Calming-and-Insight]

Next, the second mode. Here we explain the cultivation of calmingand-insight while moving through objective conditions and while relating to the objective sphere.

Constantly sitting with the body upright is the supreme essential for entering the Path. However, a person with responsibilities must necessarily be involved in conditions related to his endeavors. If one adapts to objective conditions in relating to the objective sphere and yet fails to cultivate calming-and-insight, this will produce interruptions in his cultivation of the mind. In such a case, the karma of the fetters will arise at any point of contact. In such a case, how could one succeed in achieving a rapid conformity with the Dharma of the Buddha?

If a person is at all times constantly cultivating skillful means related to meditative absorption and wisdom, one should know that this person will certainly be able to reach a penetrating understanding of all of the Buddha's dharmas.

What is meant by cultivating calming-and-insight as one moves through objective conditions? As for what is referred to as "objective conditions," it refers to six kinds of objective conditions: The first is walking; the second is standing; the third is sitting; the fourth is lying down; the fifth is doing things; and the sixth is speaking.

What is meant by cultivating calming-and-insight while relating to the objective sphere? As for what is referred to as "the objective sphere," it refers to the sphere of the six sense objects: The first is the eye in relation to forms; the second is the ear in relation to sounds; the third is the nose in relation to fragrances; the fourth is the tongue in relation to flavors; the fifth is the body in relation to tangibles; and the sixth is the intellectual mind in relation to dharmas [as objects of mind].

It is based on the practitioner's cultivation of calming-and-insight in relation to these twelve phenomena that one speaks of the cultivation of calming-and-insight as one moves through objective conditions and as one relates to the objective sphere.

1) [When Moving Through Six Karmic Modes]

a) [When Walking]

First, walking. At times when one is involved in walking, one should bring forth this thought: "For what purpose do I now wish to walk?" If it is on account of being directed by afflictions or by unwholesome or neutral matters, then one should not proceed with walking. If it is not an instance of being directed by the afflictions and if it is for the sake of a matter which produces wholesome benefits and which is in accord with the Dharma, then one should go ahead and proceed with walking.

i) [Calming when Walking]

How does one go about cultivating calming while walking? If one is walking, one maintains the awareness that, on account of walking, there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth. If one is completely aware that the mind engaged in walking as well as all dharmas present in walking cannot be found, then the false-thinking mind ceases. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when Walking]

How does one go about cultivating [insight] contemplation while walking? One should bring forth this thought: "It

is on account of the mind that one moves the body. As a result, one brings about that forward movement referred to as 'walking.' It is on account of walking that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth."

One should then immediately turn back the attention and contemplate the mind which is engaged in walking. One then fails to perceive any characteristic appearance associated with it. One should then realize that the one who walks as well as all dharmas involved in walking are both ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

b) [When Standing]

Second, standing. If one is standing, one should bring forth this thought: "On account of what endeavor do I now wish to stand?" If it is for the sake of the afflictions or unwholesome or neutral endeavors that one proposes to stand, then one should not proceed with standing. If it is for the sake of good and beneficial endeavors, then one should engage in standing.

i) [Calming when Standing]

How does one cultivate calming while standing? If one is standing, one maintains the awareness that, on account of standing, there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth. If one is completely aware that the mind engaged in standing as well as all of the dharmas involved in standing cannot be found, then the false-thinking mind comes to rest. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when Standing]

How does one go about cultivating [insight] contemplation while standing? One should bring forth this thought: "It is on account of the mind that the body is brought to a stop. As a result, one refers to 'standing.' It is on account of this standing that there may then exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth."

One should then turn back one's attention and contemplate the mind engaged in standing. One then fails to perceive any characteristic appearance in it. One should then realize that the one who stands as well as all of the dharmas involved in standing are ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

c) [When Sitting]

Third, sitting. If one is sitting, one should bring forth this thought: "On account of what endeavor do I now wish to sit?" If it is to indulge the afflictions or for the sake of unwholesome or neutral matters, then one should not proceed to sit. If it is for the sake of good and beneficial endeavors, then one should proceed with sitting.

i) [Calming when Sitting]

How does one go about cultivating calming while sitting? If one is engaged in sitting, then one should be completely aware that, on account of sitting, there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth. However, if [one remains aware that] there is not one single dharma which can be found, then false thoughts will not arise. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when Sitting]

How does one go about cultivating [insight] contemplation while sitting? One should bring forth this thought: "It is on account of what is thought by the mind that one stabilizes the body in the cross-legged posture. It is on account of this that one may come to have all of the dharmas of good, of bad, and so forth. Thus it is that one refers to 'sitting.'"

In turning around the attention to contemplate the mind engaged in sitting, one does not perceive any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who sits as well as all of the dharmas involved in sitting are ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

d) [When Lying Down]

Fourth, lying down. When one is lying down, one should bring forth this thought: "On account of what endeavor do I now wish to lie down?" If it is on account of some matter which is unwholesome or neglectful, then one should not proceed with lying down. If it is for the sake of bringing the four great elements into adjustment and harmony, then one ought to proceed with lying down like the King of Lions.[10]

i) [Calming when Lying Down]

How does one go about cultivating calming when lying down? If one is going to sleep, then one ought to become completely aware that, on account of lying down, there may come to exist all manner of dharmas of good, of bad, and so forth. However, if [one remains aware that] there is not one single dharma which can be found, then false thinking will not arise. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when Lying Down]

How does one go about cultivating [insight] contemplation when lying down? One should bring forth this thought:

"It is on account of becoming worn out and exhausted that one then becomes beclouded and dim and then lets loose of the six sense faculties. It is on account of this that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth."

One should then turn back one's attention and contemplate the mind involved in lying down. One fails to perceive any characteristic appearance in it. One should then realize that the one who lies down as well as all of the dharmas involved in lying down are ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

e) [When Engaging in Actions]

Fifth, engaging in actions. When one is engaging in actions, one should bring forth this thought: "On account of what matter do I now wish to engage in an action such as this?" If it is for the sake of matters which are unwholesome, neutral, and so forth, then one should not proceed to act. If it is for the sake of good and beneficial matters, then one should proceed with the action.

i) [Calming when Engaging in Actions]

How does one go about cultivating calming in the midst of engaging in actions? If one is involved in carrying out actions, then one should be completely aware that, on account of engaging in actions, there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of good, of bad, and so forth. However, if [one remains aware that] there is not one single dharma which can be gotten at, then false thoughts will not arise. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when Engaging in Actions]

What is meant by cultivating [insight] contemplation while engaging in actions? One should bring forth this thought: "It is on account of the mind's controlling the movement of the body and hands that one engages in endeavors. It is because of this that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of good, of bad, and so forth. Thus it is that one refers to 'engaging in actions.'"

One turns back the attention and contemplates the mind which engages in actions. One then fails to perceive any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the agent of actions as well as all of the dharmas involved in engaging in actions are ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

f) [When Speaking]

Sixth, speaking. When one is involved in speaking, one should bring forth this thought: "On account of what matter do I now wish to speak?" If one would thereby follow along with the implementation of afflictions or if it would be done for the sake of discussing matters which are unwholesome, neutral, and so forth, then one should refrain from speaking. If it is for the sake of good and beneficial matters, then one should go ahead and speak.

i) [Calming when Speaking]

What is meant by cultivating calming when speaking? If one is engaged in speaking, one maintains the awareness that, on account of this speaking, there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth. One becomes completely aware that the mind which engages in speaking as well as all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, and of bad—none of them can be found. Thus the mind which brings forth false thoughts then comes to a rest. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when Speaking]

What is meant by cultivating contemplating in the midst of speaking? One should bring forth this thought: "It is based on ideation (*vitarka*) and mental discursion (*vicāra*) that one provokes the breath to move through the throat, the lips, the tongue, the teeth, and the palate. Thus one emits sound as the words of speech. It is because of this speaking that there may then come to exist the dharmas of good, of bad, and so forth. Thus it is that one refers to 'speech.'"

One turns back the attention and contemplates the mind which engages in speaking. One fails to perceive any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who speaks as well as all of the dharmas involved in speaking are ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

g) Summation of Cultivation when Moving through Conditions

The above-discussed six sets of ideas involved in the cultivation of calming-and-insight are to be employed in a manner which adapts to whatever is appropriate at the given time. In each and every case, they also involve the five previously discussed concepts inherent in cultivating calming-and-insight. Those are to be implemented in the manner explained earlier.[11]

2) [Calming-and-Insight in Relation to Objective Spheres of the Six Senses]

Next, the cultivation of calming-and-insight at the entrances of the six sense faculties.

a) [When the Eye Views Forms]

i) [Calming when the Eye Views Forms]

First, the cultivation of calming when the eye views forms. Whenever one views forms, it is as if one were looking at the moon reflected in water. [Thus one recognizes that] there is no definite reality involved [in what one sees].

If one sees forms with which one is temperamentally agreeable, one does not give rise to desirous affection. If one sees forms to which one is temperamentally opposed, one does not give rise to hateful affliction. If one sees forms to which one is neither opposed nor agreeable, one does not manifest ignorance or any form of disordered thinking. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when the Eye Views Forms]

What is meant by the cultivation of [insight] contemplation when the eyes view form? One should think: "Whatever one observes, just those very characteristic features are themselves empty [of inherent existence] and abiding in stillness. How is this the case? Within the sphere of that sense faculty, sense object, space, and light, there is nothing seen on the part of any one of them, nor is there any discrimination which takes place therein.

"Rather it is a combination of causes and conditions which generates eye consciousness. Next, there occurs the arising of the mind consciousness. That is then immediately able to make distinctions among all of the various types of forms. It is on account of this that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth."

One should immediately turn the attention back and contemplate that mind which bears forms in mind. One does not then perceive that it possesses any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who sees as well as all of the other associated dharmas are ultimately empty [of inherent existence] and abiding in stillness. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

b) [When the Ear Hears Sounds]

i) [Calming when the Ear Hears Sounds]

Second, the cultivation of calming when the ear hears sounds. Whichever sounds are heard by the ear, one immediately realizes that the sounds are characterized by being like echoes.

If one hears sounds with which one is temperamentally agreeable, one does not give rise to an affectionate mind. As for sounds to which one is temperamentally opposed, one does not give rise to a hateful mind. And as for sounds to which one is neither opposed nor agreeable, one does not give rise to a discriminating mind. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when the Ear Hears Sounds]

What is meant by the cultivation of [insight] contemplation in the hearing of sounds? One should bring forth this thought: "No matter what sound is heard, it is empty and utterly devoid of any [inherent] existence. It is only from the coming together of the sense faculty and the sense object that there is the generation of ear consciousness. Next, the mind consciousness arises and, in a forced manner, gives rise to discriminations. It is because of this that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth."

One turns back the attention and contemplates the mind which hears sounds. One does not perceive any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who hears as well as all of the other associated dharmas are ultimately empty and still. It is this which constitutes [insight] contemplation.

c) [When the Nose Smells Fragrances]

i) [Calming when the Nose Smells Fragrances]

Third, the cultivation of calming when the nose smells fragrances. No matter what fragrances are smelled, one immediately realizes that they are like flames and are unreal. If one smells fragrances with which one is temperamentally agreeable, one does not give rise to a mind characterized by attachment. As for smells to which one is temperamentally opposed, one does not give rise to a hateful mind. And as for smells towards which one is neither opposed nor agreeable, one does not bring forth disordered thinking. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when the Nose Smells Fragrances]

What is meant by the cultivation of [insight] contemplation in the smelling of fragrances? One should bring forth this thought: "The fragrances which I am now smelling are false, deceptive, and unreal. How is this the case? It is because of the coming together of the sense faculty and the sense object that there is then produced the olfactory consciousness. Next, there is the production of the mind consciousness. In a forced manner, it then seizes upon the characteristics of fragrances. It is because of this that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth. Thus it is that we speak of 'smelling fragrances.'"

One turns back the attention and contemplates the mind which smells fragrances. One does not perceive that it possesses any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who smells fragrances as well as all of

the other associated dharmas are ultimately empty [of inherent existence] and abiding in stillness. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

d) [When the Tongue Tastes Flavors]

i) [Calming when the Tongue Tastes Flavors]

Fourth, the cultivation of calming when the tongue tastes flavors. No matter what flavors are tasted, one immediately realizes that they are like flavors tasted in a dream or as part of a conjuration.

If one obtains a marvelous flavor towards which one is temperamentally agreeable, one does not give rise to desirous attachment. As for bad tastes towards which one is temperamentally opposed, one does not give rise to a hateful mind. And as for tastes towards which one is neither opposed nor agreeable, one does not give rise to discriminating thoughts on the part of the intellectual mind. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when the Tongue Tastes Flavors]

What is meant by cultivating [insight] contemplation when the tongue experiences tastes? One should bring forth this thought: "In reality, the tastes which are now being experienced cannot be apprehended as existents. How is this so? The subjective and objective factors involved in the six flavors are by their very nature free of any discriminating function. It is because one's tongue organ comes into conjunction with them that gustatory consciousness arises. Next, one gives rise to mind consciousness. That then seizes in a forced manner upon the characteristic aspects of flavors. It is because of this that there may then come to exist all of the dharmas of the afflictions, of good, of bad, and so forth."

One turns back the attention and contemplates the consciousness which takes tastes as its objective conditions. One does not perceive any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who experiences tastes as well as all of the other associated dharmas are ultimately empty [of inherent existence] and abiding in stillness. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

e) [When the Body Engages Tangibles]

i) [Calming when the Body Engages Tangibles]

Fifth, the cultivation of calming when the body engages tangibles. No matter which tactile sensations become the object of awareness, one immediately realizes that they are like a reflection, like an illusion, or like a conjuration, and thus are unreal.

If one experiences a pleasurable tactile sensation to which one is temperamentally agreeable, one does not give rise to desirous attachment. If one experiences painful tactile sensations to which one is temperamentally opposed, one does not give rise to hateful affliction. If one experiences tactile sensations to which one is neither opposed nor agreeable, one does not give rise to thoughts which retain them in mind nor does one engage in making distinctions among them. This constitutes the cultivation of calming.

ii) [Insight when the Body Engages Tangibles]

What is meant by the cultivation of [insight] contemplation when the body engages tangibles? One should bring forth this thought: "Lightness and heaviness, coolness and heat, roughness and slickness and other such dharmas are all tactile sensations. The six sections of the body consisting of the head and so forth constitute what is referred to as the body. The nature of tactile sensations is that they are empty and false. The body, too, is unreal. It is through the coming together of causes and conditions that there is the arising of physical consciousness. There next arises the mind consciousness which engages in recollective thought and the making of distinctions with regard to the characteristics of pleasure, pain, and so forth. Thus it is that we speak of 'experiencing tactile sensations.'"

One turns back the attention and contemplates the mind which takes tactile sensations as objective conditions. One does not perceive it to possess any characteristic appearance. One should then realize that the one who experiences tactile sensations as well as all of the other associated dharmas are ultimately empty [of inherent existence] and abiding in stillness. It is this which constitutes the cultivation of [insight] contemplation.

f) [When the Mind Experiences Awareness of Dharmas]

Sixth, the features of the cultivation of calming-and-insight in the midst of the mind's awareness of dharmas are as already explained at the beginning [of this chapter], in the section devoted to sitting meditation. From among the above features relating to the cultivation of calming-and-insight in dependence upon the six sense faculties, one implements whichever ones correspond to that faculty which one intends to utilize. The five concepts discussed earlier are inherent in each and every one of these situations.[12] Because they have already been extensively detailed herein, we won't repeat the analysis now.

c. [The Benefits and Scriptural Citations]

If the practitioner is able to cultivate calming-and-insight at every point as he walks, stands, sits, lies down, sees, hears, experiences awareness, and so forth, then one ought to know that this person truly cultivates the Mahāyāna

path. As stated in the *Large Sutra*, "The Buddha told Subhūti, 'If when the bodhisattva walks, he is aware of walking, if when he sits, he is aware of sitting…" and so forth until we come to "…when he dons the *saṅghāṭī* robe, …gazes, or blinks, …he is single-minded, …both exiting from and entering into dhyāna absorption…".[13] One should know that a person such as this qualifies as a bodhisattva, a Mahāyānist.

Furthermore, if a person is able to cultivate the Great Vehicle in this manner in every situation, this person is the most superior in all the world. He is the most supreme and has no peer. A verse from the *[Mahāprajñāpāramitā] Upadeśa* states:

> Easefully sitting within the forest,
> Quiescently extinguishing every ill,
> Serenely gaining unity of mind—
> This bliss is not the bliss of the heavens.
>
> People seek after worldly profit,
> Fame, robes, and fine beds and cushions.
> Bliss of this sort is not secure.
> In seeking profit, there is no satisfaction.
>
> The patch-robed one abides in deserted places.
> Moving and stopping, his mind is always one.
> Spontaneously employing the clarity of wisdom,
> He contemplates the true character of dharmas.
>
> In all of the different classes of dharmas,
> All are entered through [insight] contemplation of their equality.
> The mind of understanding wisdom abides in quiescence.
> Throughout the three realms, there are none ranked as peer.[14]

Chapter Seven

Manifestations of Roots of Goodness

7. Section Seven: Manifestations of Roots of Goodness

If the practitioner is able in this manner to skillfully cultivate calming-and-insight, going from the [insight] contemplation of the conventional into the [insight] contemplation of emptiness, as he sits in meditation, his body and mind will manifest as bright and pure.[1] At such time, there may occur the development and manifestation of many different sorts of roots of goodness (*kuśala-mūla*). One must recognize and be aware of them.

Now, we shall briefly explain the signs associated with the manifestation of roots of goodness. This involves two different categories, as follows.

a. [Outward Roots of Goodness]

First, the signs associated with the manifestation of "outward" roots of goodness: This refers to the development and manifestation of roots of goodness associated with giving, upholding moral precepts, filial dutifulness to parents, veneration of seniors, making offerings to the Triple Jewel, listening to and studying the teachings, and so forth. These are outward matters.[2]

If one is not engaged in correct cultivation, it may happen that there is a mutual spilling over and admixture with demonic states of mind. We will not now analyze these matters in detail.[3]

b. [Inward Roots of Goodness]

Second, the signs of the manifestation of "inward" roots of goodness. This refers to the development and manifestation of roots of goodness related to the Dharma gateways associated with the dhyāna absorptions. There are three concepts to be considered here.

1) [Signs of Manifestation of Roots of Goodness]

The first, the explanation of the signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness. This involves five different categories, as follows.

a) [Signs Related to Pathways of the Breath]

First, the signs related to the manifestation of roots of goodness linked to the pathways of the breath. On account of the practitioner's skillful cultivation of calming-and-insight, the body and mind become regulated correctly and false thinking comes to a halt. Because of this, one becomes aware that one's mind gradually enters into meditative absorption. These phenomena manifest in desire realm absorptions and the "preliminary-ground" (*anāgamya*).[4]

The body and mind seem as if they have disappeared and are experienced as empty and quiescent. The mind associated with meditative absorption becomes peaceful and stable. In the midst of this meditative absorption, one does not perceive any appearance whatsoever of a body or a mind. Then, afterwards, one may continue on through one or two sitting sessions, and so forth until we come to one day, two days, one month, or two months. In attempting to take up with [cultivation focused on] the breath, one may find it to be imperceptible. It may be that this circumstance does not recede and is not lost.

Then, in the midst of meditative absorption, one may suddenly become aware of the body and mind moving and provoking the manifestation of eight tactile sensations, namely the awareness of physical pain, itching, coldness, heat, lightness, heaviness, roughness, smoothness, and so forth.

At that time when there is the manifestation of these dharmas of tactile sensation, the body and mind are peaceful and stabilized. There is an empty and subtle blissfulness. One's happiness and pleasure are pure and indescribable even by simile. These are signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness characterized by the basic dhyāna absorption's awareness of the pathways of breath.

It may be that, in the preliminary ground of the desire realm, the practitioner suddenly becomes aware of the exiting and entry of the breath, of its relative duration, and of its pervading the entire body, coursing emptily through all of one's hair pores. One then immediately sees with the mind's eye the thirty-six categories of physical components contained within the body just as when, upon opening up a pantry, one sees all of the sesame seeds, beans, and so forth. The mind is both profoundly startled and delighted. One becomes quiescent, peaceful, and happy. These are signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness corresponding to the special ascendant practices associated with the breath.[5]

b) [Signs Related to Contemplation of Impurity]

Second, the signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the contemplation of impurity. When the practitioner is immersed in the meditative absorption of the desire realm's preliminary ground, his body and mind become empty and still in the midst of this meditative absorption, [whereupon he may experience the following signs]: He may suddenly observe an appearance of the physical death of some other man or woman and then, following upon that death, the corpse's bloating and rotting, the presence of worms, and the flowing forth of pus. He may then observe the whitened bones scattered about. His mind may become affected by sorrow and delight and he may then experience revulsion and abhorrence for that which he had previously loved. These are signs indicating the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the nine reflections.[6]

Then again, it may happen that, in the midst of quiescent meditative absorption, one may suddenly observe the impure things inside of the body, someone else's body as bloated and scattered, or his own body as a white skeleton from the head to foot, with every one of the bones held in position by the others. After having seen this phenomenon, the mind of absorption may become peaceful and stable. One may experience a startling awakening to a realization of impermanence. One may then develop revulsion and abhorrence for the five objects of desire, and may then desist from attachment to either oneself or other persons. These are signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the [eight] liberations.[7]

Then again, when the mind is immersed in meditative absorption, one may observe everything as utterly impure, maintaining this perception whether it be with regard to one's own body, the bodies of others, flying birds, crawling beasts, clothing, drink, food, dwellings, mountains, or forests. These are signs indicating the manifestation of roots of goodness related to [past-life contemplation of] the great [all-encompassing] impurity.

c) [Signs Related to the Mind of Loving-kindness]

Third, the signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the mind of loving-kindness (*maitrī*). If, on account of cultivating calming-and-insight, the practitioner succeeds in entering the meditative absorption of the desire realm's preliminary ground (*anāgamya*), while he is immersed in this meditative absorption, he may suddenly bring forth a mind characterized by a lovingly-kind mindfulness of other beings wherein there appear to him signs indicating that persons with whom he has close affinities gain happiness. He may then immediately develop deep meditative absorption wherein his own mind manifests a pure and blissful happiness indescribable even by simile.

Identical experiences may occur [for the practitioner] in relation to people towards whom he possesses only middling affinities, in relation to people who have been his adversaries and, ultimately, even in relation to all of the beings within the five rebirth destinies throughout the ten directions. When he arises from meditative absorption, his mind abides in blissful happiness, so much so that, no matter whom he sees, his countenance remains constantly harmonious. These are signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the mind of loving-kindness. The signs of the manifestation of the mind of compassion (*karuṇa*), the mind of sympathetic joy (*muditā*), and the mind of equanimity (*upekṣā*) may all be understood through comparison to this.[8]

d) [Signs Related to Contemplation of Causes and Conditions]

Fourth, the signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the contemplation of causes and conditions. It may be that, on account of cultivating calming-and-insight, the practitioner gains the desire realm's preliminary-ground meditative absorption in which the body and mind abide in stillness. He may then suddenly experience the arising of an awakened mind wherein, in pursuing deliberation upon the causes and conditions of ignorance, karmic formative factors (*saṃskāras*), and so forth as they play out in the three periods of time, he does not perceive the [inherent] existence of either others or a self.[9]

[The practitioner may] then immediately transcend [views positing] annihilationism and eternalism, demolish all attachments and views, and gain the peace and security of meditative absorption. Understanding and wisdom may manifest, Dharma joy may come forth in his mind, and his thought may remain free of concerns associated with worldly matters.

As for the distinctions involved in one's experiences in relation to the five aggregates, the twelve sense bases, and the eighteen sense realms, they may be of a character similar to the above. These are signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the contemplation of causes and conditions.

e) [Signs Related to Mindfulness of the Buddha]

Fifth, the signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to mindfulness of the Buddha. It may be that, on account of cultivating calming-and-insight, the practitioner gains the desire realm's preliminary-ground meditative absorption wherein his body and mind become empty and still. It may be that he then immediately calls to mind the inconceivable and ineffable meritorious qualities and major and minor characteristics of the Buddha, including all of the ten powers, the fearlessnesses, the dharmas exclusive to the Buddha, the samādhis, the liberations, and other such dharmas, including also the inconceivable and indescribable superknowledges and transformations, and

including also the unimpeded eloquences and vast benefits to beings which are themselves so inconceivable and indescribable.

When [the practitioner] engages in such thought, he then manifests a mind imbued with admiring reverence. Samādhi develops in him. Thus his body and mind become blissful, pure, peaceful, and secure, and he becomes free of any unwholesome characteristics.

When he arises from dhyāna absorption, his body abides in a state of lightness and easefulness (*praśrabhi*).[10] He realizes for himself that [the Buddha's] meritorious qualities are lofty and impressive and that they are fit to be the object of a person's admiring reverence. These are signs of the manifestation of roots of goodness related to the mindfulness-of-the-Buddha samādhi.

f) [Signs Related to Other Roots of Goodness]

Furthermore, in the event that the practitioner gains clarity and purity of body and mind on account of cultivating calming-andinsight, he may then experience the manifestation of signs associated with the reflections on impermanence, suffering, emptiness, non-self, impurity, renunciability of the world, impurity of food, death, abandonment, or cessation, or he may experience signs associated with the recollections of the Buddha, of the Dharma, of the Sangha, of the precepts, of relinquishing, or of the heavens.[11]

[The practitioner] may experience the manifestation of signs associated with any of the Dharma entryways, including the stations of mindfulness, the right efforts, the foundations of psychic power, the roots, the powers, the limbs of enlightenment, or the [eight-fold] path,[12] or may experience signs associated with emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness,[13] the six perfections, any of the [other] pāramitās,[14] the superknowledges and transformations, and so forth. Ideally, these should all be analyzed extensively herein. Thus it is that a sutra states: "If one controls the mind so that it abides in a single place, there is no endeavor which may not be accomplished."[15]

2) [Distinguishing Between True and False]

Second, the section on "distinguishing between the true and the false," consists itself of two parts.

a) [Signs of False Dhyāna Absorptions]

The first part is "describing the signs of the manifestation of false dhyāna absorptions."

When the practitioner experiences the manifestation of dhyāna absorptions such as discussed above, it may be that, on account of the dharmas which have become manifest, [he experiences the following]: It may be that the body manifests agitated movement. At times the body may feel heavy, as if something was pressing down and smashing it. At times the body may feel light, as if it was about to fly. At times it might feel as if it were tied up. At times it may feel as if one were twisting around, being suspended while roasted. Or at times it may feel as if one were being subjected to boiling or cold. At times one may experience intensely strong heat.

Or perhaps one might see all sorts of strange mental states. At times one's mind may become dark and covered over. Sometimes one may generate all sorts of evil ideations. Sometimes one may bring to mind external scatteredness and confusion associated with miscellaneous wholesome endeavors. Sometimes one may experience delight or agitated movement. Sometimes one may become worried or preoccupied with sad thoughts. Sometimes one may experience unwholesome tactile sensations causing the hairs on the body to stand on end. Sometimes one may become so intensely happy that one acts confused or inebriated. All sorts of abnormal dharmas such as these, when manifesting together with dhyāna absorption, amount to instances of aberrant falseness.

If one becomes affectionately attached to these deviant meditative absorptions, then one accords with the dharmas of the ninety-five kinds of ghosts and spirits. One then becomes increasingly inclined towards mental derangement associated with the loss of one's mind [of correct resolve]. Sometimes the ghosts, spirits, and other such beings become aware that a person has become mentally attached to their dharmas. Consequently they then immediately increase the intensity of the power [associated with those dharmas] such that one then manifests all sorts of aberrant meditative absorptions and aberrant forms of intelligence, eloquence, and spiritual powers through which one might then fall into influencing people of the world through deception.

When the common foolish person observes this, he is of the opinion that one has gained the fruit of coursing along the Path. They all believe in and submit to such a person even though his mind is possessed by inverted views, even though he exclusively practices the dharmas of ghosts, and even though he deceives and confuses the inhabitants of the world.

When such a person's life comes to an end, he will remain forever unable to encounter the Buddha and will fall back down into the path of the ghosts and spirits. If he has mostly engaged in the practice of evil dharmas when sitting in meditation, he will immediately fall into the hells.

If, when the practitioner cultivates calming-and-insight, he achieves dhyāna absorptions like these which are

possessed of these signs of falseness, he should then immediately get rid of them. How does one get rid of them? If one becomes aware of the presence of falseness and deception, he should establish himself in correctness of mind and desist from accepting or becoming attached to them. They should then diminish and disappear. If one implements correct contemplation to demolish them, they should then immediately disappear.

b) [Signs of True, Correct Dhyāna Absorption]

Second, "articulating the signs of the manifestation of true and correct dhyāna absorption." [This refers to] when the practitioner is engaged in sitting meditation and there manifest dhyāna absorptions wherein there are none of the above-described abnormal dharmas. When each and every dhyāna absorption manifests, one immediately becomes aware of its relationship to meditative absorption.

One experiences emptiness, brightness, and purity. Inwardly, one's mind is delighted. One feels tranquil and blissful. There are no situations wherein one is covered over by the hindrances. The mind of goodness comes forth and manifests.

One's faith and reverence increase and grow. One's mirror of wisdom becomes clear and bright. The body and mind become supple and pliant. One experiences a subtle and marvelous emptiness and quiescence. One develops a revulsion for and abhorrence of the world. There is nothing [which one feels needs] to be done and one remains free of desires. One remains sovereignly independent in one's ability to emerge from and enter into [meditative absorption].

These are the signs of the manifestation of correct dhyāna absorptions. This is just as when working with evil people, one constantly encounters mutual aggravation, whereas when working together with good people, one eventually observes their fine points. It is much the same in distinguishing the deviant and the correct, the two types of signs manifesting in cultivating dhyāna absorption.

c) [Increasing Growth of Roots of Goodness]

Third, "clarifying the use of calming-and-insight to increase the growth of roots of goodness." When one is sitting [in meditation] and roots of goodness manifest, one should employ the two dharmas of calming and insight to cultivate them and cause them to increase and advance. If it is appropriate to employ calming, then one uses calming to cultivate them. If it is appropriate to employ insight, then one uses [insight] contemplation to cultivate them. One does this in a manner which accords with the previous discussions. This has been a summary explanation of the major ideas [related to this topic].

Chapter Eight

Recognizing the Work of Demons

8. Section Eight: Recognizing the Work of Demons

a. [Four Categories of Demons]

In Sanskrit, the term is "*māra*." In our language (lit. "the language of the Qin State"), it is rendered as "killer." They plunder the practitioner's merit wealth and slay the wisdom life of the practitioner. Hence, as for that which is referred to as "the work of demons," just as the Buddha takes as his work the use of merit and wisdom to liberate beings that they might enter nirvāṇa, the demons take as their work the continual destruction of beings' roots of goodness that they might be caused to flow along and turn about in the realms of cyclic births and deaths.

If one is able to establish the mind in the right path, it therefore becomes a case of "where the path is lofty, one knows then that the demons will flourish." Hence it is still necessary to be skillful in the recognition of the work of demons.

There are only four categories: First, the affliction demons; second, the demons of the [five] aggregates, [twelve] sense bases, and [eighteen] sense realms; third, the death demons; and fourth, the ghost-and-spirit demons.

1) [Three Categories as Common Mental Phenomena]

Three of them are normal worldly phenomena as well as products of a given individual's mind. One must get rid of them by rectifying one's own mind, thus exorcising them. We will not describe them in detail just now.

2) [Ghost-and-Spirit Demons]

As for the signs of the ghost-and-spirit demons, these are matters which must be understood. We shall now discuss them briefly. There are three categories of ghost-and-spirit demons: [First, the sprites, goblins, and creatures of the twelve horary time periods; second, "*duiti*" demons; and third, demon-generated afflictions].

a) [Sprites, Goblins, and Creatures of the Twelve Horary Time Periods]

As for the first, the sprites, goblins, and creatures of the twelve horary time periods, they transform into all sorts of different shapes and forms, perhaps taking on the form of a young girl or an old person, or even appearing in fearsome physical forms not limited to any single type. They aggravate and deceive the practitioner. All of these sprites and goblins desire to afflict practitioners. Each of them comes at a time corresponding to its appointed hour. It is necessary to become skillful in distinguishing and recognizing them.

If they come during the *yin* time period (3:00–5:00 a.m.), they are certainly tigers or other such creatures.

If they come during the *mao* period (5:00–7:00 a.m.), they are certainly rabbits, deer, and so forth.

If they come during the *chen* period (7:00–9:00 a.m.), they are certainly dragons, turtles, and so forth.

If they come during the *si* time period (9:00–11:00 a.m.), they are certainly snakes, pythons, and so forth.

If they come during the *wu* period (11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m.), they are certainly horses, mules, camels, and so forth.

If they come during the *wei* time period (1:00–3:00 p.m), they are certainly sheep, and so forth.

If they come during the *shen* time period (3:00–5:00 p.m.), they are certainly monkeys, baboons, and so forth.

If they come during the *you* time period (5:00–7:00 p.m.), they are certainly chickens, crows, and so forth.

If they come during the *xu* time period (7:00–9:00 p.m.), they are certainly dogs, wolves, and so forth.

If they come during the *hai* time period (9:00–11:00 p.m.), they are certainly pigs and such.

If they come during the *zi* time period (11:00 p.m. to 1:00 a.m.), they are certainly rats and such.

If they come during the *chou* time period (1:00–3:00 a.m.), they are certainly oxen and such.

If the practitioner observes that they always come at this particular time, he may then know which creature goblin it is. He should then declare its name to scold and rebuke it, whereupon it should retreat and disappear.

b) [*Duiti* Ghosts]

Second, the *duiti* ghosts. They too generate all sorts of aggravating contacts which they inflict upon practitioners. Sometimes they manifest like insects or scorpions which attack a person's head or face, producing a drilling and piercing sensation attended by intense bright light. Sometimes they strike or constrict a person's sides or perhaps suddenly clutch a person in their embrace, or sometimes they speak, make noises, howl, and even appear in the forms of beasts, not limiting themselves to a single form of appearance.

One should recognize them immediately, single-mindedly close the eyes to block them from view, and then scold them, saying, for example, such words as these: "I now recognize you. You are a *kṛtya* demon[1] from Jambudvīpa, one who feasts on fires and foul-smelling smoke[2] and one who seeks to plunder ordination careers. You are under the sway of deviant views and thus delight in destroying the ranks of the precept-holders. I am now one who upholds the precepts and am one who will never fear you."

If one is a monastic, he should recite the precept texts. If one is a householder, he should recite the three refuges, the five precepts, and so forth. The ghost will then be driven off, being forced to crawl away. All sorts of other such appearances which present difficulties and which aggravate people as well as other techniques for cutting them off and getting rid of them are all as extensively described in the sutras on dhyāna meditation.

c) [Demon-generated Afflictions]

Third, afflictions inflicted by demons. Typically, these demons create by transformation three types of phenomenal states within the sphere of the five sense objects, states which they bring forth to demolish the wholesome mind:

In the case of the first type, one which involves the creation of disagreeable phenomena, these appear as fearsome manifestations of the five sense objects which cause a person to be filled with terror.

In the case of the second type, one which involves the creation of agreeable phenomena, these appear as desirable manifestations of the five sense objects which cause a person to become mentally attached.

In the case of the third type, one which involves phenomena that are neither agreeable nor disagreeable, these appear as neutral manifestations of the five sense objects which distract and confuse the practitioner.

On account of such activities as these, the demons are also referred to as "killers," are also referred to as "floral arrows," and are also referred to as "the five arrows." This is on account of their penetrating a person through the five sense faculties.

Within [the mental and physical phenomena of] "name-andform,"[3] they create all sorts of objective states which deceive and confuse the practitioner. In cases where they create agreeable objective states, they may manifest in the form of parents, siblings, buddhas, attractive men or women, or as other desirable phenomena which cause a person to become mentally attached.

In cases where they create disagreeable objective states, they may manifest in the forms of tigers, wolves, lions, or *rākṣasas*, or may manifest in all sorts of other fearsome appearances by means of which they come forth to terrorize the practitioner.

In cases where they create objective states that are neither disagreeable nor agreeable, they may manifest ordinary phenomena which they employ to distract and confuse the mind of the practitioner, thus causing the loss of dhyāna absorption. Hence they are referred to as "demons."

They may also create all sorts of fine or terrible sounds, or may create all sorts of fragrant or stinking smells, or may create all sorts of fine or terrible tastes, or may create all sorts of anguishing or blissful objective states which they bring forth to inflict upon a person's body. These are all the work of demons. Their signs are multifarious. We will not now describe them all.

To bring up and speak of that which is essential, wherever there is the creation of all sorts of phenomena among the five sense objects which aggravate and confuse a person, causing the loss of good dharmas and the arising of afflictions, these are all activities of the demon armies. They are able to employ them to destroy the normal standard for the Buddha's Dharma and to cause the arising of all sorts of path-blocking dharmas such as desire, worry, anger, sleepiness, and so forth. This is as described in a verse from a sutra:

Desire is the foremost of your armies.
Worry is the second.
Hunger and thirst make up the third army.
Craving is the fourth.

Sleepiness is the fifth of your armies.
Fearfulness is the sixth.
Doubt and remorse make up the seventh army.
Anger is the eighth.

Offering and empty praises are the ninth.
Pridefulness and arrogance are the tenth.
Numerous armies such as these
Subdue and bury the monastic.

I use the power of dhyāna and wisdom
To smash all of these armies of yours,
And after realizing the Path of buddhahood,
Bring all beings across to liberation.[4]

b. [Driving Demons Away]

Once the practitioner has recognized the work of demons, he should immediately drive them away. There are two methods for driving them away, as follows.

1) [Through Calming]

The first method involves using calming to drive them off. Whenever one observes any of the external evil demon states, knowing that they are false and deceptive, one refrains from becoming either worried or fearful. Neither does one grasp at them or [actively] reject them or commit the error of indulging in making any calculations or mental discriminations with regard to them. By putting the mind to rest and causing it to abide in quiescence, they should naturally disappear on their own accord.

2) [Through Insight]

The second involves using insight to drive them off. If one observes any of the different kinds of demon states similar to those discussed above and one then finds that, even though one employs calming, they nonetheless do not go away, one should then immediately turn back one's attention and contemplate the observing mind. One does not then perceive that it abides in any location. What then is it that could be afflicted by them?

When one contemplates in this manner, they should soon disappear. If they are slow to respond and thus fail to go away, one should rectify one's own mind and refrain from generating thoughts of terror. One should not even fear for the loss of one's own physical life. One should rectify one's thought so that it does not move. One should recognize that the suchness (*tathatā*) of the demon realm is just the suchness of the buddha realm and [should thus recognize also] that if the suchness of the demon realm and the suchness of the buddha realm are a single suchness, there cannot be two [different] suchnesses.

If one reaches a complete comprehension in this manner, [one will understand that] there is nothing in the demon realm to be relinquished and nothing in the buddha realm to be seized upon. Of its own accord, the Dharma of the Buddha should then naturally manifest before one, whereupon the demon state should naturally dissolve and disappear.

3) [When Demon States Won't Abate]

a) [Limits of a Demon's Powers]

Additionally, if one observes that a demon state does not disappear, one need not give rise to distress. If one observes that it does disappear, one must not become joyful, either. Why is this? We have not yet observed a case of a person sitting in dhyāna absorption who has observed the demon transform into a tiger or a wolf which has then actually come forth and eaten the person. Nor have we yet observed a case of a demon transforming into a man or woman which has actually come forth and acted as a husband or a wife.

b) [Complicit Role of Demon-state "Victims"]

It is through taking on [an indulging] role in a demon's illusory transformations that a foolish person, failing to completely understand, allows his mind to become alarmed or allows it to generate desire-based attachment. Because of this, the mind becomes chaotic, one loses meditative absorption, and one may behave insanely.

One causes one's own calamity. In every case, it is a matter of the practitioner bringing on a calamity through the absence of wisdom. It is not a case of something actually brought about by the demon.

c) [Additional Techniques for Driving Off Demonic States]

i) [Rectification of One's Own Mind]

If demon states occur which aggravate and disturb the practitioner and which don't go away even after months and years have passed, one must simply make one's own mind upright so that the rectitude of one's own thoughts remains solid. One should [be so determined to maintain mental rectitude that he would] not even shrink from risking his own life [to secure that end].[6] One must not be filled with distress or fearfulness.

ii) [Mantras, Repentances, Precept-Recitation, Rectitude, the Good Guru]

One should recite the demon-countering incantations found within the Great Vehicle *vaipulya*[5] sutras. One should recite them silently and abide in mindfulness of the Triple Jewel. Even when one has emerged from dhyāna absorption, one should still recite the incantations as a self-protective measure. One should perform repentances, should maintain a sense of shame and a dread of blame, and should also recite one's *pratimokṣa* codes.[7]

That which is deviant is unable to interfere with whatsoever is orthodox. After a time, it will fade away on its own accord. The work of demons is of many different sorts. A complete discussion of it would be endless. One must

be skillful in recognizing it.

Hence the novice practitioner must draw near to a good and knowledgeable spiritual guide specifically because difficult situations such as these may arise.

d) [Summary Statement on Negative Effects of Demons]

These demons may enter into a person's mind thus becoming able to cause the practitioner's mind and spirit to become crazy and disturbed, thus producing swings alternating between joy and depression. On account of this, a calamity could occur which might even lead to one's death. At times, they may cause one to gain deviant forms of dhyāna absorption, wisdom, spiritual powers, or *dhāraṇīs*, or they may even cause one to speak Dharma and engage in teaching and conversion of a sort which influences everyone to believe in and submit to him. In the end, one may do damage to other people's wholesome, world-transcending endeavors and one may even engage in activities destructive of right Dharma.

The various strange phenomena of this sort are not of a single type. If one were to describe all of them, they would be endlessly many. We now only briefly explain their essential features for the sake of preventing the practitioner from erroneously indulging mind states arising during dhyāna meditation.

e) [Summary Statement on Demons and Driving Them Off]

To speak of it in a way which grasps what is essential, if one desires to drive away the deviant and return to the orthodox, one should contemplate the true character of dharmas. If one skillfully cultivates calming and insight, there is no deviant phenomenon which will not be demolished. Hence the *[Mahāprajñāpāramitā] Upadeśa* states: "Aside from the true character of dharmas, everything else is demonic phenomena."[8] This is as described in a verse:

If one makes discriminations and engages in reflective intellection,
This then is just the net of Māra.
If one remains unmoving and does not indulge discriminations,
This then is the seal of the Dharma.[9]

Chapter Nine

Treatment of Disorders

9. Section Nine: Treatment of Disorders

Once the practitioner has established his resolve to cultivating the Path, disorders associated with the four great elements may manifest. Based on one's present application of the contemplative mind, the breath may be caused to provoke the activation of latent disorders. Sometimes it happens that one is unable to skillfully and appropriately adjust the three factors of body, mind and breath. Due to interferences between the inward and the outward circumstances, pathological troubles may develop.

Now, as for the dharma of sitting in dhyāna absorption, if one is able to skillfully apply the mind, then the four hundred and four kinds of disorders will naturally be cured. If, however, one fails in the correct placement of the mind, then the four hundred and four kinds of disorders may arise on that very account.

For these reasons, whether one is engaged in practice oneself, or whether one is teaching others, one must become skilled in recognizing the causes of disorders. One must know well the methods for employing the inward mind during sitting meditation to treat disorders. If someday one activates a disorder, it may not simply be a matter of developing an obstruction to practice of the Path. It may be that one has to even contemplate the loss of this one great life.

Now, there are two concepts involved in the explanation of the treatment of disorders. First, one explains the signs which arise when disorders manifest. Secondly, one explains the methods employed in the treatment of disorders.

a. [Signs of Disorders]

First, the explanation of the signs which arise when disorders manifest. Although there are many different species of disorders which may manifest, when set forth in brief, they do not go beyond two categories, as follows.

1) [Signs Related to the Four Great Elements]

The first are signs of disorders related to the increase or decrease in the four great elements.

a) [Earth-Related Signs]

If the great element of earth increases [relative to the other elements], then there may be swelling, obstruction, submersion, or heaviness, and the body may become emaciated. One hundred and one maladies of this sort may arise.

b) [Water-Related Signs]

If the great element of water increases [relative to the other elements], then there may occur production of the thick or the thin disease-related fluids, edema, and the failure of food and drink to digest properly. Abdominal pain, diarrhea, and any of one hundred and one different types of related maladies may arise.

c) [Fire-Related Signs]

If the great element of fire increases [relative to the other elements], then there may be strong fever in which steaming heat alternates with coldness. The joints may all become painful. The respiration, urination, and defecation may not occur with normal ease and any of one hundred and one different types of related maladies may arise.

d) [Wind-Related Signs]

If the great element of wind increases [relative to the other elements], then the body may feel as if empty and suspended. There may occur quaking and tremors and the experience of intense pain. The lungs may feel as if pressed down or else may feel distended and urgent in their functioning. There may occur nausea and eructation or an intense urgency to the breathing. Any of one hundred and one different types of such related maladies may arise.

e) [Summary Statement on Element-Related Signs]

Hence a scripture states, "When a single great element is out of adjustment, any of one hundred and one disorders may arise. When the four great elements are out of adjustment, any of four hundred and four disorders may be simultaneously activated."[1]

When the disorders associated with the four great elements manifest, each of them possesses a characteristic appearance. One should be watchful for them when one is sitting in meditation and even during one's dreams.

2) [Signs Related to the Five Core Organs]

Second, the signs which occur when the five core organs develop maladies.

a) [Heart-Related Signs]

In a case where a malady develops from a cause associated with the heart, the body may become either cold or hot and there may be headaches or, on account of the heart's serving as the ruler of the mouth, there may be such symptoms as dryness of the mouth.

b) [Lung-Related Signs]

In the case where a malady has developed from a cause associated with the lungs, the body may become edematous, the four limbs may become aggravatingly painful, the heart may become depressed, or, on account of the lungs' serving as the ruler of the nose, there may be such symptoms as nasal congestion.

c) [Liver-Related Signs]

In the case where a malady has developed from a cause associated with the liver, there are usually no joyful thoughts. One may be distressed, worried, or unhappy. One may have melancholic thoughts or anger. The head may ache or, on account of the liver serving as the ruler of the eyes, there may occur such symptoms as dimness, blurriness, or dullness of the eyes.

d) [Spleen-Related Signs]

In a case where a malady develops from a cause associated with the spleen, a traveling wind may afflict the body and the face and there may be irritating itching and pain throughout the body. On account of the spleen serving as the ruler of the tongue, there may occur such symptoms as a seeming loss of flavor in food and drink.[2]

e) [Kidney-Related Signs]

In the case where a malady has developed from a cause associated with the kidneys, the throat may be inclined towards feeling choked or obstructed, the abdomen may become distended and, on account of the kidneys serving as the ruler of the ears, there may occur such symptoms as deafness.

f) [Summary Statement on Organ-Related Signs]

The disorders produced from the five *core* organs are of many different sorts. Each of them presents its own particular signs. One should investigate them when sitting in meditation and even during one's dreams. One may thus be able to understand them.

3) [Summary Statements on Disease Etiology]

The causality involved in pathological maladies associated with the four great elements and the five core organs is not limited to a single type. The symptoms are of many different varieties. They cannot be completely described herein. If the practitioner wishes to cultivate the Dharma entryway of calming-and-insight, it may happen that maladies arise. One should become skillful in recognizing their causal bases. These two categories of disorder may both be activated through either internal or external causes.

In a case where there has been injury from external cold, wind, or heat, and it happens also that one's food and drink are not digesting properly so that the disorder has appeared in both of these [element and organ] locations, one should know then that this is an instance of pathological activity instigated by external causes.

In a case where there has been incorrect adjustment in application of the mind, contradictory and unorthodox contemplative practice, or perhaps misunderstanding of appropriateness in the giveand-take required when meditative absorption dharmas manifest, and when it happens consequently that disorders have developed in both of these [element and organ] locations, this is a case of pathological signs instigated by internal causes.

Additionally, there are three different categories of causal bases for becoming afflicted with disorders: The first consists of excesses and deficiencies in the four great elements and five *core* organs as discussed earlier. The second consists of disorders brought on through the actions of ghosts and spirits. The third consists of disorders brought on as a result of karmic retribution.

Disorders such as these are very easily cured if they are treated immediately when first contracted. If they go on for a long time, however, then the pathology becomes established. If the body becomes emaciated and the disorder becomes anchored in place, then, in proceeding with the treatment of it, it may be difficult to bring about a cure.

b. [Treating Disorders]

Second, explaining the methods for treating the disorders. Having deeply understood the origins of a disorder's arising and manifestations, one should implement a method for treating it. The methods employed in the treatment of disorders are of many types. To bring up those which are essential, they do not go beyond the two skillful means of calming and insight.

1) [Treatment through Calming]

How does one use calming to treat symptoms of a disorder?

a) [At the Site of the Disorder]

There are masters who say that if one simply establishes the mind in calming at the site of the disorder, one will immediately be able to cure the disorder. Why is this? The mind is the ruler of this [life's] span of karmic-effect retributions. This [healing effect] is comparable to that circumstance wherein, whenever a king goes somewhere, the bands of rebels suddenly scatter.

b) [At the *Udāna* or *Dantian*]

Next, there are masters who say that one inch below the navel is a location known as the *udāna*. This refers to what we know [in Chinese culture] as the "*dantian*."[3] If one is able to bring the mind to a halt and preserve its point of focus at this location such that it does not become scattered, then after one has done this for a long time, in most cases, there will be that which is remedied.

c) [Beneath the Feet]

There are other masters who say that if one constantly anchors the mind's point of attention beneath the feet without regard to whether one is walking, standing, or lying down to sleep, one will be able to cure disorders. Why is this? This is because it is on account of nonregulation of the four great elements that most illnesses occur. This is brought about by the mind's consciousness becoming anchored in a higher position, thus causing the four great elements to become unregulated. If one anchors the mind below, then the four great elements will naturally become appropriately adjusted and the various disorders will be gotten rid of.

d) [Quiescent Abiding in Calming While Realizing Emptiness]

There are masters who state that one need only realize that all dharmas are empty and that nothing whatsoever exists. If one refrains from seizing upon the symptoms of illness while quiescently abiding in calming, then a cure will be brought about in most cases. Why is this? This is because the mind's reflective intellection pumps up the four great elements and instigates the arising of disorders.

If one puts the mind to rest in harmony and happiness, the various disorders will then be cured. Hence the *Vimalakīrti Sutra* states, "What is it that constitutes the origin of disease? It is the so-called 'manipulation of conditions.' … How does one cut off the manipulation of conditions? It is through what is known as 'the mind's non-apprehension [of the inherent existence of any phenomena].'"[4]

e) [Summary Statement on "Calming" as a Means of Treatment]

All such sorts of explanations promoting the use of calming to treat disease symptoms are not of just one single type. Hence one should realize that one is able to treat a multitude of disorders through skillful cultivation of the dharma of calming.

2) [Treatment through Various {Insight} Contemplation Techniques]

Next, the explanation of using [insight-based] contemplations to treat disorders.

a) [Employing Six Types of Breath]

There are masters who state that one need only engage in contemplation utilizing the mind's visualizing thought while also employing six kinds of subtle energetic breath (*qi* = *prāṇa*) to treat disorders. This is just a case of [insight] contemplation being able to treat disorders. What are the six kinds of breath? The first is blowing (*chui*). The second is exhaling (*hu*). The third is mirthful tittering (*xi*). The fourth is puffing (*he*). The fifth is drawn-out breathing (*xu*). The sixth is normal breathing (*si*).[5] These six kinds of breathing are all created within the lips and mouth and are a skillful means employed by the envisioning mind as one turns to the side, utilizing them in a soft and subtle manner. A verse states:

The heart belongs to "*he,*" the kidneys to "*chui*,"
The spleen to "*hu,*" and the lungs to "*si*"—the sages all know this.
When the liver heats up, the "*xu*" word comes forth.
Wherever the Triple Warmer is blocked, one need only intone "*xi*."

b) [Employing Twelve Types of Respiration]

There are masters who say that if one is skillful in using vizualizing contemplations in implementing twelve different kinds of respiration, one is able to treat a multitude of maladies. The first is "ascending" respiration. The second is "descending" respiration. The third is "filling" respiration. The fourth is "burning" respiration. The fifth is "extended" respiration. The sixth is "demolishing" respiration. The seventh is "warming" respiration. The eighth is "cooling" respiration. The ninth is "forceful" respiration. The tenth is "retaining" respiration. The eleventh is "harmonizing" respiration. The twelfth is "restoring" respiration.

All twelve of these types of respiration arise from the visualizing mind. We now briefly explain the counteractive features of the twelve types of respiration:

"Ascending" respiration counteracts sinking and heaviness.

"Descending" respiration counteracts symptoms of feeling as if empty and "suspended."
"Filling" respiration counteracts emaciation.
"Burning" respiration counteracts distention.
"Extended" respiration counteracts injury through wasting away.
"Demolishing" respiration counteracts increasing fullness.
"Warming" respiration counteracts coldness.
"Cooling" respiration counteracts heat.
"Forceful" respiration counteracts non-opening obstructions.
"Retaining" respiration counteracts shaking.
"Harmonizing" respiration counteracts four-element deterioration.
"Restoring" respiration fortifies four-element deterioration.

If one is skillful in using these kinds of respiration, one may be able to treat all of the many varieties of maladies. If one extrapolates from this, one will be able to comprehend the techniques.

c) [Through Visualizing Contemplations]

There are masters who say that, if one is skillful in employing visualizing contemplations in the sphere of conventional [reality], one will be able to treat a multitude of disorders. For instance, if a person is afflicted with coldness, one may visualize the fire energy arising within the body and then be able to counteract the coldness. This accords with the *Saṃyukta Āgama Sutra's* extensive discussion of seventy-two esoteric therapeutic techniques.

d) [Through Realization of Unfindability]

There are masters who say that one need only employ calming and insight to carry out investigative analyses within the body so as to realize that the disorders of the four great elements cannot be apprehended as existing and the disorders of the mind cannot be found either. Thus the multitude of disorders will then be cured of themselves. There are all sorts of explanations such as these whereby one employs [insight-based] contemplations to treat disorders. Their implementations differ. However, if one well realizes their meanings, one may in every case be able to treat disorders.

3) [Summary Discussion on the Treatment of Disorders]

a) [General Considerations]

One should understand that if one realizes well the meanings inherent in the two techniques of calming and insight, there is no disorder which will not be cured thereby. However, the faculties and potential of people of the present age are shallow and dull. When they carry out these envisioning contemplations, they often fail to succeed. Thus these techniques do not circulate widely in the world. As an additional point, one must not go beyond these techniques to pursue the study of energy-manipulation skills or diets requiring desisting from cereal grains. It is feared that one will then develop heterodox views. Mineral and herbal medicines can be useful in the treatment of disease. Hence they may be consumed as well.

If it is a case of a disorder caused by ghosts, one should employ an intensely resolute mind in the application of mantras, using them as a means to assist the treatment. If it is a case of a disorder brought on by karmic retribution, then it is essential to cultivate merit and repentances. The malady will then disappear. In the case of these two[6] types of treatment methods, where a practitioner has had particularly good success with a specific approach, he may practice it himself and also extend its benefits to others as well. How much the more might this be acceptable where one has succeeded in reaching a complete and penetrating realization.

However, if one has no real knowledge of any of this, then when disorders arise, one will not have any means to treat it. Then, not only would this amount to neglectfulness in one's own cultivation of right Dharma, but one fears it might also be a case of someone's very life being in danger. [Under such circumstances], how could one then resort to one's own practice experience as a basis for offering instruction to others?

Therefore, one who wishes to cultivate calming-and-insight must well understand the treatment techniques based in one's own mind. Those techniques are not limited to a single approach. The realization of the concept is something particular to each person. How then could one be able to transmit such matters solely through writing?

b) [Ten Essential Factors in Treatment of Disorders]

Furthermore, when one applies one's mind to the treatment of disorders while engaged in sitting meditation, it is still essential to also include ten dharmas of which there are none which fail to provide benefit. The ten dharmas are:

1. Faith;
2. Utilization;
3. Diligence;

4. Staying constantly focused on the objective condition;

5. Distinguishing the causality of the disorder;

6. Skillful means;

7. Long-enduring practice;

8. Understanding selection and relinquishing;

9. Maintaining and guarding [precept observance]; and

10. Recognizing how to block the arising of obstacles.

What is meant by "faith"? This refers to having faith that this technique is certainly capable of curing the particular disorder.

What is meant by "utilization"? This refers to constant utilization no matter what the circumstances may be at the time.

What is meant by "diligence"? This refers to utilization of the technique in a focused, intense, and unceasing manner wherein one takes the achievement of a cure as the measure of accomplishment.

What is meant by "staying focused on the objective condition"? This refers to maintaining a refined mental focus abiding in constant reliance on the particular [treatment] method while not allowing any change in the object of one's attention.

What is meant by "distinguishing the causality of the disorder"? This is as discussed above.

What is meant by "skillful means"? This refers to being skillful and not failing in appropriateness as one perfects subtle energetic meditation work, application of mind, and development of visualizations.

What is meant by "long-enduring practice"? This means that, should one employ a particular technique and yet not gain immediate benefit from it, one nonetheless ignores the passage of days or months, continuing nonetheless to be constant and unfailing in carrying on with the practice.

What is meant by "understanding selection and relinquishment"? This means that, where one becomes aware of benefits in a given technique, one is then diligent, whereas, where one discovers harmfulness in a given technique, one immediately relinquishes it. One is extremely subtle in applying the mind to the task of making adjustments and implementing treatment methods.

What is meant by "maintaining and guarding [precept observance]"? This means that one is skillful in recognizing how different objective conditions carry the potential to involve one in transgressions [against the moral precepts].

What is meant by avoiding obstacles? This means that, should one realize some benefits in one's practice, one does not broadcast [such accomplishments] to others, whereas, so long as one hasn't encountered any harm in [a particular treatment technique], one refrains from generating doubts or slanders toward it.

If one relies upon these ten dharmas in the application of treatment methods, one will definitely find them to be efficacious and will not have undertaken them in vain.

Chapter Ten

Realization of the Fruits

10. Section Ten: Realization of the Fruits

a. [Provisional Contemplations]

1) [Contemplation of Śrāvaka Disciples and Pratyekabuddhas]

When the practitioner cultivates calming-and-insight in this manner, he may be able to realize that, in every case, all dharmas arise from the mind and, due to the falseness and insubstantiality of causes and conditions, they are empty. Because he realizes that they are empty, he is unable to apprehend any existence in the names and characteristics linked to any dharma. This constitutes the calming achieved through the comprehension of truth.

At such a time, one does not perceive any fruit of buddhahood above which may be sought after, nor does one perceive any beings below which could be delivered to liberation. This constitutes moving from [contemplation of] conventional [truth] into the contemplation of [the truth of] emptiness. It is also the contemplation of the two truths, is also a function of the wisdom eye, and is also [the basis of] all-knowledge.

If [one commits the error of] taking up residence in this contemplation, one thereby falls down onto the ground of the Śrāvaka Disciples and Pratyekabuddhas.[1] Thus, the [*Lotus] Sutra* states that the assembly of Śrāvaka Disciples and others sighed to themselves and said, "If we heard of the purification of buddhalands and of the teaching and transforming of beings, our minds were not pleased. Why is this? All dharmas are empty and still. There is in them no production, no destruction, no greatness, no smallness, no outflows, and no conditioning. Having deliberated in this fashion, we did not generate any joy or happiness in it."[2]

One should realize that if one establishes oneself in a perception of the unconditioned and in so doing then enters into the "correct station" (*samyaktva-niyāma*),[3] such a person will never be able to generate the mind directed toward *samyak saṃbodhi*.[4] This is a case of a failure to perceive the buddha nature due to excessive emphasis on the power of meditative absorption.

2) [Contemplation of the Bodhisattvas]

The bodhisattva perfects all of the dharmas of a buddha for the sake of all beings. He should not seize upon or become attached to the unconditioned, thus bringing himself to enter a state of quiescent cessation. At such a time, one should instead cultivate going from [contemplation of the truth of] emptiness into the contemplation of conventional [truth]. Then, one ought to carefully contemplate and realize that, although the nature of the mind is empty, nonetheless, when one abides in the dual realm of conditions, one is still able to bring forth all dharmas. They are comparable to magicallyconjured illusions or supernaturally-generated transformations. Although they are devoid of any fixed reality, there still do exist different characteristic distinctions in the sphere of seeing, hearing, awareness, knowing, and so forth.

When the practitioner contemplates in this manner, although he realizes that all dharmas are ultimately empty and still, he is nonetheless able to cultivate all kinds of practices in the midst of emptiness. It is just as if he were planting a tree in empty space. One is still able to distinguish the faculties of beings and, based on the incalculable number of individual natures and desires, one is then able to proclaim an incalculable number of different dharmas [for their sakes]. If one is able to perfect unobstructed eloquence, then one will be able to benefit the beings of the six destinies.

This constitutes the calming characterized by skillful means adapted to conditions. This then constitutes a moving from [contemplation of the truth of] emptiness into the contemplation of the conventional [truth]. It is also the evenly balanced contemplation, is also the function of the dharma eye, and is also the knowledge of the aspects of the paths (*mārga-ākara-jñatā*).

If one abides in this contemplation, on account of an excessive emphasis on the power of wisdom, although one *does* succeed in perceiving the buddha nature, still, one does not yet arrive at a completely clear comprehension of it. Although the bodhisattva may succeed in perfecting these two kinds of contemplations, this still only constitutes an entryway involving provisional contemplations. It is not the case that it constitutes the correct contemplation.

3) [Summarizing Scriptural Citation]

Hence the [*Bodhisattva Necklace Fundamental Practices*] *Sutra*[5] states: "The previous two contemplations are

provisional paths. It is because of the contemplation of these two emptinesses[6] that one succeeds in entering the contemplation of the primary meaning of the Middle Way. One engages in simultaneous illumination of the two truths, perceives every single thought-moment as quiescent extinction…and one naturally flows on into the sea of *sarvajñatā*."[7]

If a bodhisattva wishes to perfect all of the dharmas of a buddha in a single thought-moment, he should cultivate the calming which distinguishes the two extremes and should carry it out within the correct contemplation of the Middle Way.

b. [Correct Contemplation]

1) [Defining Characteristics of Correct Contemplation]

How does one cultivate the correct contemplation? If one completely comprehends that the nature of the mind is neither true nor false, and if one puts to rest the mind which takes truth and falseness as objective conditions, this constitutes correctness.

If one truly contemplates the nature of mind as neither empty nor conventionally existent while still not refuting those dharmas which are either empty or conventionally existent, and if one is able to realize this sort of complete illumination, then in the very nature of mind, one achieves a penetrating understanding of the Middle Way and achieves perfect illumination of the two truths.

If one is able to perceive the Middle Way and the two truths in one's own mind, then one perceives the Middle Way and the two truths in all dharmas, but still does not seize upon either the Middle Way or the two truths. This is because no definite and fixed nature can be found in them. It is this which constitutes the correct contemplation of the Middle Way. This is as set forth in a verse from the *Treatise on the Middle*:

> As for all dharmas produced of causes and conditions,
> I declare them to be empty.
> They are also [mere] conventional designations,
> And also [embody] the meaning of the Middle Way.[8]

In deliberating deeply on the intent of this verse, one finds that it not only completely delineates the characteristics of the contemplation of the middle but also simultaneously clarifies the import of the previous two provisional-contemplation gateways. One should realize that the correct contemplation of the Middle Way involves the buddha eye and the knowledge of all modes (*sarva-kāra-jñatā*). If one abides in this contemplation, then the powers of meditative absorption and wisdom are equal, one completely and utterly perceives the buddha nature, and one becomes peacefully established in the Great Vehicle.

2) [Characteristics of the Bodhisattva's Post-Resolution Realizations]

"His steps are even and correct and his speed is as fleet as the wind."[9]

"One then naturally flows on into the sea of *sarvajñatā*."[10]

"One carries on the practices of the Tathāgata."[11]

"One enters the room of the Tathāgata. One dons the robe of the Tathāgata. One sits in the seat of the Tathāgata."[12]

In this case, one then takes the adornment of the Tathāgata as one's own adornment and succeeds in realizing purification of the six faculties.[13] One enters into the state realized by the Buddha. One has no defiling attachment to any dharma. All of the Buddha's dharmas entirely manifest before one and one perfects the mindfulness-of-the-Buddha samādhi.

One becomes peacefully established in the foremost *Śūraṅgama* meditative absorption. This is the samādhi wherein one manifests form bodies universally. One universally enters all of the buddhalands of the ten directions, teaching and transforming beings. One adorns and purifies all of the buddha *kṣetras*, makes offerings to the Buddhas of the ten directions, receives and maintains the Dharma treasury of all Buddhas, perfects the pāramitās of all practices, awakens to and enters into the station of the great bodhisattvas, and in doing so becomes a companion of Samantabhadra and Mañjuśrī.

Having come to eternally abide in the Dharma-nature body, one is then praised by the Buddhas and given a prediction of buddhahood. One then adorns the Tuṣita Heaven, manifests descent of his spiritual body into the womb of his mother, leaves behind the home life, goes to the site where the Path is realized (*bodhimaṇḍala*), conquers the demon adversaries, realizes the right enlightenment, turns the wheel of Dharma, and then enters nirvāṇa. Throughout the lands of the ten directions, one brings to perfect completion all of the Buddha's endeavors and becomes complete in the two bodies, the true body and the response body. This then is the realization of the bodhisattva who

has initially brought forth the resolve.

In the *Floral Adornment Sutra*, it states: "At the very time when one first brings forth the resolve, one then succeeds in achieving the right enlightenment. One gains a completely penetrating understanding of the true nature of dharmas. The wisdom body one possesses is not awakened to in reliance on others."[14]

It also states: "The bodhisattva who has generated the initial resolve gains the Tathāgata's singular [Dharma] body and the capacity to create an incalculable number of other bodies."[15]

It also states: "The bodhisattva who has generated the initial resolve is the same as a buddha."[16]

The *Nirvāṇa Sutra* states: "The bringing forth of the resolve and the ultimate realization are indistinguishable. Of these two minds, the first of them is [particularly] difficult [to generate]."[17]

The *Mahāprajñāpāramitā Sutra* states: "Subhūti, there are bodhisattvas, *mahāsattvas* who, from the very point of first bringing forth the resolve, immediately proceed to sit at the site where the Path is realized (*bodhimaṇḍala*) where they then proceed to turn the wheel of the right Dharma. One should realize that these are bodhisattvas acting in the same way as buddhas."

In the *Lotus Sutra*, the instance of the jewel being offered up by Dragon Daughter serves as a corroborating case. Sutras such as these all clarify that, in the initial establishment of resolve, one perfects all of the dharmas of the Buddha. This is just as exemplified by the *Mahāprajñāpāramitā Sutra*'s gateway of the syllable "*a*," just as exemplified by the concept in the *Lotus Sutra* of teachings being for the sake of causing beings to open up the knowledge and vision of the Buddhas, and is also just as exemplified by the concept in the *Nirvāṇa Sutra* of abiding in the great nirvāṇa through perceiving the Buddha nature.

We have already explained in brief the initial-resolve bodhisattva's signs of realizing the fruits arising on account of cultivating calming-and-insight.

3) [Characteristics of Later-Stage Realizations]

Next, elucidation of the characteristics of realization of the fruits on the part of later-stage minds. The states of realization which develop for those with later-stage minds are not such as we can cognize. However, if we now extrapolate from what the teachings make clear, we find that they never depart from the two dharmas of calming and insight.

So, how is this the case? Take for example when the *Lotus Sutra* states that [the Buddha] assiduously praised the wisdom of the Buddhas. This is a reference to the concept of [insight] contemplation. This is a case of employing a correlation to [insight] contemplation as a means of elucidating its fruits.

As for the *Nirvāṇa Sutra*'s expansive description employing a hundred statements on the topic of liberation as a means of explaining the great nirvāṇa, nirvāṇa corresponds to the meaning inherent in calming. This is a case of employing a correlation with calming as a means of elucidating its fruits.

Therefore it states that the great *parinirvāṇa* is an eternal quiescent meditative absorption. As for "meditative absorption," it corresponds to the meaning inherent in calming.

Although in the *Lotus Sutra*, the correlation to [insight] contemplation is employed as a means of elucidating its fruits, it is nonetheless also inclusive of calming. Hence it states, "[The characteristic of liberation, the characteristic of abandonment, the characteristic of cessation], as well as the ultimate nirvāṇa's characteristic of eternal quiescent extinction are all finally returnable to emptiness."[18]

Although in the *Nirvāṇa Sutra*, the correlation to calming is employed to elucidate its fruits, it is nonetheless also inclusive of [insight] contemplation. Hence it takes the three qualities[19] as constituting the great nirvāṇa.

Although there are differences in the texts of these two great sutras as regards the explicit and the esoteric, it is never the case that they depart from a relationship to the two entryways of calming and insight. In the articulation of their ultimate concepts, they both rely upon the two dharmas of meditative absorption and wisdom in order to elucidate the utmost fruits [of cultivating the path] The practitioner should realize that the initial, middle and later fruits are all inconceivable and ineffable. Hence the new translation of the *Golden Light Sutra* states, "The Tathāgatas at the beginning are inconceivable and ineffable. The Tathāgatas during the intermediate phase engage in all sorts of adornments [of the Dharma realm of beings and in every case it is for the sake of benefiting others.] The Tathāgatas at the final phase are eternally indestructible."[20]

In every case the correlation to the cultivation of the two minds of calming and insight is employed to articulate the fruits [of cultivation]. Hence a verse from the *Pratyutpanna Samādhi Sutra* states:

It is from the mind that all buddhas gain liberation.
As for the mind, it is pure and known as undefiled.

Even in the five destinies, it remains fresh and immaculate and takes on no form.
Where there is one who studies this, he perfects the great Path.[21]

c. [The Essential Prerequisites for Success]

I declare as a matter of solemn oath that, as for that which is practiced, it is essential to get rid of the three obstacles[22] and the five hindrances.[23] In the event that they are not gotten rid of, even though one might be diligent in applying one's efforts, one will ultimately gain no benefit from it.

End of *The Essentials for Practicing Calming-and-Insight and Dhyāna Meditation*

Endnotes

Preface

1. *Ekottara-āgama-sūtra* (增壹阿含經 – T02.125.551a).
2. Although "fetters" does have technical meanings, it is a general term of reference for afflictions (*kleśa*) such as desire, hatred, and delusion. Fetters are referred to as such because they provoke unwholesome karma which binds one to unenlightened cyclic existence. A more detailed list speaks of the nine fetters: desire, hatred, arrogance, ignorance-generated delusion, doubtfulness, views, grasping (at views), jealousy, stinginess.
3. T09.262.8a.
4. Unable to find the origin of this citation.
5. *Mahā-parinirvāṇa-sūtra* (大般涅槃經 – T12.374.547a).

1. *Sutra on the General Teachings and Remonstrances of the Buddha Prior to Parinirvāṇa*, translated by Kumārajīva (佛垂般涅槃略說教誡經 – T12.389.1111a). A "bhikshu," by the way, is a fully ordained celibatetradition Buddhist monk.

2. The five "relentless" transgressions are patricide, matricide, killing an arhat, spilling the blood of a Buddha, and causing a schism in the harmoniously-united monastic Sangha. The Sanskrit term connotes immediacy, unavoidability, and relentlessness of hell-bound retribution. These transgressions are discussed in the fourth chapter of the *Abhidharma-kośa-bhāṣyam*.

3. 佛說佛名經 (T14.441.225b, 284b), 大方廣十輪經 (T13.410.709a).

4. "Sense of shame" (*hrī*) and "dread of blame" (*apatrāpya*) are considered to be "good dharmas" which are included as such in the dharmicanalysis schemas of all traditional Buddhist schools of both Southern and Northern traditions. They are, for instance, contained in the 100 dharmas of Vasubandhu, and in a subset of that schema commonly studied in certain schools of Tibetan Buddhism as "the fifty-one mental factors").

   A sense of shame instills a sensitivity to one's own highest standards of behavior whereas dread of blame instills a sensitivity to the highest behavioral standards of one's peers. They are not intended to produce a mental state eternally freighted with guilt. On the contrary: Where one nourishes these sensitivities, one is bound to avoid negative karma and the guilt which naturally follows in its wake.

5. I was unable to locate this scripture in the Chinese canon.

6. Dhyāna Master Baojing notes that this refers to Shakyamuni Buddha's period of cultivating ascetic practices in the Himalayas in this lifetime and also to his cultivation in the mountains in previous lives while coursing along the Bodhisattva Path (p. 53).

7. "*Dhūta* practices" refers to a dozen ascetic practices which were encouraged by the Buddha for those practitioners who could benefit from them. They included such practices as eating but a single meal each day, sitting up while sleeping at night, etc. They tend to reinforce certain crucial aspects of intense spiritual cultivation and are to be distinguished from the non-beneficial ascetic practices which the Buddha specifically discouraged (such as lying down on a bed of nails, covering oneself with ashes, etc.).

8. Verbal purification refers to a mental contemplation attended by a verbal statement wherein a monastic offers material goods in excess of one's most basic needs to the Triple Jewel (Buddha, Dharma, and monastic Sangha), requesting that they compassionately accept their ownership. One then becomes able to use them without the assumption that they belong specifically to one's self. The practical utility of this practice is that it tends to discourage attachment to personal material possessions.

9. According to Śāriputra's classic explanation narrated by Nāgārjuna in fascicle three of *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.79c2–80a1), "upwardly" refers to such professions as meteorological and astronomical prognostications, "inferiorly" refers to the blending of herbs, tilling the soil, planting fruit trees and so forth, "midpoints" refers to occult professions involving mantras, oracles, omens and so forth, and "directions" refers to manipulation and flattery of the rich and powerful through activities performed in all four directions intended to obtain their favors. The entire story, as translated in my *Marvelous Stories of the Perfection of Wisdom*:

   Śāriputra Explains Pure Sustenance to Śucimukhī

   Śāriputra went into the city to make his alms rounds and, having obtained his food, sat down facing a wall to eat. At this time, a *brahmacarinī* name Śucimukhī came along and saw Śāriputra and asked Śāriputra, "Śramaṇa, are you eating?"

   He replied, "Yes, I'm eating."

   Śucimukhī asked, "Do you *śramaṇas* eat with your attention directed downwards?"

   He replied, "No, Sister."

   "Do you eat with your attention directed upwards?"

   "No."

   "With your attention directed to the [four] directions?"

   "No."

   "With your attention directed to the four intermediary points?"

   "No."

   Śucimukhī said, "There are four methods employed in eating. I asked you about them and you said 'no' in every case. I don't understand. You ought to explain."

   Śāriputra said, "There are those who have left the home life who blend herbs, sow grains, plant trees, or engage in other such forms of impure means of sustaining one's life. These methods are referred to as "sustenance gained with one's attention directed downwards."

   "There are those who have left the home life who observe the stars, the constellations, the sun, the moon, the wind, the rain, thunder and lightning, and lightning bolts, these impure means of sustaining one's life. These methods are referred to as "sustenance gained with one's attention directed upwards."

   "There are those who have left the home life who manipulate and flatter the noble and powerful, who deliver messages for them in all four directions, or who employ clever words and covetousness, these impure means of sustaining one's life. These methods are referred to as "sustenance gained with one's attention directed in all directions."

   "There are those who have left the home life who study all manner of incantational techniques, or who practice divination and calculation of auspiciousness and inauspiciousness and all kinds of other impure means of sustaining one's life such as these. These methods are referred to as "sustenance gained with one's attention directed on the intermediary points." Sister, I do not fall into any of these four types of impure means of sustaining one's life. I employ the pure alms round to sustain this life."

   At this time, when Śucimukhī had heard the explanation of the dharma of pure sustenance, she was delighted and developed faith and understanding. On account of having spoken Dharma for her, Śāriputra gained the way of the *srota-āpanna* (first-stage arhat).

10. An *araṇya* is a quiet meditation hermitage. As for the Chinese unit of distance measure, there are roughly three Chinese *li* in a mile.

1. Nāgārjuna, from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.181b–c), as translated in *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections*:

How does one renounce sounds? It is the characteristic of sounds that they do not abide. One hears them only momentarily and then they immediately disappear. Because foolish people do not understand a sound's characteristic of being impermanent and disappearing. they erroneously develop fondness and pleasure in relation to sounds. They retain in their minds sounds which have already passed and bring forth attachment to them.

This is illustrated by the case of the five hundred rishis who dwelt in the mountains. A *kinnara* maiden was bathing in a pool in the Snow Mountains. When they heard the sound of her singing, they immediately lost their dhyāna absorptions. Their minds became drunken, crazed, and so unrestrained that they were unable to control themselves. It was as if a great gale had begun to blow through the trees in the forest. When they heard this subtle and marvelous singing voice which was so soft and pure, they brought forth aberrant thoughts. On account of this, without their even being aware of it, their minds became deranged.

Thus it is that one may lose one's meritorious qualities in the present life and even become bound in later lives to fall into the wretched destinies.

A person possessed of wisdom contemplates sounds and perceives that, in every new thought-moment, they are produced and destroyed, that the prior and latter sounds do not include each other, and that they are not continuous. If one is able to develop an understanding such as this, then one does not bring forth defiling attachments. Whosoever is a person like this is unable to become disoriented even by the music of the gods, how much the less by the voices of humans. All sorts of causes and conditions such as these serve to illustrate what is meant by renouncing the desire for sounds.

2. "Fetters" (*saṃyojana*) are just the afflictions of greed, hatred, stupidity, arrogance, doubt, etc. which tie people up and bind them to the world.

3. Nāgārjuna, from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.181c–2a), as translated in *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections*:

Additionally, there was a bhikshu who was walking next to a lotus pool in the forest. When he smelled the fragrance of the lotus blossoms, his mind was pleased and so experienced a feeling of pleasure. Having passed on by, his mind engendered a fondness for it.

The pond spirit then spoke to him, saying, "Why is it that you have forsaken that place beneath the trees wherein you have been sitting purely in dhyāna meditation and have now come forth to steal these fragrances of mine? It is on account of attachment to fragrances that dormant fetters may be caused to arise."

At that time, yet another person came along who entered right into the pool and took many of its flowers. He proceeded to dig, pulled forth roots and stems, created a disorderly mess, and then left. The pond spirit remained silent and did not say anything at all.

The Bhikshu then said, "This person destroyed your pond and took your flowers. You didn't say anything whatsoever to him. However, I merely passed by the bank of the pond and then suffered your rebuke and a scolding in which you claimed that I had stolen your fragrances."

The pond spirit said, "The evil people of the world are always immersing their heads in the excrement of offense-related defilement. I do not even bother to speak to them. You, however, are a fine person who engages in the practice of dhyāna meditation. Thus, when you become attached to these fragrances, it destroys your fine endeavors. It is for this reason that I scolded you."

This is analogous to a white cloth which is fresh and pure but then gets a spot where it has become stained by something black. Everyone sees it. In the case of those who are evil persons, it is analogous to an already black robe becoming spotted with ink. It is such as people would not even notice. So, who would even bring it up?

All sorts of causes and conditions such as this constitute what is meant by renouncing the desire for fragrances.

4. Nāgārjuna, from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.182a), as translated in *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections*:

What is meant by renouncing tastes? One ought to make oneself aware that, "Solely on account of desirous attachment to fine flavors, I may become bound to undergo a multitude of sufferings wherein molten copper is poured down the mouth and I am forced to consume burning hot iron pellets."

If one fails to observe the Dharma in its applications to eating, and if one's thoughts of particular fondness become solidly attached, one may fall down amongst the worms who course in the midst of impurities. This is exemplified by the one *śrāmaṇera* whose mind became constantly fond of curds. Whenever the *dānapatis* made a food offering to the Sangha of curds, the portion which was left over would always be passed on to that *śrāmaṇera*. In his thoughts, he became lovingly attached to it, taking such pleasure and delight that he was unable to separate from it. After the end of his life he was reborn in this vase of leftover curds. The master of that *śrāmaṇera* had gained the way of arhatship. When the Sangha divided up the curds, he said to them, "Be careful, be careful. Don't injure the curd-loving *śrāmaṇera*."

Everyone said, "But this is just a worm. Why do you refer to it as 'the curd-loving *śrāmaṇera*'?"

He replied, saying, "Originally, this worm was my *śrāmaṇera*. Because he only sat there engaged in a gluttonous affection for leftover curds, he came to be reborn in this vase. When the master received his share of the curds, the worm came along within it. The master said, "Curd-loving fellow. Why did you come here?" He then gave it the curds.

5. Nāgārjuna, from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.183a–c), as translated in *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections*:

In a time long ago and far off in the past there was a rishi in the mountains of the state of Benares who, in the early spring was relieving himself into a wash basin when he observed a buck and a doe mating. Lustful thoughts suddenly arose in him, whereupon his semen flowed into the basin.

The doe happened to drink from that basin and then became pregnant. When the months of pregnancy were complete, she gave birth to a fawn with the appearance of a man. There was only one horn on the head and his feet were like that of deer. When the deer was about to give birth, she went to a place alongside the rishi's hut and then gave birth. She saw that her fawn was a person and so entrusted it to the rishi and left.

When the rishi came out, he saw this progeny of the deer, recalled to himself the original conditions, knew that it was his own son, and so took him and raised him. As the son grew to adulthood, he diligently instructed him in the topics of study so that he was able to gain a penetrating understanding of the eighteen great classics. Additionally, he studied sitting in dhyāna, practiced the four immeasurable minds, and then immediately gained the five superknowledges.

Once, he was climbing up the mountain and encountered a great rainstorm. The mud became so slippery that he lost his footing, fell to the ground, broke his ewer and injured his foot. He then became greatly enraged. Because his ewer had been full of water, he cast a spell which caused it to not rain any more. On account of the meritorious qualities possessed by this rishi, the dragons, ghosts and spirits all saw to it that it did not rain.

Because it did not rain, the five types of grains and the five types of fruit all failed to grow. The populace became impoverished, destitute, and bereft of any means to survive. The king of the state of Benares was distressed, worried, and tormented by grief. He ordered all of the great officials to convene and discuss the rainfall situation.

One of the wise ones among them offered an opinion, saying, "I have heard it rumored that there is a one-horned rishi up in the Rishi Mountains who, on account of losing his footing, fell down and injured his foot as he was climbing the mountain. In a fit of anger, he cast a spell on these rains and thus caused them to not fall at all for the ensuing twelve years."

The King thought to himself, "If it goes twelve years without raining, my country will surely be finished. There will be no people left at all." The King then issued an appeal, stating, "Could it be that there is someone who, for the sake of the population, will be able to instruct me in how to cause a rishi to lose his five superknowledges? If so, I will divide the country with them so that we might each rule over half of it."

In this country of Benares, there was a courtesan by the name of Śāntā who was incomparably beautiful. She came in response to the King's appeal and asked everyone there, "Is this individual a man or not?"

Everyone replied, "He is a man, that's all. He was born to a rishi."

The Courtesan said, “If he is a man, I will be able to destroy him.” After she had said this, she took up a gold tray filled with fine and precious things, and told the King, “I will come back here mounted on the neck of this rishi.”

The Courtesan then immediately sought to assemble five hundred carriages carrying five hundred beautiful maidens and five hundred deer-carts carrying all sorts of delightful morsels all of which had been admixed with many herbs. She used many different hues to color them so that they appeared like various kinds of fruits and then took all sorts of greatly powerful fine liquors which, in appearance and flavor, were identical to water.

They dressed in tree bark clothing and grass clothing and traveled into the forest, appearing thereby as if they were rishis themselves. They set up grass huts off to the side of the Rishi’s hut and then took up residence there. The one-horned Rishi was wandering about and observed them. The maidens all came out and welcomed him. They used beautiful flowers and fine incenses as offerings to the Rishi. The Rishi was greatly delighted.

All of the maidens used lovely words and respectful phrases in greeting the Rishi. They took him on into their quarters and sat with him on fine bedding. They gave him fine clear liquor which he took to be pure water. They gave him delightful morsels which he took to be fruit. After he had feasted and drunk his fill, he told the maidens, “From the time of my birth on up to the present, this is a first. I have never yet had such fine fruit and such fine water.”

The maidens said, “It is because we have been single-minded in our practice of goodness that the gods fulfill our wishes to obtain these fine fruits and fine water.”

The Rishi asked the maidens, “How is it that your complexions and bodies are so full and flourishing?”

They replied, saying, “It is because we eat these fine fruits and drink this marvelous water that our bodies are so full and flourishing as this.” The maidens asked the Rishi, “Why don’t you come and live here among us?”

He replied, “I, too, could abide here.”

The maidens said, “We could bathe together.” He then assented to that as well. The hands of the maidens were soft and tender. When they touched him, his mind moved. He then continued to bathe together with the beautiful maidens. Desirous thoughts arose and consequently he engaged in sexual intercourse. He immediately lost his superknowledges, whereupon the heavens made a great downpour of rain which went on for seven days and seven nights, allowing them the opportunity to continue engaging together in the delights of food and drink.

After the seven days had passed, the liquor and fruit were all gone, whereupon they continued to supply their needs with the waters of the mountain and the fruits from the trees. However, their flavors were not so marvelous, and so he sought more of what they had enjoyed before.

She responded by saying, “Those things are already used up. We must now go together to a place, not far from here, where more of them may be obtained.”

The Rishi said, “We can do as you wish.” They then went off together. The Courtesan knew when they had come to a spot not far from the city. The maiden then lay down in the middle of the road and said, “I’m exhausted. I can’t walk any further.”

The Rishi said, “If it’s the case that you cannot walk, sit up on my shoulders and I will carry you forth.”

The maiden had already sent a letter on ahead to the King in which she told the King, “The King will be able to observe my intelligence and abilities.”

The King ordered up his official carriage and went forth to observe them. He asked, “How did you manage to bring this about?”

The maiden addressed the King, saying, “It is on account of the power of skillful means that I have now caused the situation to develop in this way. I have no abilities beyond this. Order him to live within the city. Make fine offerings to him and pay respects to him. Keep him satisfied with the five objects of desire.”

The King honored him with the status of a great official. He had dwelt in the city for only a short span of days when his body became haggard and emaciated. He remembered the mental bliss of dhyāna absorptions and so grew disgusted with these worldly desires. The King asked the Rishi, “How is it that you have become so unhappy that your body is now so haggard and emaciated?”

The Rishi replied to the King, “Although I have gained the five desires, I constantly recall to mind the leisure and stillness in the forest, the wandering place of all the rishis. I cannot get it out of my mind.”

The King thought to himself, “If I force him to go against his aspirations, such a going against one’s aspirations is suffering. If the suffering reaches an extreme, he will die. Originally, this was done out of a desire to get rid of the calamity of drought. Now that I have already succeeded in that, why should I continue to forcibly keep him from his aspirations?”

And so it was that he was released straightaway. After he returned to the mountains, he had not applied himself vigorously for long before he gained the five superknowledges once again.

6. Zhiyi’s alternate Sino-Buddhist title for Nāgārjuna’s *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa*.

7. *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.181a). Although presented as a unitary quotation, this is actually a series of unconnected quotes, with minor textual variations.

8. 治禪病祕要法 (T15.620.336c).

1. *Āvaraṇa*, one of two alternate Sanskrit antecedents for what are commonly translated into English as the five "hindrances" or "obstacles" (the other is *nīvaraṇa*), has a primary meaning of "covering" in addition to its "hindrance"-related meanings. Because many classic-era Sino-Buddhist translations render this "covering" meaning directly, it is in this sense that a number of Zhiyi's hindrance-related comments are framed. Even so, for the sake of easy resonance with other classic discussions on this topic, I have translated the technical term as "hindrance" throughout whilst still preserving this author's specific "covering"-associated comments.

2. This is a reference to a story related by Nāgārjuna in *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.166a–b). It does require, for maximum effect, that the reader adopt some degree of sympathy with the hierarchical concerns of a caste-based society. It follows here as I have rendered it in both *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections* and *Marvelous Stories from the Perfection of Wisdom*:

   There once was a king who had a daughter named Kumuda. There was a fisherman named Śubhakara. He was walking along the road when he looked from afar and saw the princess's face in the window of a tall building. In his imagination, he developed thoughts of defiling attachment which he could not relinquish for even a moment. He went through days and months during which he was unable to drink or eat. His mother asked him the reason and he revealed his feelings to his mother, "I saw the daughter of the King. My mind is unable to forget her."

   The mother explained to her son, "You are a man of lesser station. The daughter of the King is an honored member of the nobility. She is unobtainable."

   The son said, "My mind prays for this bliss and is unable to forget it for even a moment. If I cannot have it as I will it, then I will be unable to go on living."

   For the sake of her son, the mother entered the palace of the King, constantly providing gifts of fat fish and fine meats which she left for the daughter of the King without asking any remuneration. The princess thought this strange and so asked her what wish she was seeking to fulfill.

   The mother addressed the princess, "Pray, dismiss the retainers. I must relate a personal matter." [She then continued], "I have only one son. He cherishes a respectful admiration for the daughter of the King. His feelings have taken hold in a way that has caused him to become ill. He is not likely to survive much longer. I pray that you will condescend to have pity on him and give him back his life."

   The princess said, "On the fifteenth of the month have him go into such-and-such a deity's shrine and stand behind the image of the deity."

   The mother returned and told her son, "Your wish has already been fulfilled." She then described what had transpired. He bathed, put on new clothes, and stood behind the image of the deity.

   When the time came, the princess told her father, the King, "I have something inauspicious which has come up. I must go to the shrine of the deity and seek for auspiciousness and blessings."

   The King replied, "That is very good." He then had five hundred carriages adorned which then proceeded to the shrine of the deity. Having arrived, she ordered her retainers to close the doors and wait as she entered the shrine alone.

   The heavenly spirit thought, "This should not be this way. The King is the lord of the land. I cannot allow this petty man to destroy and dishonor the princess." He then caused the man to become tired and to fall into a sleep from which he did not awaken.

   Having entered, the princess saw him sleeping. She shook him very hard and yet he did not awaken. She left him a necklace worth a hundred thousand ounces of gold and then went away.

   After she had left, this man was able to awaken and see that the necklace was there. Next, he asked a person in the crowd. He then knew that the King's daughter had come. Because he was unable to follow up on his infatuation, he became distressed, full of regret, and overcome with the affliction of grief. The fire of lust broke loose within him. He was burned up by it, and then died.

3. Nāgārjuna devotes considerable energy to emphasizing the negative points of desire as a hindrance to acquisition of meditative absorption. I quote here a section from his discussion of the five hindrances wherein he presents some forty analogies on this topic, this from *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections* (T25.1509.185a–b):

   Moreover, one seeks exclusively to gain the first dhyāna and, in doing so, renounces the pleasures of desire. By way of analogy, it is as if one were to constantly strive to exterminate an enemy who threatens one with calamity, this so that one cannot be injured by that enemy.

   This is illustrated by what the Buddha said to the Brahman who was attached to desire: "I originally contemplated desire and realized that desire constitutes a cause and condition for apprehensiveness, distress, and suffering. Desire brings only few pleasures, whereas its sufferings are extremely numerous."

   Desire is the net of the demons and an entangling web from which it is difficult to escape. Desire constitutes a burning heat which dries up all bliss. It is like being in a forest with fire rising up on all four sides. Desire, like drawing close to a fiery pit, is extremely fearsome. It is like cornering a venomous snake, like an enemy invader brandishing a knife, like an evil rākṣasa ghost, like deadly poison entering the mouth, like swallowing molten copper, like three columns of crazed elephants, like drawing close to an extremely deep abyss, like a lion blocking one's path, like the Makara fish-monster opening its maw. All of the desires are just like this and are very much worthy of being feared. The desires cause people to undergo torment and suffering.

   Those people who are attached to desire are like convicts in a prison, like deer caught in a corral-trap, like birds snared in a net, like fish who have swallowed a hook, like a dog pounced upon by a leopard, like a crow in the midst of a band of owls, like a snake which has run up against a wild boar, and like a mouse among cats. They are like blind men approaching an abyss, like a fly caught in hot oil, like a peaceful man caught up in military combat, like a lame person who has entered a conflagration, like one who has entered a river of boiling brine, like one who licks a honey-smeared blade, and like one [sentenced to be] sliced to ribbons in the city square.

   The desires are like a thinly covered grove of knives, like flowers covering filth, like a jar of honey mixed with poison, and like a basket of venomous snakes. They are like the falseness and deception of a dream, like a debt which must be repaid, and like a conjuration which deceives a small child. In their lack of substantiality, they are like the flames of a fire. [Involvement with them] is like being drowned in a great body of water and like when a boat enters into the gullet of the Makara fish-monster.

   They are like a hailstorm destroying crops, like crashing thunder and lightning striking right next to a person. The desires are just like this. They are false, deceptive, devoid of substantiality, devoid of durability, devoid of potency, possessing only few pleasures, but many sufferings. The desires constitute an army of demons smashing all of one's goodness and merit.

   It is because they constantly serve to plunder and injure beings that we present all sorts of analogies such as these. If one renounces the five desires, gets rid of the five hindrances, and practices the five dharmas, one may then succeed in reaching the first dhyāna.

4. "Three wretched destinies" refers to three extremely unfortunate realms of rebirth: in the hells, as a hungry ghost, and as an animal.

5. An incomplete quotation from Nāgārjuna in *Mahā-prajñāpāramitāupadeśa* (T25.1509.167a). The complete passage as translated in *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections* (in the midst of an marvelous discussion of antidotes to anger):

   What thing is it which, killed, brings peace and security?
   What thing is it which, if slain, one has no regrets?

What thing is it which is the root of venomousness?
And which devours and destroys all forms of goodness?
What thing is it which one slays and then one is praised?
What thing is it which, slain, brings on no more distress?

The Buddha replied with a verse in which he said:
If one kills anger (*krodha*), the mind will be peaceful and secure.
If one slays anger, the mind will have no regrets.
It is anger which is the root of venomousness.
It is anger which destroys all forms of goodness.
If one slays anger, all buddhas offer praise.
If one slays anger, one has no more distress.

6. On the question of why "lethargy-and-sleepiness" is a dual-component hindrance, Vasubandhu indicates (in Chapter Five of his *Treasury of Analytic Knowledge*) that it is because both "lethargy" and "sleepiness" are nourished by the same five factors (bad omens seen in dreams [*tandrī*]; unhappiness [*arati*]; physical exhaustion [*vijṛmbhikā*]; uneven consumption of food [*bhakte'samatā*]; mental depression [*cetaso līnatva*]), are starved by the same single factor (illuminated perception [*āloka-samjñā*]), and are productive of the same result of mental languor. See Leo Pruden's *Abhidharma-kośa-bhāṣyam* (851–2).

7. I have reinserted in brackets the couplet missing from this verse which Zhiyi otherwise quotes in full from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.184b–c). The corresponding Chinese text: 一切世間 死火燒。汝當求出安可眠。

8. The "dhyāna wake-up device" refers to a piece of wood connected by a string to one's ear which falls and tugs at the ear when the meditator's posture slumps due to drowsiness.

9. On the question of why "excitedness-and-regretfulness" is a dualcomponent hindrance, Vasubandhu indicates (in Chapter Five of his *Treasury of Analytic Knowledge*) that it is because both "excitedness" and "regretfulness" are nourished by the same four factors, namely ideation regarding relatives (*jñāti-vitarka*), land (*janapada-vitarka*), immortals (*amara-vitarka*), previous pleasures and the associated companions, are countered by the same single factor (calmness), and are productive of the same result of mental agitation. See Leo Pruden's *Abhidharma-kośa-bhāṣyam* (852).

10. This is a quote from Nāgārjuna in *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.184c) with a variation in the final line. (In this text, the fourth line of the quatrain is replaced with a line *not* from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* and then a non-verse paraphrase of the replaced line.) The *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* version, as translated in *Nāgārjuna on the Six Perfections*:

You've already shaved your head and donned the dyed robe.
Taking up the clay bowl, you go out on the alms round.
How then can you delight in and be attached to dharmas of frivolity and excitedness?
Since you gain no Dharma benefit, you lose worldly bliss as well.

11. This entire verse is a quote, with very minor variations, from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.184c).

12. *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.274c).

13. This entire verse is a quote (with only very minor variations) from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.184c–5a).

14. These two concluding paragraphs are a direct quote from Nāgārjuna's *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.185a).

1. This corresponds to a quote from the *Sutra on the Ten Grounds* contained in Vasubandhu's treatise devoted to it (十地經論 – T26.1522.169a15).

2. The first "quote" (身安則道隆) is actually a condensing paraphrase of an idea found in multiple locations in the Āgamas and other Indian Buddhist canonical works. (It is not found as a direct quote in a digital search of the extant Indian-origin canon.) In the extant early Chineseorigin canon, it is found as a direct quote only in a Pureland sutra commentary (阿彌陀經義記 – T37.1755.308b) where the phrasing is virtually identical (身安即道隆).

   As for the quatrain, it is found in three closely related editions of the monastic moral code translated by Buddhayaśas, the early sixth-century north Indian translator (四分律比丘戒本 – T22.1429.1022b; 四分 僧戒本 – T22.1430.1020a; 四分比丘尼戒本 – T22.1431.1040b).

3. *Sutra on the General Teachings and Remonstrances of the Buddha Prior to Parinirvāṇa*, (佛垂般涅槃略說教誡經 – T12.389.1111a–b).

4. "Slippery" would not be the most apt description in English. This is actually a reference to a circumstance where the respiration has not yet slowed to a point where it is genuinely subtle, but rather flows on in such an unrestrained fashion that one may even hear an audible sound during either inhalation and exhalation. Zhiyi is very explicit about the meaning of this term in another text where he states: "One should regulate the breathing, ensuring that it is neither coarse nor slippery. If during exhalation or inhalation, there is any sound or [the breath] is not fine (i.e. subtle), this is the mark of 'slipperiness.'" (當調息令不澀不滑。若出入有聲及不細即是滑相。[方等三昧行 法 – T46.1940.945c]). The difficulty with producing a one-word rendering into English comes from the multiple connotations in Chinese of: "flowing on and on," "being unrestrained," and "being somewhat elusive" to one's attempts to make the respiration adequately subtle for the development of meditative absorption.

5. I've emended the text here to correct what appears to be an obvious scribal error, that of the *Taisho* text reading "two" (二) when it should actually read "three" (三). Not an uncommon occurrence, this only requires the accidental chipping off or light printing of the short middle stroke in the woodblock character for "three."

6. This verse is found nowhere in the *Taisho* version of the Chinese canon aside from other works authored by Zhiyi. In the *Eminent Tiantai Master Zhizhe's Oral Instructions on the Dhyāna Gateway* (天台智者大師 禪門口訣 – T46.1919.581a), there is a minor variation in the fourth line and then the addition of a summarizing couplet:

   In moving forward and in stopping, there is a proper sequence.
   The coarse and the subtle do not work against each other.
   It is just as with the skillful training of a horse.
   As with wishing to move on, so it is with wishing to halt.
   If one is constantly diligent and careful in this,
   One stabilizes the body and mind and then enters dhyāna.

7. T09.262.41c.

1. This is a quote from *Sutra on the Upāsaka Precepts* (優婆塞戒經 – T24.1488.1062b), translated by Dharmarakṣa (385–433 CE).
2. This is a paraphrastic quote from a Chinese edition of the *Dharmapāda*, but with the two statements presented in reverse order (法句經 – T04.210.572a). The precise quote is: “In the absence of dhyāna, one does not exercise wisdom. In the absence of wisdom, one does not course in dhyāna. The Path comes forth from dhyāna and wisdom.” (無禪不智。無智不禪。道從禪智。)

1. The four types of deportment are walking, standing, sitting, and lying down.
2. I've copied these five bracketed titles from later in the text so as to inform the student ahead of time of the main topics contained in the ensuing eight pages.
3. *Bhikshu Pratimokṣa Precept Manual* (十誦比丘波羅提木叉戒本 – T23.1436.470c).
4. *Sutra on the General Teachings and Remonstrances of the Buddha Prior to Parinirvāṇa* (佛垂般涅槃略說教誡經 – T12.389.1111a).
5. This is the verse spoken by Bhikshu Aśvajit to Śāriputra in explaining the essence of the Buddha's teaching. It is quoted here from the *Middle-Length Sutra on Origination* (中本起經 – T04.196.153c). "Śramaṇa" is a term of reference for a religious mendicant who exerts himself strenuously on a path of spiritual liberation. As such, it is an alternate term of reference for a Buddhist monk. The Bhikshu sums up in this quatrain the nature of the effort by which one might validly be referred to as a "śramaṇa."
6. A *kṣaṇa* is the shortest measure of time. One definition states that sixty of them transpire in a single fingersnap (Soothill, pp. 250–1).
7. 大乘起信論 (T32.1666.582a). There are minor textual variations here from the extant *Taisho* text. The meaning, however, is identical.
8. "True character of dharmas" (諸法實相) is a Sino-Buddhist rendering of the Sanskrit *dharmatā*. It simply refers to dharmas as they truly are. This term points directly to a dharma's "true suchness" (*tathatā*) and absence of any inherent existence. One should not construe from the term that any genuinely independent "reality" is possessed by any particular dharma.
9. *Pratyutpanna Samādhi Sūtra* (般舟三昧經 – T13.418.906a). The entire verse (uttered by the Buddha) is as follows:

> As for the mind, it does not know the mind.
> Possessing mind, one does not perceive the mind.
> If the mind generates thoughts, then this is delusion.
> The absence of thought is nirvāṇa.
>
> These dharmas are devoid of solidity,
> They are constantly established in one's thoughts.
> Through understanding and perceiving emptiness,
> In every case, one remains free of thinking.

10. "King of Lions" is a metaphoric reference to the Buddha. Master Baojing's commentary notes that when the Buddha lies down, there is no mental dimness, only complete quiescence together with wakeful awareness (p. 165). This term is also descriptive of a particular posture in which one lies down on the right side with the right arm crooked under the head and with the left arm up on top of the body with the hand on or adjacent to the left hip.
11. This refers to the five concepts discussed earlier, namely, cultivating calming-and-insight as means: 1) to counter the coarseness and disorderedness of the beginner's mind; 2) to counter the faults of mental sinking or floating; 3) to accord with whatever is appropriate; 4) to counteract subtle states of mind occurring in meditative absorption; 5) to achieve equal balance in meditative absorption and wisdom.
12. See previous note.
13. *Mahāprajñāpāramitā Sūtra* (摩訶般若波羅蜜經 – T08.223.253b–c).
14. *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.161a). There are ten minor variations in the quotation as cited in this text, only one of which involves a noteworthy change of meaning. (The first half of the third stanza therein reads: "When the patch-robed one goes out on the alms round, when moving and stopping, his mind is always one.")

1. “Contemplation of the conventional” and “contemplation of emptiness” are two of the “three contemplations” so central to the Tiantai hermeneutic system. (The third is “contemplation of the middle.”)

2. It may be worth noting here that all orthodox Buddhists consider most of the causal factors involved in “roots of goodness” to originate in previous lifetimes. Hence these are not just present-life issues.

3. See Section Eight for a detailed treatment of these issues.

4. *Anāgamya*, often referred to as “access concentration,” or “preliminary concentration” is the state of meditative concentration developed just prior to the first dhyāna.

5. Awareness of the entry of the breath, awareness of the exiting of the breath, awareness of the length of the breath, awareness of the breath pervading the body, experiencing joy, experiencing bliss, and mind’s generation of bliss are all included within the “sixteen special ascendant practices” (十六特勝). See: Foguang Dictionary, 389a, 482a; Dingfubao Dictionary, 213c; Harivarman’s *Satyasiddhi-śāstra* (成實論 – T32.1646.355-6).

6. The nine reflections on impurity (*nava-aśubha-saṃjñā* – 九不淨想]), as explained in *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* are: 1) the bloated corpse; 2) the bluish corpse; 3) the damaged corpse; 4) the blood-smeared corpse; 5) the purulent, rotting corpse; 6) the corpse which has been gnawed at [by scavenging animals and insects]; 7) the scattered corpse; 8) the skeletal corpse; and 9) the burned corpse (T25.1509.217a-18c).

7. This refers to the eight liberations (*aṣṭau vimokṣāḥ* – 八解脫, also known as: 八背舍).

8. Thus this section refers then not just to compassion but also to all four of the four immeasurable minds (*apramāṇacitta*).

9. This is an abbreviated reference to the entire twelve-fold chain of causation.

10. *Praśrabdhi*, “lightness and easefulness” is one of the wholesome dharmas, is the fourth of the seven limbs of enlightenment, and is a standard feature, common to both mind and body, which arises in beginning meditation states.

11. This is an abbreviated reference to the ten reflections and eight recollections.

12. These are the subcomponents of the thirty-seven wings of enlightenment.

13. This is a reference to the three gates to liberation, otherwise known as the three samādhis.

14. This is probably a reference to the four additional perfections resulting from the unfolding of the sixth perfection (wisdom) in the formulation known as the ten perfections. The additional four are: skillful means, vows, the powers, and the knowledges.

15. This is from Kumārajīva’s translation of the *Sutra on the Buddha’s General Instructions and Remonstrances Spoken before Entering Parinirvāṇa* (佛垂般涅槃略說教誡經 – T12.389.1111a).

1. In his long commentarial work on the *Great Calming-and-Insight* by Master Zhiyi, Zhanran identifies this as a ghost from among the ranks of precept breakers (止觀輔行傳弘決 – T46.1912.409b).

2. This type of ghost is described in the *Sutra on the Right Dharma Stations of Mindfulness* (正法念處經 – T17.721.92a-b, 100c–101a) translated during the early sixth century by the South Indian monk Prajñāruci. According to that scripture, this "consumer of fire and coals" hungry ghost is number thirty among thirty-six major categories of hungry ghosts. It is a type of hungry ghost which attempts to relieve its perpetual hunger through feasting on various sorts of fire and smoke such as that occurring in funeral pyres.

   Master Baojing identifies the *duiti* ghost as an especially aggravating and fearsome-looking subspecies of *yakṣa* ghost, one which has four eyes and two mouths.

3. "Name-and-form" is synonymous with the five aggregates which in turn are the bases for our imputing the existence of inherently existing beings of the sorts listed here. "Name" refers to the four aggregates of: feelings (including those arising through not only the five basic sense faculties, but also those arising through the intellectual mind faculty); mental perceptions; karmic formative factors (*saṃskāras*); and the consciousnesses. "Form" is primarily a reference to physical phenomena, including the five sense faculties, the five sense objects, and "forms" perceptible by the intellectual mind faculty.

4. This is from Buddha's verse to Māra beneath the Bodhi Tree drawn from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.169a). Nāgārjuna provides a fuller version of the same verse in the same work (T25.1509.99b-c) and attributes its origin to the *Kṣudraka-āgama-sūtra* (雜法藏經). Lamotte (p. 341) demonstrates that these verses appear with a few differences in the *Suttanipāta* (see verses 436–449) and the *Lalitavistara*.

5. "*Vaipulya*" means "expansive." In the broader sense, it is reference to the entire corpus of Great Vehicle sutras. In the narrower sense of the chronological formulation of Tiantai hermeneutics, it refers to the sutras generally spoken after the *Avataṃsaka Sutra* and the *Āgama* scriptures, but before such scriptures as the *Perfection of Wisdom*, the *Lotus*, and the *Nirvāṇa*.

6. The beginning Dharma student should not be so naive as to think that Master Zhiyi is suggesting any possibility that one would have to sacrifice one's life in the course of exorcising demonic states. The reference is purely to the degree of determination which may be required to accomplish the task in extreme cases, this because enforcing rectitude in one's own thoughts is not always so easy, especially where one has allowed self-destructive mental habits to become ingrained. It may very well be in such cases that one's determination must be fierce in its level of intensity. In the absence of such strong determination, one may become vulnerable to "lapses."

7. This is a reference to codes of ethics taken on in formal precept-transmitting ceremonies. Although this usually refers to the monastic's ordination precepts, it may also refer to bodhisattva moral codes available to laity who have already formally taken the five precepts.

8. This is from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.99b). Nāgārjuna's precise statement there (where he sums up his commentary on the *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* text's statement: "They have gone beyond all matters associated with demons.") is as follows: "Then again, aside from the true character of dharmas, all other dharmas are entirely [within the sphere of] demons. These include for example all of the afflictions, the fetters, the bondage of desire, the grasping at and becoming entangled in the [five] aggregates, the [eighteen sense] realms, and the [twelve] sense fields, [and includes as well] the demon kings, the demon subjects, and demons in the form of humans."

9. Also from *Mahā-prajñāpāramitā-upadeśa* (T25.1509.211a), this is drawn from Nāgārjuna's discussion of the four immeasurables wherein the actual quoted lines attributed to the Buddha are slightly variant. I translate here the entire verse:

   As for when I sat upon the platform of the Path,
   It was such as even wisdom is unable to apprehend.
   As with an empty fist employed to trick little children,
   It was done in order to bring all to deliverance.

   The true character of dharmas
   Is identical to the characteristic aspects of beings.
   If one seizes upon the characteristic aspects of beings,
   Then one strays far away from the path of reality.

   If one constantly bears in mind eternally empty characteristics,
   Such a person is not engaged in the practice of the Path.
   For, among dharmas which are neither produced nor destroyed,
   He nonetheless makes discriminations regarding their aspects.

   If one makes discriminations and engages in reflective intellection,
   This then is just the net of Māra.
   If one is unmoving and doesn't depend on anything,
   This then constitutes the seal of the Dharma.

1. This is a quote from a discussion of the suffering of sickness drawn from the *Sutra on the Five Kings as Spoken by the Buddha* (佛說五王經 – T14.523.796b). The Buddha so impresses the Kings with his explanation of the eight sufferings that they renounce their palaces and royal pleasures, preferring then to become monks in quest of liberation from cyclic existence.
2. Traditional Chinese medicine employs the term "spleen" to encompass the overall functioning of the digestive system and does not at all limit its use of the term to reference the blood-filtering organ carrying that name in Western medicine.
3. "*Dantian*," literally translated, means "the field [for cultivating] the pill [of immortality]." The binome is a Chinese anatomical term with origins in Taoist yoga. The term was adopted into Buddhist literature as the nearest indigenous analogue to the identically located *maṇipūra* chakra of such importance in Indian Buddhist meditation yoga.
4. T14.475.545a.
5. Master Baojing cautions the reader to not rely on the actual meaning of the character so much as on intoning the sound of the character while exhaling very subtly and performing the related visualization (250-1).
6. I'm emending the Taisho text here, substituting "two" (二) for "one" (一) to correct an obvious scribal error. The emendation is supported by other editions as well as by the flow of ideas contained in the text.

1. It may be useful to reflect that Zhiyi is not criticizing this level of realization *per se*, but rather is pointing out that developing a nonprogressing attachment to it is fatal to pursuit of the bodhisattva's career which eventually culminates in buddhahood.
2. From a verse uttered by Mahākāśyapa in the "Faith and Understanding" chapter of the *Lotus Sutra* (妙法蓮華經 – T09.262.18b).
3. A term indicating a station synonymous with the path of seeing constituting a "point of no return" for those intent on the individual-liberation goal of arhatship.
4. This means "right enlightenment" and refers here to the enlightenment of a buddha.
5. From the *Bodhisattva Necklace Sutra* (菩薩瓔珞本業經 – T24.1485.1014b, c). The post-ellipsis quote is located a full *Taisho* panel after the first quote.
6. Master Baojing points out that the two types of emptiness refer here to the emptiness of persons and the emptiness of dharmas (281).
7. *Sarvajñatā* is the omniscience or all-knowledge of a buddha.
8. From Nāgārjuna's *Treatise on the Middle* (中論 – T30.1564.33b).
9. This is a quote from "The Analogies Chapter" of the *Lotus Sutra* where the great white ox which represents the one buddha vehicle is being described (T9.262.12c). Master Baojing notes that "even and correct" refers to the equality of meditative absorption and wisdom characteristic of a buddha's perfect contemplation whereas "speed as fleet as the wind" refers to that perfect contemplation's acuity in reflecting the nature and its entry into the way of effortlessness (290-1).
10. Again, this is from the *Bodhisattva Necklace Sutra* (菩薩瓔珞本業經 – T24.1485.1014c).
11. *Lotus Sutra* (T09.262.30c). This is a slight paraphrase. The actual passage states, "One carries on the endeavors of the Tathāgata."
12. *Ibid.* (T09.262.31c). Master Baojing notes that in this additional quote from the *Lotus Sutra*, the "practice" refers to the practice of a buddha wherein a single practice embodies all practices, the "robe" refers to patience, the "room" refers to the great loving-kindness and compassion, and the "seat" refers to the emptiness of dharmas (291-2).
13. Master Baojing also notes that "adornment" here refers to the merit and wisdom of a buddha (292).
14. From the *Avataṃsaka Sutra (*大方廣佛華嚴經 – T09.278.449c).
15. Ibid. T09.278.452c.
16. Ibid. T09.278.452c.
17. From the *Mahāparinirvāṇa Sutra* (大般涅槃經 – T12.374.590a).
18. From the *Lotus Sutra* (妙法蓮華經 – T09.262.19c). The text I have supplied in brackets represents a more complete quotation from the sutra text.
19. The three qualities alluded to are: prajñā, liberation, and the Dharma body.
20. From the composite edition of the *Golden Light Sutra* (合部金光明經 – T16.664.362b-c). The bracketed phrases reflect the fuller phrasing of the scripture text as currently recorded in *Taisho*. The extant *Taisho* edition has the order of the last two statements reversed and so concludes with: "The Tathāgatas during the intermediate phase engage in all sorts of adornments of the Dharma realm of beings and in every case it is for the sake of benefiting others."
21. From the *Pratyutpanna Samādhi Sutra* (般舟三昧經 – T13.418.909a). The extant *Taisho* edition reads slightly differently:

    "It is from the mind that all Buddhas understand and realize the Path.

    As for the mind, it is pure, bright, and undefiled.

    In the five destinies, it is fresh and immaculate and takes on no form.

    Where there is one who understands this, he perfects the great Path."
22. The three obstacles are those associated with afflictions, with karma, and with karmic retribution.
23. As articulated in the extensive discussion earlier in this work, the five hindrances are: desire, ill-will, lethargy-and-sleepiness, excitedness-and-regretfulness, doubt.

About the Translator

Bhikshu Dharmamitra (ordination name “Heng Shou” – 釋恆授) is a Chinese-tradition translator-monk and one of the early American disciples (since 1968) of the late Weiyang Ch’an patriarch, Dharma teacher, and exegete, the Venerable Master Hsuan Hua (宣化上人). He has a total of 23 years in robes during two periods as a monastic (1969–1975; 1991 to present).

Dharmamitra’s principle educational foundations as a translator lie in four years of intensive monastic training and Chinese-language study of classic Mahāyāna texts in a small-group setting under Master Hua from 1968–1972, undergraduate Chinese language study at Portland State University, a year of intensive one-on-one Classical Chinese study at the Fu Jen University Language Center near Taipei, and two years at the University of Washington’s School of Asian Languages and Literature (1988–90).

Since taking robes again under Master Hua in 1991, Dharmamitra has devoted his energies primarily to study and translation of classic Mahāyāna texts with a special interest in works by Ārya Nāgārjuna and related authors. To date, he has translated a dozen important texts, most of which are slated for publication by Kalavinka Press.

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